

T H E C O M P L E T E

MAUS



WINNER
OF THE
PULITZER
PRIZE

art spiegelman



'*Maus* memorializes Spiegelman's father's experience of the Holocaust – it follows his story, frame by frame, from youth and marriage in pre-war Poland to imprisonment in Auschwitz. The 'survivor's tale' that results is stark and unembellished. One of the clichés about the Holocaust is that you can't imagine it – like nuclear war, its horror outfaces the artistic imagination. Spiegelman disproves that theory' *Independent*

'Spiegelman portrays the Nazis as cats, the Jews as mice, the Poles as pigs and the Americans as dogs. They are all terrifyingly human' *The Times*

'An intensely personal account of a family's survival, of hair-breadth escapes and incarceration, [that] deals artfully with experiences and emotions that many might fervently wish to forget. Of how, when life is stripped to subsistence level, trust and betrayal take on unprecedented dimensions. In the tradition of Aesop and Orwell, it serves to shock and impart powerful resonance to what, after all, is a well-documented subject. And the artwork is so accomplished, forceful and moving, without resorting to sentimentality, that it works'

Time Out



MAUS

A SURVIVOR'S TALE

M

AUS

**A SURVIVOR'S TALE
MY FATHER
BLEEDS
HISTORY**

**AND HERE
MY TROUBLES
BEGAN**
art spiegelman



PENGUIN BOOKS

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22

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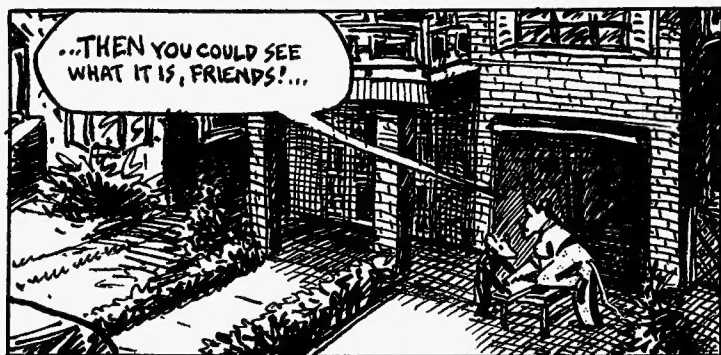
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Rego Park, N.Y. c.1958





PART I PAGE 9
MY FATHER BLEEDS HISTORY

PART II PAGE 167
AND HERE MY TROUBLES BEGAN

MAUS



FOR ANJA

MY FATHER BLEEDS HISTORY

(MID - 1930s TO WINTER 1944)

C O N T E N T S

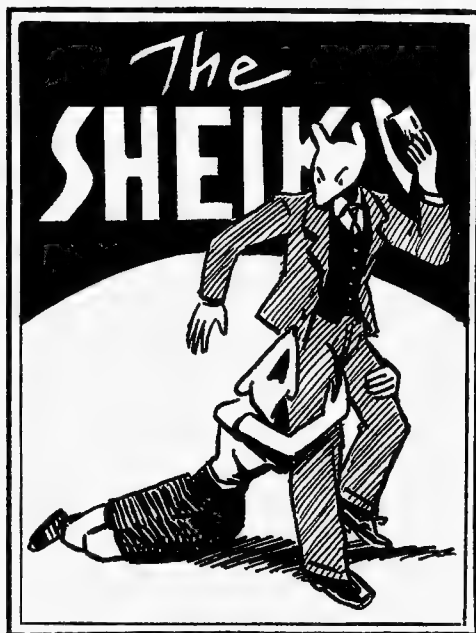
- 11 one/the sheik
27 two/the honeymoon
43 three/prisoner of war
73 four/the noose tightens
97 five/mouse holes
131 six/mouse trap



**"The Jews are undoubtedly a race,
but they are not human."**

Adolf Hitler

C H A P T E R O N E



I went out to see my Father in Rego Park. I hadn't seen him in a long time- we weren't that close.



IT'S A SHAME FRANÇOISE ALSO DIDN'T COME.





I WAS, AT THAT TIME, YOUNG, AND REALLY A NICE, HANDSOME BOY.



I HAD A LOT OF GIRLS WHAT I DIDN'T EVEN KNOW THAT WOULD RUN AFTER ME.



HELLO, VLADER?
THIS IS YULEK...

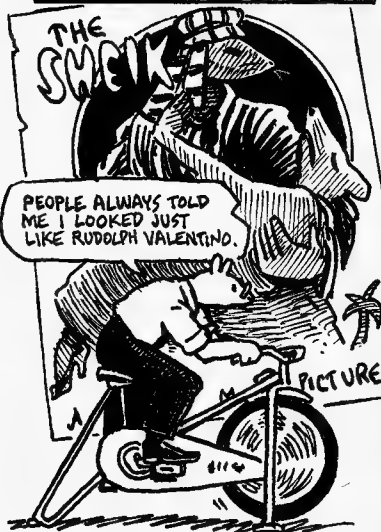


A FRIEND OF MINE, LUCIA GREENBERG, WOULD LIKE TO BE INTRODUCED TO YOU.



THE
SMACK

PEOPLE ALWAYS TOLD
ME I LOOKED JUST
LIKE RUDDOLPH VALENTINO.



EVENTUALLY, I TOOK LUCIA TO DANCE...

DO YOU LIVE ALONE?

YES.



I HAVE A SMALL APARTMENT.
MY PARENTS MOVED TO SOSNOWIEC

I'D LIKE
TO SEE IT
SOMETIME.

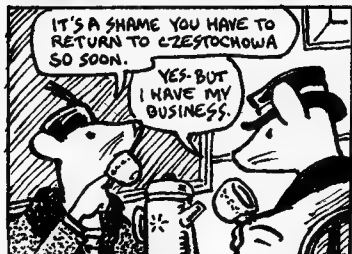
MAYBE
SOMETIME







THE NEXT MORNING WE ALL MET TOGETHER. MY
COUSIN AND ANJA SPOKE SOMETIMES IN ENGLISH.



AND THEN SHE STARTED
WRITING TO ME SUCH
BEAUTIFUL LETTERS—
ALMOST NOBODY COULD
WRITE POLISH LIKE
SHE WROTE.

I VISITED A COUPLE TIMES TO HER.
SHE SENT ME A PHOTO!!!

I BOUGHT A VERY NICE FRAME...

IT PASSED
MAYBE A WEEK
UNTIL LUCIA
AGAIN CAME
AND SAW
THE PHOTO!!!

I'M GOING TO GET EN-
GAGED TO HER, LUCIA.

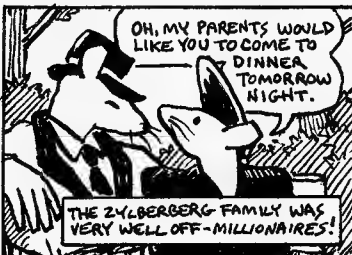
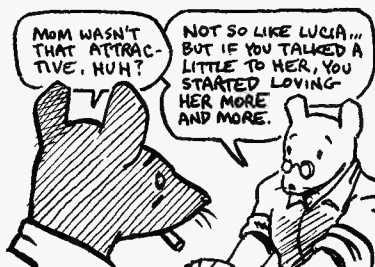
PSSH! AND LOOK
AT WHAT A
BEAUTY YOU
PICKED.

LOOKS AREN'T EVERYTHING,
LUCIA. IT ISN'T GOOD
FOR EITHER OF US THAT
YOU KEEP
COMING
UP HERE...

"WE HAVE TO PLAN FOR OUR
FUTURES, AND

FORGET HER!
LET ME MAKE
YOU HAPPY!

IT WAS NOT SO EASY TO GET FREE FROM LUCIA.

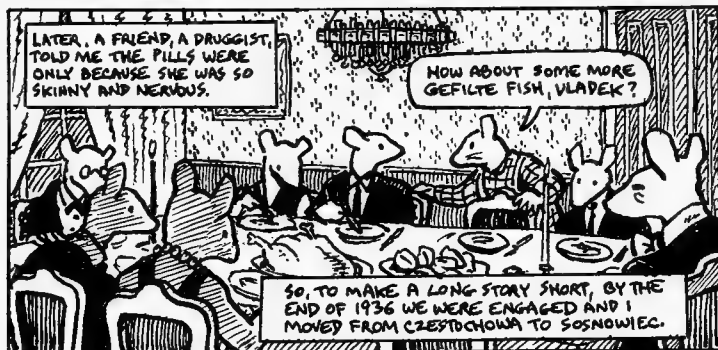


ANJA'S PARENTS WERE ANXIOUS SHE SHOULD BE MARRIED. SHE WAS 24; I WAS THEN 30.

THE ZYLBERBERGS HAD A HOSIERY FACTORY—ONE OF THE BIGGEST IN POLAND... BUT WHEN I CAME IN TO THEIR HOUSE IT WAS SO LIKE A KING CAME...



TO SEE WHAT A HOUSEKEEPER SHE WAS, I PEEKED INTO ANJA'S CLOSET.



SO, TO MAKE A LONG STORY SHORT, BY THE END OF 1936 WE WERE ENGAGED AND I MOVED FROM CZESTOCHOWA TO SOSNOWIEC.

ACH! HERE I FORGOT TO TELL SOMETHING FROM BEFORE I MOVED TO SOSNOWIEC BUT AFTER OUR ENGAGEMENT WAS MADE.

ONE EVENING THE BELL RANG ...

LUCIA

WHAT ARE YOU DOING HERE?
I'M ON MY WAY OUT.

I-I'LL COME WITH YOU.

NO, YOU CAN'T COME WI-

PLEASE, VLADEK!

SHE FELL ON THE FLOOR
AND HELD STRONG MY LEGS.

DON'T RUN AWAY!

I SAW NOW THAT I WENT TOO FAR WITH HER.

SLAM!

I RAN OUT TO MY FRIEND WHAT INTRODUCED US. HE WENT TO CALM HER DOWN AND TOOK HER HOME.

IT DIDN'T HEAR MORE
FROM LUCIA - BUT
ALSO I STOPPED HEAR-
ING FROM ANJA ...



NO TELEPHONE CALLS,
NO LETTERS, NOTHING!
WHAT HAPPENED?



SHE SAYS SHE WON'T
SPEAK TO YOU!



SHE GOT A LETTER FROM SOME-
ONE IN CZESTOCHOWA. MY GOD!
IT SAYS THE WORST THINGS IN
THE WORLD ABOUT YOU!



WELL, I CAN'T CONVINCE HER
ON THE PHONE. I'LL COME
DOWN BY TRAIN ON FRIDAY
AFTER WORK.



IT WASN'T EVEN A
HOLIDAY, BUT I WENT
ANYWAY TO SOSNOWIEC.



SO, TELL ME, ANJA - WHAT HAVE
I DONE THAT'S SO HORRIBLE?

YOU SHOULD KNOW -
JUST READ
THIS!



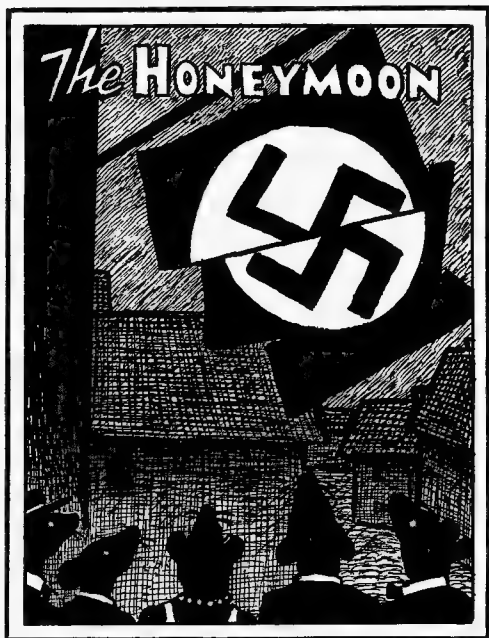


SO I MOVED TO SOŚNO-
WIEC AT THE END OF 1936;
AND FEBRUARY 14, 1937,
WE WERE MARRIED.

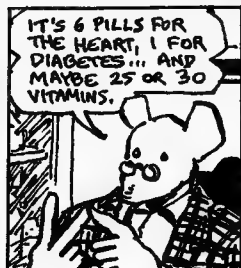
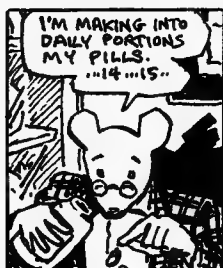




C H A P T E R T W O



For the next few months I went back to visit my father quite regularly, to hear his story.





ANJA WAS INVOLVED IN CONSPIRACIONS!

A LITTLE BEFORE THE POLICE CAME, SHE GOT FROM FRIENDS A TELEPHONE CALL...



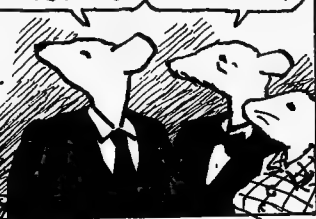


BY OCTOBER 1937, THE
FACTORY WAS GOING,
AND IT WAS BORN
MY FIRST SON, RICHIEV.



HE'S A BIG BABY-
OVER 3 KILOS.

MY GOD-ANJA
ONLY WEIGHS 39!



OF COURSE, YOU NEVER KNEW HIM.
HE DIDNT COME OUT
FROM THE WAR.

YES, I KNOW...



BUT WAIT-IF YOU WERE MARRIED IN
FEBRUARY, AND RICHIEV WAS BORN
IN OCTOBER, WAS HE PREMATURE?

YES, A LITTLE...



BUT YOU-AFTER THE
WAR, WHEN YOU WERE
BORN-IT WAS VERY
PREMATURE.
THE DOCTORS
THOUGHT YOU
WOULDN'T
LIVE.



I FOUND A SPECIALIST
WHAT SAVED YOU...
HE HAD TO BREAK YOUR
ARM TO TAKE YOU
OUT FROM
ANJA'S BELLY!



AND WHEN YOU WERE A
TINY BABY YOUR ARM
ALWAYS JUMPED UP LIKE SO!



WE JOKED AND
CALLED YOU
"HEIL HITLER."

ALWAYS WE PUSHED
YOUR ARM DOWN, AND
YOU WOULD
OOPS!



LOOK NOW WHAT YOU
MADE ME DO!

ME? OKAY,
I'LL RE-COUNT
THEM LATER.



NO! YOU DON'T KNOW
COUNTING PILLS.
I'LL DO IT
AFTER...
I'M AN
EXPERT
FOR THIS.



SO... ANJA STAYED
WITH THE FAMILY
AND I WENT TO LIVE
IN BIELSKO FOR MY
FACTORY BUSINESS
AND TO FIND FOR
US AN APARTMENT..

BUT SOON IT CAME FROM SOSNOWIEC A TELEPHONE ...

VLADYK! COME HOME RIGHT
AWAY- ANJA IS SICK!

SHE WAS CRYING AS
SOON I CAME IN ...

WHAT'S
WRONG,
DARLING?

SOB

IT DOESN'T
MATTER...
NOTHING
MATTERS.

BUT WHY
ARE YOU
CRYING?

I DON'T
KNOW!
I HAVE A
GOOD FAMI-
LY... A FINE
SON... I SHOULD
BE HAPPY...

BUT I DON'T CARE.
I JUST DON'T
WANT TO LIVE.

HERE, BABY. DRINK THIS AND REST.

I DON'T UNDERSTAND
WHAT'S THE
MATTER?

GIVING BIRTH WAS TOO MUCH OF
A STRAIN. SHE'S ALWAYS HYSTER-
ICAL OR DEPRESSED... A BREAKDOWN!

PLEASE

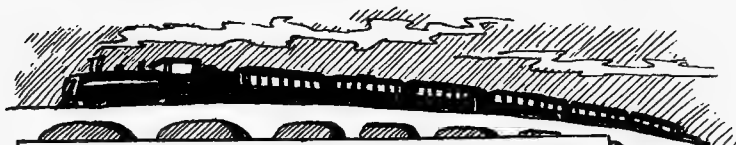
THE DOCTOR TOLD US ABOUT A
SANITARIUM.

... BUT SOMEBODY MUST
GO WITH HER... SOMEONE
SHE TRUSTS.

EVERYTHING'S ARRANGED- THE CHILD
CAN STAY HERE
WITH A GOVERNESS.

...AND I'LL WATCH
YOUR FACTORY.

SOB

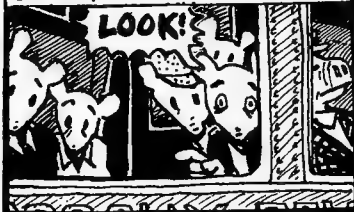


RIGHT AWAY, WE WENT. THE SANITARIUM WAS INSIDE CZECHOSLOVAKIA, ONE OF THE MOST EXPENSIVE AND BEAUTIFUL IN THE WORLD.

I REMEMBER WHEN WE WERE ALMOST ARRIVED, WE PASSED A SMALL TOWN.



EVERYBODY-EVERY JEW FROM THE TRAIN - GOT VERY EXCITED AND FRIGHTENED.



IT WAS THE BEGINNING OF 1938-BEFORE THE WAR-HANGING HIGH IN THE CENTER OF TOWN, IT WAS A NAZI FLAG..



HERE WAS THE FIRST TIME I SAW, WITH MY OWN EYES, THE SWASTIKA.





IN THE EVENINGS
WE WENT EITHER TO
THE THEATER OR TO
DANCE IN THE CAFE.



DID I TELL YOU THE TRAGEDY ABOUT THE PILLOW
MY FAMILY LOST AT THE START OF THE 1914 WAR?

I WAS SEVEN... WE
LIVED TOO CLOSE
TO THE BORDER...
IT WASN'T SAFE...

I TOLD HER MANY JOSES AND STORIES TO
KEEP HER BUSY...

...SO WE TOOK WHAT
WE COULD ON A WAGON PULLED BY FOUR
HORSES AND WENT TO MY GRANDFATHER'S
HOME IN RADOMSKO.



SOMEONE RODE PAST US AND TOLD
US THAT WE'D DROPPED A PILLOW A
FEW MILES BACK.

A GUY TRAVELING TO
AMSTOW PICKED IT UP.



IMAGINE - MY FATHER NEVER
RODE A HORSE BEFORE... BUT
HE UNKITCHED ONE FROM THE
WAGON AND RODE TOWARD AMSTOW.



WE WAITED AND WAITED... MOTHER
STARTED CRYING: "SURELY HE FELL
AND GOT KILLED!" SHE HAD BEGGED
HIM TO "LET THE PILLOW GO AND
TAKE ALL OUR TROUBLES WITH IT!"



THE HORSE WAS BONY AND DIDN'T HAVE
A SADDLE... FINALLY, LATE THAT NIGHT,
FATHER RODE BACK WITH THE PILLOW
... UNDER HIS BLOODY TUCKER...



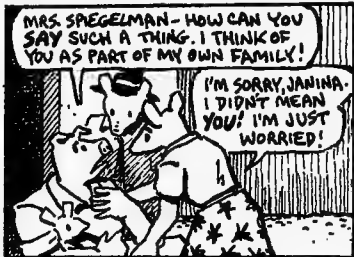
SO, FATHER GOT HIS PILLOW BACK
... BUT HE COULDN'T SIT
DOWN FOR THE REST OF
THE WAR!



I LOVE
YOU, VLADK.

AND SHE WAS SO LAUGHING AND SO HAPPY,
SO HAPPY, THAT SHE APPROACHED EACH
TIME AND KISSED ME, SO HAPPY SHE WAS.











WELL, IT'S ENOUGH FOR TODAY, YES? I'M TIRED AND I MUST COUNT STILL MY PILLS.

OKAY, GOOD IDEA... MY HAND IS SORE FROM WRITING ALL THIS DOWN.



C H A P T E R T H R E E





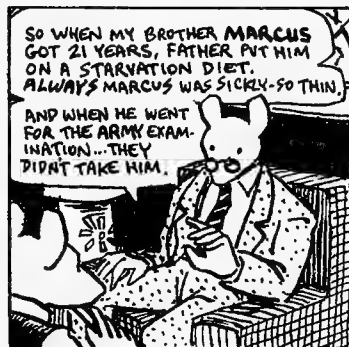
I visited my father more often in order to get more information about his past..

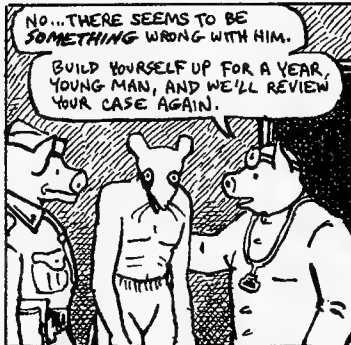




1939? YES...WE WERE GIVEN ARMY TRAININGS FOR A FEW DAYS AND THEN, BY THE START OF SEPTEMBER WE WERE ON THE FRONTIER.







...THE NEXT YEAR FATHER WANTED I WOULD AGAIN DO THE SAME THING. BUT I BEGGED HIM AND AT 22 WENT INTO THE ARMY...

BUT LET'S GET BACK TO 1939!

YES. YOU SEE HOW YOU MIX ME UP?
...IN 1939 WE WERE ON THE FRONTIER,
DIGGED INTO TRENCHES BY A RIVER.

IT WAS QUIET UNTIL NEAR MORNING. THEN I HEARD SHOOTING ON BOTH SIDES.

AN OFFICER SNEAKED OVER TO ME.

DIG IN DEEPER.
YOU'LL GET KILLED.

YOUR GUN IS COLD!
WHY AREN'T YOU SHOOTING?

I DIDN'T SEE AT WHAT TO SHOOT...

KPOK!
KPOK!
KPOK!

...BUT I DIGGED DEEPER
AND STARTED TO SHOOT!

THEN BULLETS CAME
IN MY DIRECTION.



I DUG DEEPER MY TRENCH
BUT I STOPPED TO SHOOT.



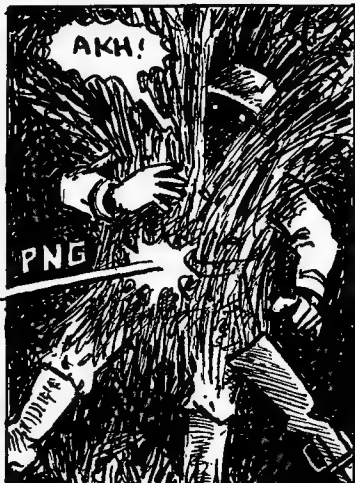
BUT WHEN I LOOKED IN
MY GUN, I SAW... A TREE!!!



AND THE TREE WAS ACTUALLY MOVING!



WELL, IF IT MOVED, I HAD TO SHOOT!



IT HELD UP A HAND TO SHOW
IT WAS HURT. TO SURRENDER.



BUT I KEPT SHOOTING AND SHOOTING, UNTIL FINALLY THE TREE STOPPED MOVING.
WHO KNOWS; OTHERWISE HE COULD HAVE SHOT ME!

AFTER TWO HOURS OF FIGHTING, THE NAZIS
OVERCAME OUR SIDE OF THE RIVER.

GET
UP!



GIVE ME YOUR GUN!



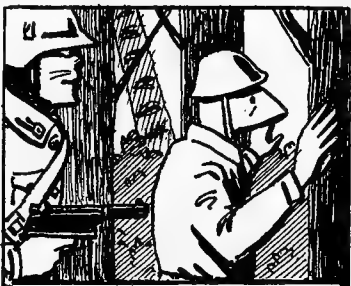
IT'S HOT! YOU WERE SHOOTING AT US!



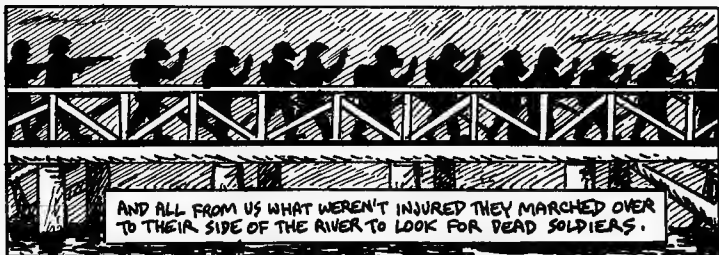
MY COMMANDER MADE ME SHOOT.
I ONLY FIRED IN THE AIR!



I ANSWERED IN GERMAN AND HIS PART-
NER STOPPED HIM FROM BEATING ME.



THEY MARCHED ME TO WHERE IT WAS
MORE LIKE ME. WAR PRISONERS.



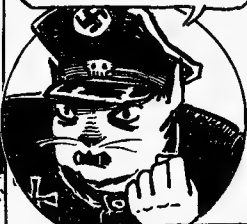
AND ALL FROM US WHAT WEREN'T INJURED THEY MARCHED OVER
TO THEIR SIDE OF THE RIVER TO LOOK FOR DEAD SOLDIERS.



THEY TOOK US TO A PLACE NEAR NUREMBERG WHERE IT WAS MANY WAR PRISONERS. THE JEWS THEY MADE TO STAND SEPARATE.



WE SHOULD HANG YOU RIGHT HERE ON THIS SPOT!



OF COURSE, NOBODY OF US SAID A WORD.



HE CAME UP TO ME... I HAD MAYBE 300 ZLOTYS.



DO YOU EXPECT TO DO SOME BUSINESS HERE? SHOW ME YOUR HANDS!



ANOTHER GERMAN TOOK 4 OR 5 FROM US TO A STABLE.

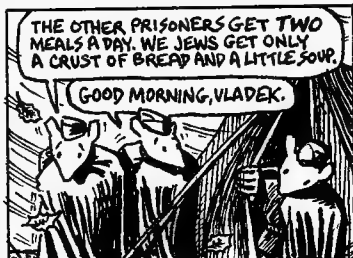


WE REALLY WORKED VERY HARD.
BUT, AN HOUR LATER...





TO KEEP WARM WE HAD ONLY OUR SUMMER UNIFORMS AND A THIN BLANKET.



MANY OTHERS GOT FROSTBITE WOUNDS. IN THE WOUNDS WAS PUS, AND IN THE PUS WAS LICE.

EVERY DAY I BATHED AND DID GYMNASTICS TO KEEP STRONG. ...AND EVERY DAY WE PRAYED.



OFTEN WE PLAYED CHESS TO KEEP OUR MINDS BUSY AND MAKE THE TIME GO.



AND ONE TIME A WEEK WE COULD WRITE LETTERS THROUGH THE INTERNATIONAL RED CROSS.



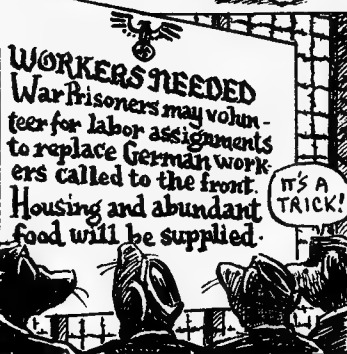
AND THROUGH THIS IT CAME A PACKAGE...



I HAD A SIGN MY FAMILY WAS SAFE, AND—BECAUSE I NEVER SMOKED—I HAD CIGARETTES TO TRADE FOR FOOD.

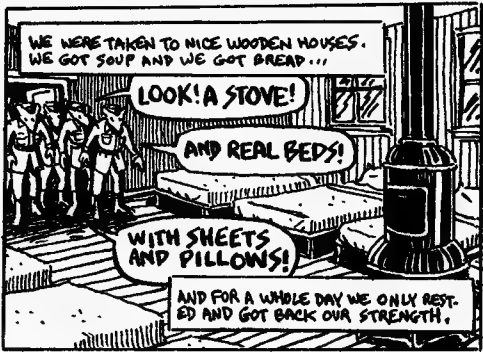


AND SO THINGS WENT FOR MAYBE SIX WEEKS, THEN...





WE WERE RIGHT AWAY SENT
TO A BIG GERMAN COMPANY.



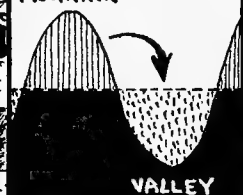
THE NEXT DAY WE WERE GIVEN SHOVELS AND PICKS ...



AND THE WORK WAS REALLY VERY HARD-
WE HAD TO MOVE MOUNTAINS.



MOUNTAIN



VALLEY

THE HILLS WERE MAYBE
3 OR 4 YARDS HIGH. WE
HAD TO MAKE IT LEVEL.

SOME COMPLAINED -THOSE WHAT WERE
TOO OLD OR WEAK FOR SUCH WORK:



BUT WHAT HAP-
PENED TO THEM,
I DON'T KNOW.

STILL, EIGHTY PER CENT STAYED. THERE WAS ENOUGH
TO EAT, AND A WARM BED. IT WAS BETTER TO STAY...



...ALWAYS I WENT TO SLEEP EXHAUSTED.
AND ONE NIGHT I HAD A DREAM...

A VOICE WAS TALKING TO ME. IT WAS,
I THINK, MY DEAD GRANDFATHER...



IT WAS SO REAL, THIS VOICE...



SO WHAT'S
PARSHAS TRUMA?

EACH WEEK, ON SAT-
URDAY, WE READ A SEC-
TION FROM THE TORAH.

THIS IS SO CALLED - A PARSHA...
AND ONE WEEK EACH YEAR IT IS
PARSHAS TRUMA.



BEFORE WORK A FEW
FROM US PRAYED. IT WAS
A RABBI THERE WITH US.

ONE MOMENT, RABBI.
WHEN WILL WE
READ PARSHAS TRUMA?

PARSHAS TRUMA?



...IN THE MIDDLE OF FEB-
RUARY - ALMOST THREE
MONTHS FROM NOW. WHY?



I TOLD HIM MY DREAM...

LET'S HOPE IT'S TRUE.
I'M AFRAID WE'LL NEVER
GET OUT OF HERE.

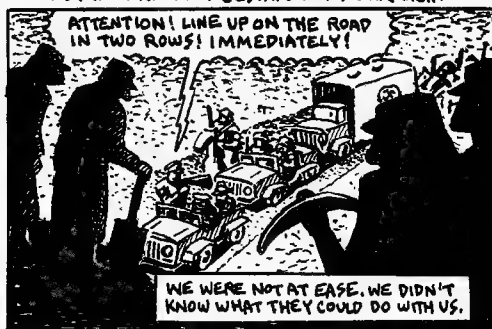




UNTIL, ONE TIME...



IT CAME VERY MANY GESTAPO AND WEHRMACHT.



I STOOD ALWAYS IN THE SECOND LINE.



SOMEONE SNEAKED NEXT TO ME...



SATURDAY, OF COURSE.





DURING THE JOURNEY I SAT WITH THE RABBI.

SO, MY SON. NOW I SEE YOU ARE A "ROH-EH HANDED," ONE WHO SEES WHAT THE FUTURE WILL BRING.



YOU SEE, THE NAZIS DIVIDED POLAND INTO PIECES: PROTECTORATE AND REICH, WITH A GUARDED BORDER BETWEEN.



HEY! THIS TRAIN SEEMS TO BE PASSING SOSNOWIEC!



WHEN THEY DIDN'T STOP THE TRAIN I BECAME VERY WORRIED.

THE TRAIN WENT COMPLETELY PAST MY PART OF POLAND—THE REICH—AND STOPPED ONLY IN THE PROTECTORATE.

THOSE WITH PAPERS FOR KRAKOW—OUT!



AND, WHEN IT STOPPED IN WARSAW, THE RABBI GOT OUT.

I'LL WRITE TO YOU.



BUT I NEVER HEARD AGAIN FROM HIM. IT CAME SUCH A MISERY IN WARSAW, ALMOST NONE SURVIVED.

AND THE TRAIN WAS A LONG WAY PAST SOSNOWIEC. THEY TOOK ME UP, UP, VERY FAR—MAYBE 300 MILES—UNTIL WE CAME TO LUBLIN. THERE THEY UNLOADED ALL OF US FROM THE REICH.

IN LUBLIN, THEY TOOK US TO BIG TENTS...



EVENTUALLY CAME SOME PEOPLE TO SEE US FROM THE JEWISH AUTHORITIES...



...TWO DAYS AGO THE NAZIS MARCHED THEM TO A FOREST...



...AND THEY SHOT ALL OF THEM- THEY KILLED 600 PEOPLE!



I THOUGHT YOU WERE RELEASED AS A PRISONER OF WAR!

EXACTLY SO...



INTERNATIONAL LAWS PROTECTED US A LITTLE AS POLISH WAR PRISONERS. BUT A JEW OF THE REICH ANYONE COULD KILL IN THE STREETS!





THEN WE HEARD SOMETHING TO GIVE US A LITTLE HOPE...

WE'VE BRIBED THE GERMANS TO RELEASE PRISONERS INTO THE HOMES OF LOCAL JEWS WHO WILL CLAIM YOU AS RELATIVES.



MY NAME'S SPIEGELMAN. THERE'S A FRIEND OF MY FAMILY NAMED ORSBACH IN LUBLIN. I MET HIM WHEN I WAS HERE FOR ARMY TRAINING.

FINE! WE'LL TRY TO REGISTER YOU AS HIS COUSIN.



THAT NIGHT I WENT OUT FROM THE TENT...



I HAD TO URINATE.



I RAN QUICK INSIDE



AND THOUGHT ALL NIGHT DIFFERENT THINGS WHAT COULD HAPPEN TO US.

AND A GUARD BEGAN SHOOTING TO ME.

THEN AS SOON AS IT WAS LIGHT.



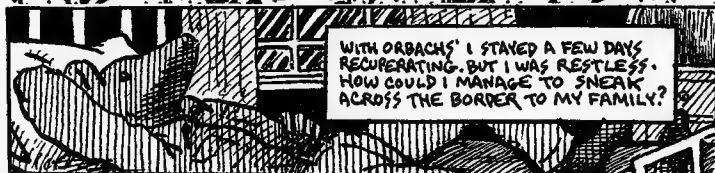
ORBACH WAS A FRIEND FROM MY UNCLE— HE HAD
TWO BEAUTIFUL DAUGHTERS NEAR TO MY AGE.



EVENTUALLY, WHEN I
CAME AGAIN TO SOSNO-
WIEC, WE SENT THEM
FOOD PACKAGES...

... WE WERE FOR A WHILE
A LITTLE BETTER OFF...
AND THEY WROTE BACK
VERY HAPPY HOW IT
HELPED SURVIVE THEM...

... THEN THEY WROTE THAT
THE GERMANS WERE
KEEPING THE PACKAGES,
AND THEN THEY STOPPED
TO WRITE.
FINISHED.



TRAINS WERE STILL GOING FROM PROTECTORATE TO REICH. ONLY, ONE NEEDED LEGAL PAPERS. OF COURSE, THIS I DIDN'T HAVE ...



...BUT ANYWAY I GOT ON THE TRAIN IN THE DIRECTION I WANTED.

I APPROACHED TO THE TRAIN MAN, A POLE...

MAY I TALK TO YOU FOR A MOMENT?



SURE, SOLDIER.

I STILL HAD ON MY ARMY UNIFORM, AND I DIDN'T LET KNOW I WAS A JEW.

YOU'RE A POLE LIKE ME, SO I CAN TRUST YOU... THE STINKING NAZIS HAD ME IN A WAR PRISON... I JUST ESCAPED.



THE POLES WERE VERY BITTER ON THE GERMANS, SO IT WAS GOOD TO SPEAK BAD OF THEM.

I'M TRYING TO GET TO SOSNOWIEC - BACK TO MY FAMILY.

DON'T WORRY... WHEN WE GET TO THE BORDER, HIDE IN HERE.



AND SO THE TRAIN MAN HELPED ME COME BACK TO MY SIDE OF POLAND.



I WALKED FIRST OVER TO MY PARENTS' HOUSE...

...WHAT I THOUGHT I MIGHT NEVER SEE AGAIN.



OY GEVAULT!
IT'S VLADEK!



AT 7:00 IT WAS A RULE. ALL JEWS HAD TO BE IN THEIR HOME AND ALL LIGHTS OUT.

FROM MY PARENTS' TO SOŚNOWIEC WAS ONLY A SHORT RIDE.

GO IN AND SAY YOU JUST GOT A LETTER FROM ME SAYING I'D BE HOME IN A WEEK.



I STOOD AT THE DOOR, LISTENING...

DON'T JOKE! IF VLADEK WAS COMING HOME, HE'D HAVE WRITTEN TO US TOO!



SURPRISE!

OH MY GOD.



VLADEK!



I GRABBED MY SON. HE WAS 2½ YEARS.

RICHIEU!

BWAAH



HE STARTED SCREAMING.

WHY DO YOU CRY, MY BOY? I'M YOUR FATHER!

WAH



SNFF TH' BUTTONS. YOUR METAL BUTTONS, DADDY—THEY'RE COLD!

AND I DON'T NEED TO TELL YOU HOW BIG THE JOY WAS IN OUR HOUSE.

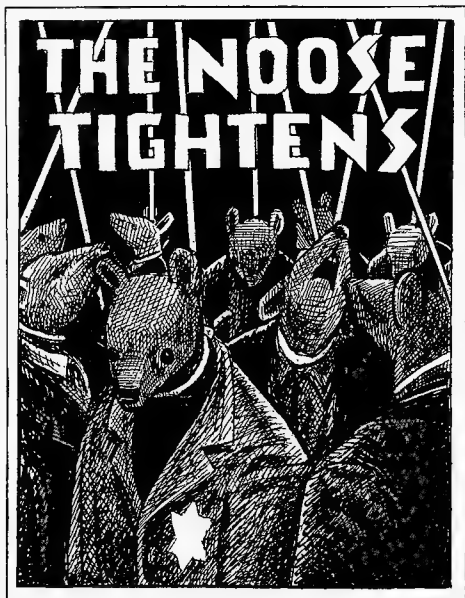








C H A P T E R F O U R







IT WAS TWELVE OF US LIVING IN FATHER-IN-LAW'S HOUSEHOLD...



IT WAS ANJA AND ME, AND OUR BOY, RICHIEU...



ANJA'S OLDER SISTER, TOSHA, HER HUSBAND, WOLFE, AND THEIR LITTLE GIRL, BIBI...



AND IT WAS ANJA'S GRANDPARENTS. THEY HAD MAYBE 90 YEARS, BUT VERY ALERT...



AND, OF COURSE, IT WAS MY FATHER-IN-LAW AND MY MOTHER-IN-LAW...



AND ALSO THE 2 KIDS FROM YOUR UNCLE HERMAN AND AUNT HELEN: LOLEK AND LONIA







I WENT THE NEXT DAY TO MODRZEJOWSKA STREET. HERE PEOPLE STILL MADE MONEY, FROM SECRET BUSINESSES... NOT SO LEGAL...



I WENT THEN TO SHOPS WHAT STILL OWED ME MONEY FROM BEFORE THE WAR...



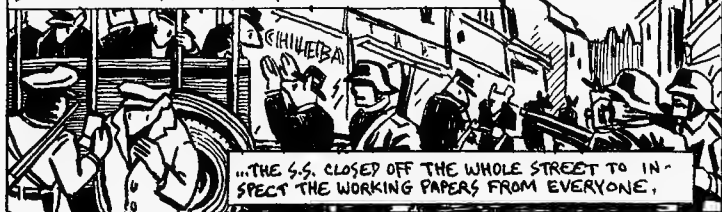
THE NOTE TOLD THAT I WORKED WITH HIM. SUCH A PAPER COULD BE USEFUL TO HAVE.



I REMEMBER, FATHER-IN-LAW WAS SO HAPPY WITH ME.



A LITTLE LATER I WAS AGAIN ON MODRZEJOWSKA, LOOKING TO BUY SOME TEXTILES WITHOUT COUPONS...



...THE S.S. CLOSED OFF THE WHOLE STREET TO INSPECT THE WORKING PAPERS FROM EVERYONE.

I DIDN'T KNOW BEFORE ABOUT THIS.



I MANAGED TO DISAPPEAR INTO A BUILDING.



BUT THEY TOOK MAYBE 50% OF THE PEOPLE AWAY.



I TALKED ABOUT IT TO FATHER-IN-LAW...

THEY ALMOST GOT ME! I'LL NEED MORE THAN JUST ILZECKI'S NOTE!

IT'S TRUE.



COME... WE'LL VISIT A FRIEND OF MINE WHO OWNS A TIN SHOP. I THINK HIS OVERSEER CAN BE BRIBED.



AND SO IT WENT... OKAY, VLADEK...

SINCE WE MAKE THINGS FOR GERMANY WE CAN GET YOU A PRIORITY WORK CARD.



REMEMBER, IF THERE'S A ROUND-UP, RUN IN HERE AND PRETEND YOU'RE WORKING.



I LEARNED HERE TO DO THINGS WHAT WERE USEFUL TO ME WHEN I CAME TO AUSCHWITZ.

AND SO WE LIVED FOR MORE THAN A YEAR. BUT ALWAYS THINGS CAME A LITTLE WORSE. A LITTLE WORSE...



FATHER-IN-LAW HAD A NICE NEW BEDROOM SET...



WOLFE AND I SLEPPED EVERYTHING VALUABLE DOWNSTAIRS FOR A POLISH NEIGHBOR TO HIDE.

ANJA'S MOTHER HAD GALLSTONES. THE DAY THE GERMANS CAME SHE LAY IN THE BED.

OOH, ARE WE LEAVING THE OTHER BED UPSTAIRS?

JA. MOTHER-IN-LAW IS TOO SICK. SHE NEEDS A GOOD BED.



PLEASE DON'T TAKE HER BED-LOOK AT HOW SICK SHE IS.

THE DOCTOR IS HERE EVERY DAY.



FATHER-IN-LAW HAD AN OLD FRIEND WHO CAME ALWAYS OVER TO PLAY CARDS.

HIDDEN, WE HAD NO USE FROM THE FURNITURE. SO WE SLEPPED IT AGAIN UPSTAIRS TO SELL.

...AND THEY LEFT WITHOUT TAKING ANYTHING!

YOU KNOW, I MET A GERMAN OFFICIAL WHO WOULD PAY WELL FOR A BEDROOM SET...



YOU HAVE EXCELLENT TASTE IN FURNITURE, HERR ZYLBERBERG. THANK YOU.



MY MEN WILL BE RIGHT BACK TO GET YOUR WIFE'S BED TOO!..



YOU CHEATED US LAST TIME, JEW!

WAIT! I HAVEN'T BEEN PAID, YET.

PLEASE, IF YOU WANT TO STAY ALIVE GO BACK INSIDE.



HE WAS SO UNHAPPY AFTER. SO UNHAPPY!



WILL I WALK SLOWLY, THEY WILL TAKE ME...

WILL I RUN THEY CAN SHOOT ME!

THEN FROM FAR, I SAW ILZECKI WALKING, SO I WENT HASTY OVER TO HIM.



ILZECKI HAD A SON THE SAME AGE LIKE RICHIEU. IF YOU ONLY COULD SEE HOW THOSE CHILDREN PLAYED TOGETHER.



WE CAN'T KNOW WHAT'S GOING TO HAPPEN TO US - BUT WE MUST KEEP OUR CHILDREN SAFE.



I HAVE A GOOD FRIEND, A POLE, WHO'S WILLING TO HIDE MY SON UNTIL THE SITUATION GETS BETTER.



...I THINK HE'D TAKE YOUR BOY TOO.

YES, YOU MAY BE RIGHT. LET ME SPEAK WITH MY FAMILY.



BUT, I'M TELLING YOU, IT WAS SOMETHING **TERRIBLE** GOING ON IN OUR HOUSE WHEN I EVEN MENTIONED IT.

WHAT? HAVE YOU GONE CRAZY?

HOW CAN YOU EVEN THINK OF GIVING RICHIEU UP TO COMPLETE STRANGERS?!



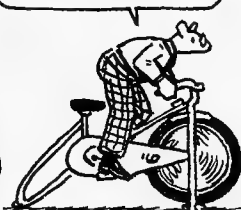
I'LL NEVER GIVE UP MY BABY. NEVER!



ILZECKI AND HIS WIFE DIDN'T COME OUT FROM THE WAR.



...BUT HIS SON REMAINED ALIVE; OURS DID NOT.



...AND **ANYWAY** WE HAD TO GIVE RICHIEU TO HIDE A YEAR LATER.



WHEN WE WERE IN THE GHETTO, IN 1943, TOSHA TOOK ALL THE CHILDREN TO-

WAIT! PLEASE, DAD, IF YOU DON'T KEEP YOUR STORY CHRONOLOGICAL, I'LL NEVER GET IT STRAIGHT ... TELL ME MORE ABOUT 1941 AND 1942.

SO?... OKAY. I'LL MAKE IT SO HOW YOU WANT IT. 1941?... AT THE END OF 1941 THE GERMANS CAME WITH SOMETHING NEW. WOLFE RAN FROM THE GEMEINDER...

LOOK! THEY'RE PUTTING THESE UP ALL OVER TOWN.

ORDER
All Jews of Sosnowiec must be relocated into the stara Sosnowiec quarter by January 1, 1942. Non-Jews will be moved into vacated premises.
Marek Marcin

ALL 12 OF OUR HOUSEHOLD WERE GIVEN NOW TO LIVE IN 2½ SMALL ROOMS...

KEWARD
FOR EVERY UNREGISTERED JEW YOU FIND: 1 KILO of SUGAR

MOST PEOPLE GOT EVEN LESS SPACE. BUT FATHER-IN-LAW AND WOLFE HAD A LITTLE INFLUENCE...

BUT THIS WASN'T YET A REAL GHETTO. STILL YOU COULD GO INTO OTHER PARTS OF TOWN SO LONG YOU WERE HOME AT NIGHT-TIME

HOLD THE LADDER, ANJA.

I'M PUTTING UP A CURTAIN TO GIVE US SOME PRIVACY.

TOSHA INSISTED ON GETTING THE PART OF THE ROOM WITH THE WINDOW.

IT DOESN'T MATTER, VLADEK. I'M JUST GLAD THE WHOLE FAMILY CAN STAY TOGETHER.

IT WAS NO MORE THE LUXURY LIFE WE HAD BEFORE.

FOR A COUPLE MONTHS I DID HERE STILL MY BLACK MARKET BUSINESS. THEN CAME MORE BAD NEWS, VERY BAD...

WHAT'S WRONG, FATHER?

THEY JUST ARRESTED MY FRIEND, NAHUM COHN, AND HIS SON.



THEY'VE TAKEN FOUR JEWS AWAY FOR DEALING GOODS WITHOUT COUPONS.

I DID MUCH BUSINESS WITH COHN!



THE GERMANS INTEND TO MAKE AN EXAMPLE OF THEM!

THE NEXT DAY I WALKED OVER TO MODRZEJOWSKA STREET AND I SAW THEM...



THEY HANGED THERE ONE FULL WEEK.



COHN HAD A DRY GOODS STORE. HE WAS KNOWN OVER ALL SOSNOWIEC. OFTEN HE GAVE ME CLOTH WITH NO COUPONS.



I TRADED ALSO WITH PFEFER, A FINE YOUNG MAN-A ZIONIST. HE WAS JUST MARRIED. HIS WIFE RAN SCREAMING IN THE STREET.

I WAS FRIGHTENED TO GO OUTSIDE FOR A FEW DAYS... I DIDN'T WANT TO PASS WHERE THEY WERE HANGING.



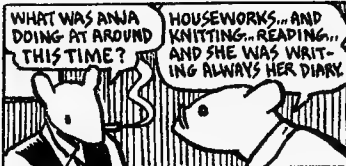
AND MAYBE ONE OF THEM COULD HAVE TALKED OF ME TO THE GERMANS TO TRY TO SAVE HIMSELF.

ACH. WHEN I THINK NOW OF THEM, IT STILL MAKES ME CRY... LOOK—EVEN FROM MY DEAD EYE TEARS ARE COMING OUT!



WHAT WAS ANJA DOING AT AROUND THIS TIME?

HOUSEWORKS... AND KNITTING... READING... AND SHE WAS WRITING ALWAYS HER DIARY.



I USED TO SEE POLISH NOTEBOOKS AROUND THE HOUSE AS A KID. WERE THOSE HER DIARIES?

YES, AND ALSO NO.



HER DIARIES DIDN'T SURVIVE FROM THE WAR. WHAT YOU SAW SHE WROTE AFTER: HER WHOLE STORY FROM THE START.

OHMIGOD! WHERE ARE THEY? I NEED THOSE FOR THIS BOOK!



COFF! PLEASE, ARTIE, STOP WITH THE SMOKING. IT MAKES ME SHORT WITH BREATH.

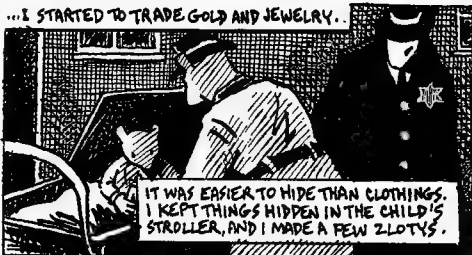
I THINK IT'S ALL YOUR PEDALING!



DON'T BE SO SMART! "WHAT I WAS TELLING YOU? YES..." AFTER THE HANGING I LOOKED FOR ANOTHER BUSINESS...



...I STARTED TO TRADE GOLD AND JEWELRY...



IT WAS EASIER TO HIDE THAN CLOTHINGS. I KEPT THINGS HIDDEN IN THE CHILD'S STROLLER, AND I MADE A FEW ZLOTYS.

FOR A WHILE I HAD ALSO
A FOOD BUSINESS THAT
I DIDN'T YET TELL YOU...



I MET SZKLARCZYK. HE HAD A BIG GROCERY ON MODRZEJOWSKA..



SO, TOGETHER WE SAT AND SPOKE, AND HE
HELPED, FROM TIME TO TIME, A CUSTOMER...



THEN A LITTLE MORE WE SPOKE AND HE
MADE TO ME A PROPOSITION...



WHEN SOMEBODY IS HUNGRY
HE LOOKS FOR BUSINESS...



ONE TIME I HAD 10 OR 15
KILOS SUGAR TO DELIVER...



WHAT WAS I SUPPOSED TO SAY?
FOR THIS I COULD REALLY HANG!



BUT WHEN WE CAME TO STARA SOSNOWIEC, ALL MY BUSINESSES BECAME HARDER... IT WAS NOT SO EASY TO MOVE AROUND.



THE TIN SHOP FINISHED—THE OWNER WAS THE ONLY JEW THEY LET WORK THERE. I GOT THEN A JOB IN A GERMAN CARPENTRY SHOP.



FATHER-IN-LAW AND LOLEK WORKED ALREADY THERE, FOR REALLY NO MONEY. I DIDN'T NEED THIS BEFORE, BUT NOW I HAD TO HAVE THE WORK PAPER.



WOLFE COULD HAVE ARRANGED ME A JOB AT THE GEMEINDE... BUT I DIDN'T WANT TO PUT MY HANDS THERE WHERE JEWS WERE BEING TAKEN.



AND THEN IT CAME AGAIN SOMETHING NEW FROM THE GERMANS. WE GOT A NOTICE...

"ALL JEWS OVER 70 YEARS OLD WILL BE TRANSFERRED TO THERESIENSTADT IN CZECHOSLOVAKIA ON MAY 10, 1942..."

"...A COMMUNITY BETTER PREPARED TO TAKE CARE OF THE ELDERLY THAN OURS IN SOSNOWIEC..."



IT DOESN'T LOOK TOO BAD! LIKE A CONVALESCENT HOME.



ANJA'S GRANDPARENTS HAD ABOUT 90 YEARS.

WE'VE BEEN TOGETHER—A FAMILY—FOR 70 YEARS. WE DON'T WANT TO BREAK APART NOW!

DON'T WORRY. WE WON'T LET THEM TAKE YOU.



WE DIDN'T YET KNOW OF AUSCHWITZ—OF THE OVENS—BUT WE WERE ANYWAY AFRAID.

...SO, IN THE YARD, WE MADE A HIDING PLACE, A BUNKER...

CUT-AWAY VIEW:

STORAGE SHEDS

FALSE WALL

GRAND-PARENTS

WE SNEAKED FOOD TO THEM, AND—WHEN IT WAS SAFE—WE TOOK THEM INSIDE A LITTLE.



SEVERAL TIMES CAME THE JEWISH POLICE TO OUR HOUSE...

OUR RECORDS SHOW THAT MR. AND MRS. KARMIO LIVE HERE. THEY HAVEN'T REGISTERED FOR TRANSFER.

YES - MY WIFE'S PARENTS - THEY LEFT WITHOUT A WORD A MONTH AGO.

JEWISH POLICE?

YES - WITH BIG STICKS.



SOME JEWS THOUGHT IN THIS WAY: IF THEY GAVE TO THE GERMANS A FEW JEWS, THEY COULD SAVE THE REST.

AND AT LEAST THEY COULD SAVE THEMSELVES.



AND A MONTH AFTER, THEY AGAIN CAME TO FATHER-IN-LAW.

MR. ZYLBERBERG, YOU AND YOUR WIFE MUST COME WITH US.

IF THE KARMIOS DON'T TURN UP IN 3 DAYS YOU TWO WILL BE SENT IN THEIR PLACE!



WE HAD STILL A LITTLE "PROTECTION" FROM THE GEMEINDE, SO THEY TOOK ONLY HIM AWAY - NOT HIS WIFE.



HE SAT A FEW DAYS THERE, THEN HE SENT TO US A NOTE

HE WROTE THAT WE HAD TO GIVE OVER THE GRANDPARENTS. EVEN IF THEY TOOK ONLY HIM AWAY NOW, NEXT THEY WOULD GRAB HIS WIFE, AND THEN THE REST OF THE FAMILY.



SO, WHAT HAPPENED?

WHAT HAPPENED? WE HAD TO DELIVER THEM!



THEY THOUGHT IT WAS TO THERESIENSTADT THEY WERE GOING.

LET US KNOW IF YOU NEED ANYTHING!



BUT THEY WENT RIGHT AWAY TO AUSCHWITZ, TO THE GAS.

WHEN DID YOU FIRST HEAR ABOUT AUSCHWITZ?

RIGHT AWAY WE HEARD...



EVEN FROM THERE - FROM THAT OTHER WORLD-PEOPLE CAME BACK AND TOLD US. BUT WE DIDN'T BELIEVE.



THEN THIS SAME NEWS CAME MORE AND MORE, SO WE BELIEVED, AND LATER ON, WE SAW ... EVEN WORSE!



AFTER WHAT HAPPENED TO THE GRANDPARENTS IT WAS A FEW MONTHS QUIET. THEN IT CAME POSTERS EVERYWHERE AND SPEECHES FROM THE GEMEINDE...

FELLOW JEWS: ON WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 12TH, EVERY ONE OF YOU, YOUNG AND OLD, MALE AND FEMALE, HEALTHY AND SICK, MUST REGISTER AT THE DIENST STADIUM...



OH NO!

NOW WHAT?

...THERE'S NO CAUSE FOR ALARM-IT'S ONLY A MATTER OF INSPECTING YOUR DOCUMENTS AND STAMPING THEM. THIS WILL PROTECT YOU AS CITIZENS OF THE REGION!...

I'M NOT GOING. IT'S A NAZI TRAP!...



EVERYBODY WAS WORRIED.

...AND OUR JEWISH COMMITTEE IS HELPING THOSE MURDERERS. GOD KNOWS WHAT WILL HAPPEN TO US AT THE STADIUM!

WELL, THEY JUST INSPECTED JEWISH DOCUMENTS IN SOME NEARBY TOWNS. IT WAS NO BIG DEAL.



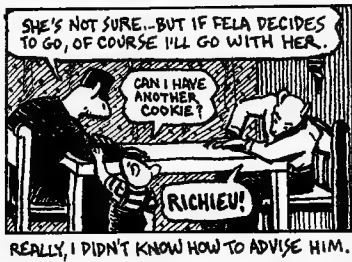
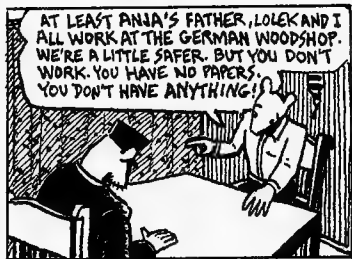
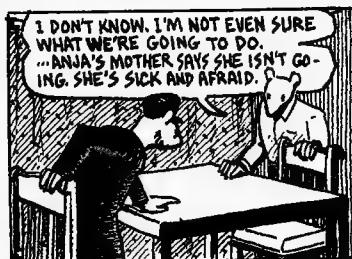
ANYWAY, WE'VE GOT TO GO. WITHOUT LEGAL PAPERS, WE'RE LOST!

TO GO, IT WAS NO GOOD. BUT, NOT TO GO - IT WAS ALSO NO GOOD.

MY FATHER-HE HAD 62 YEARS-CAME BY STREETCAR TO ME FROM DABROWA, THE VILLAGE NEXT DOOR FROM SOSNOWIEC.



AFTER MY MOTHER DIED WITH CANCER, HE LIVED THERE IN THE HOUSE OF MY SISTER FELA, AND HER FOUR SMALL CHILDREN.





WHEN WE WERE EVERYBODY INSIDE, GESTAPO WITH MACHINE GUNS SURROUNDED THE STADIUM.



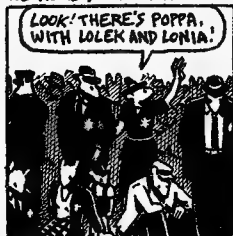
THEN WAS A SELECTION, WITH PEOPLE SENT EITHER TO THE LEFT, EITHER TO THE RIGHT.



ME AND ANJA CAME TO THE TABLE WHERE MY COUSIN WAS SITTING...



WE WERE SO HAPPY WE CAME THROUGH. BUT WE WORRIED NOW- WERE OUR FAMILIES SAFE?



BUT LATER SOMEONE WHO SAW HIM TOLD ME... HE CAME THROUGH THIS SAME COUSIN OVER TO THE GOOD SIDE.



HER, THEY SENT TO THE LEFT. FOUR CHILDREN WAS TOO MANY.



AND, WHAT DO YOU THINK? HE SNEAKED ON TO THE BAD SIDE!

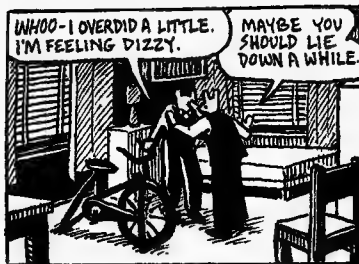


THOSE WITH A STAMP WERE LET TO GO HOME. BUT THERE WERE VERY FEW JEWS NOW LEFT IN SOSNOWIEC ...



WELL... IT'S ENOUGH FOR TODAY. YES, ARTIE?...





EVENTUALLY SHE AND MY FATHER BOTH ENDED UP IN AUSCHWITZ. THEY DIED THERE.



WHERE ARE YOU GOING? YOU DIDN'T DRINK YOUR COFFEE.



I JUST THOUGHT OF SOMETHING. MY FATHER MENTIONED THAT ANJA USED TO KEEP A DIARY, AND I VAGUELY REMEMBER SEEING THEM ON HIS SHELVES IN THE DEN.



I DOUBT IT. I WOULD HAVE NOTICED THEM.



WELL, THERE'S SO MUCH JUNK IN THERE, IT'S WORTH A SHOT.



LOOK AT ALL THIS STUFF! ... OLD MENUS HE PICKED UP ON CRUISES... A PILE OF STATIONERY FROM THE PINES HOTEL...



INCREDIBLE! FOUR 1965 DRY DOCK SAVINGS BANK CALENDARS... I'LL BET HE NEVER EVEN HAD AN ACCOUNT THERE.



HE DRIVES ME CRAZY! HE WON'T EVEN LET ME THROW OUT THE PLASTIC PITCHER HE TOOK FROM HIS HOSPITAL ROOM LAST YEAR!



HE'S MORE ATTACHED TO THINGS THAN TO PEOPLE!



I REALLY DON'T KNOW HOW LONG I CAN TAKE HIM. I REALLY DON'T.



I BETTER BE GETTING HOME. I'LL LOOK FOR THOSE DIARIES NEXT TIME.

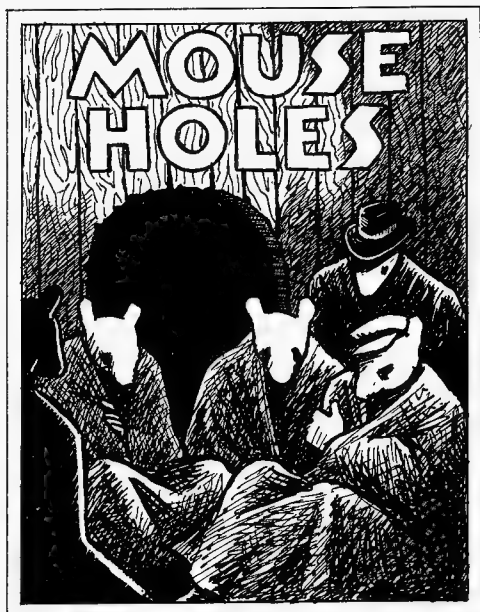


WAIT! PUT EVERYTHING BACK EXACTLY LIKE IT WAS, OR I'LL NEVER HEAR THE END OF IT!



OKAY...
OKAY...
RELAX.

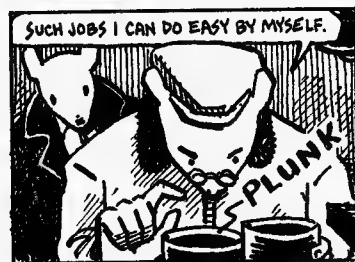
C H A P T E R F I V E







About a week later, early afternoon...



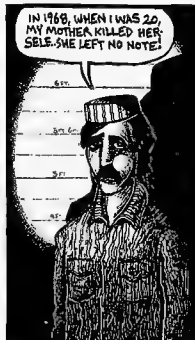
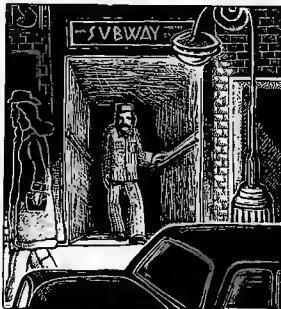




MY FATHER FOUND HER WHEN HE GOT HOME FROM WORK... HER WRISTS SLASHED AND AN EMPTY BOTTLE OF PILLS NEARBY...



I WAS LIVING WITH MY PARENTS, AS I AGREED TO DO ON MY RELEASE FROM THE STATE MENTAL HOSPITAL 3 MONTHS BEFORE.



I'D JUST SPENT THE WEEKEND WITH MY GIRLFRIEND, ISABELLA. (MY PARENTS DIDN'T LIKE HER.) I WAS LATE GETTING HOME...



I SUPPOSE THAT IF I'D GOTTEN HOME WHEN EXPECTED, I WOULD HAVE FOUND HER BODY...



WHEN I SAW THE CROWD I HAD A PANG OF FEAR... I SUSPECTED THE WORST, BUT DIDN'T LET MYSELF KNOW!

A COUSIN HERDED ME AWAY FROM THE SCENE.

DOCTOR DRENS LIVED NEARBY...

YOUR MOTHER KILLED HER-
SELF—SHE'S DEAD!



COME TO THE DOCTOR'S...
YOUR MOTHER IS -AH- SICK!...
HE WILL EXPLAIN.....



SIT DOWN, ARTHUR... I
THOUGHT I SHOULD BE
THE ONE TO TELL YOU...



I COULD AVOID THE TRUTH NO LONGER—THE DOCTOR'S WORDS CLATTERED INSIDE
ME.... I FELT CONFUSED, I FELT ANGRY, I FELT NUMB! ... I DIDN'T EXACTLY FEEL
LIKE CRYING, BUT FIGURED I SHOULD!...



NOW, NOW, BOY...

NO, LET HIM
CRY... IT'S GOOD
FOR HIM!

WE WENT HOME...MY FATHER HAD COM-
PLETELY FALLEN APART!...

I WAS EXPECTED TO
COMFORT HIM!

SOMEHOW THE FUNERAL ARRANGE-
MENTS WERE MADE...



OH, ARTIE! WHY? WHY?
SUCH A TRAGEDY! AND
NOT EVEN A NOTE!!!



MOTHER...
MOTHER...



...AND FOR \$950** WE HAVE A
BRONZE CASSET WITH BRONZE-
COLORED VELVET... OF COURSE.
FOR \$2,000** WE CAN...

PROTECT
WHAT YOU
HAVE

THAT NIGHT WAS BAD...
MY FATHER INSISTED WE
SLEEP ON THE FLOOR-AN OLD
JEWISH CUSTOM, I GUESS.
HE HELD ME AND MOANED
TO HIMSELF ALL NIGHT.
I WAS UNCOMFORTABLE...
WE WERE SCARED!



THE NEXT DAY AT THE FUNERAL HOME WAS WORSE...



MY FATHER FOUGHT FOR SELF-CONTROL AND PRAYED...
I WAS PRETTY SPACED OUT IN THOSE DAYS - I RECITED
TO MY MOTHER FROM THE TIBETAN BOOK OF THE DEAD!

די ברא ברענטה וימליך...

"O NOBLY BORN... IN YOUR
JOURNEY THROUGH THE FORM-
LESS VOID, REMEMBER THE
UNITY OF ALL LIVING THINGS..."



A FRIEND OF THE FAMILY FOUND ME OUT IN THE HALL...



I FELT NAUSEOUS THE GUILT WAS OVERWHELMING!



THE NEXT WEEK WE SPENT IN MOURNING...
MY FATHER'S FRIENDS ALL OFFERED ME
HOSTILITY MIXED IN WITH THEIR CONDO-
LENCES...



SHE CAME INTO MY ROOM...IT WAS
LATE AT NIGHT...



WELL, MOM, IF YOU'RE LISTENING ...



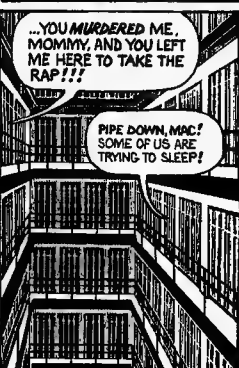
...BUT, FOR THE MOST PART, I WAS
LEFT ALONE WITH MY THOUGHTS...



...I TURNED AWAY, RESENTFUL OF THE WAY
SHE TIGHTENED THE UMBILICAL CORD...



I REMEMBERED THE LAST TIME I SAW HER...



GEE, I'M SURPRISED THAT VLADEK READ THIS WHEN HE FOUND IT. HE NEVER READS COMICS...



HE DOESN'T EVEN LOOK AT MY WORK WHEN I STICK IT UNDER HIS NOSE. BUT THIS ISN'T LIKE OTHER COMICS...



I TELL YOU, WHEN RUTHIE SHOWED IT TO ME I THOUGHT I'D FAINT, I WAS SO SHOCKED. IT WAS SO... SO PERSONAL!



...BUT VERY ACCURATE... OBJECTIVE. I SPENT A LOT OF TIME HELPING OUT HERE AFTER ANJA'S FUNERAL. IT WAS JUST AS YOU SAID.



SO, ARTIE, I'M READY.

LET'S WALK NOW TO THE BANK TOGETHER.

MALA JUST TOLD ME THAT YOU SAW MY COMIC... THE ONE ABOUT MOM.



YES. I FOUND IT WHEN I LOOKED FOR THE THINGS YOU ASKED ME LAST TIME. HOO! I SAW THE PICTURE THERE OF MOM, SO I READ IT... AND I CRIED.



I-I'M SORRY.

IT'S GOOD YOU GOT IT OUTSIDE YOUR SYSTEM. BUT FOR ME IT BROUGHT IN MY MIND SO MUCH MEMORIES OF ANJA.



...OF COURSE I'M THINKING ALWAYS ABOUT HER ANYWAY.

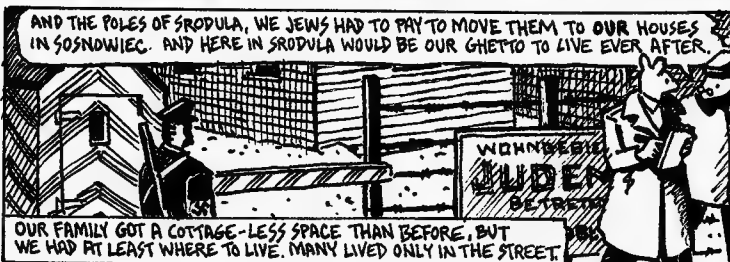
YES. YOU KEEP PHOTOS OF HER ALL AROUND YOUR DESK-LIKE A SHRINE!



WHAT HAVE I TO DO, MALA? IN THE GARBAGE PUT THEM? OF YOU ALSO I HAVE A PHOTO ON THE DESK!

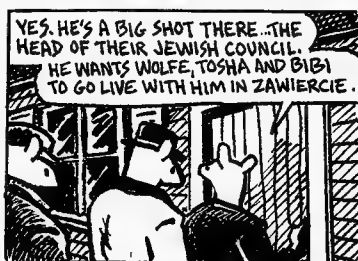
ACH! DON'T DO ME ANY FAVORS!







...AND EVERY NIGHT THEY MARCHED US BACK, COUNTED US, AND LOCKED US IN.





SO PERSIS ARRANGED, AND HE CAME AGAIN TO SRODULA.



IT WENT WITH HIM
WOLFE, TOSHA AND BIBI

LOLEK'S LITTLE
SISTER, LONIA

AND OUR BOY,
RICHIEU.

WE WATCHED UNTIL THEY DISAPPEARED FROM OUR EYES...



IT WAS THE LAST TIME EVER WE SAW
THEM; BUT THAT WE COULDN'T KNOW.

WHEN THINGS CAME WORSE
IN OUR GHETTO WE SAID
ALWAYS: "THANK GOD THE
KIDS ARE WITH PERSIS, SAFE."



THAT SPRING, ON ONE DAY,
THE GERMANS TOOK FROM
SRODULA TO AUSCHWITZ
OVER 1,000 PEOPLE.



MOST THEY TOOK WERE KIDS - SOME ONLY 2 OR 3 YEARS.



SOME KIDS WERE SCREAMING AND
SCREAMING. THEY COULDN'T STOP.

SO THE GERMANS SWINGED THEM
BY THE LEGS AGAINST A WALL...



AND THEY NEVER ANYMORE SCREAMED.

IN THIS WAY THE GERMANS TREATED THE LITTLE
ONES WHO STILL HAD SURVIVED A LITTLE.



THIS I DIDN'T SEE WITH MY
OWN EYES, BUT SOMEBODY
THE NEXT DAY TOLD ME.
AND I SAID: "THANK
GOD WITH PERSIS OUR
CHILDREN ARE SAFE!"



A FEW MONTHS AFTER WE SENT RICHIEU TO ZAWIERCIE, THE GERMANS DECIDED THEY WOULD FINISH OUT THAT GHETTO.



ALL THE GESTAPO IN THE GHETTO HAVE BEEN REPLACED BY OTHERS FROM OPOLE. THEY JUST SHOT PERSIS AND THE REST OF THE JEWISH COUNCIL!...



THEY'RE EVACUATING ZAWIERCIE. WE'RE ALL SUPPOSED TO GO TO THE SQUARE WITH OUR BAGGAGE RIGHT AWAY. THEY'RE SENDING ALL OF US OUT - TO AUSCHWITZ!



DID
TOSHA'S
HUSBAND
SURVIVE?

NO. ON THE TRAIN
TO AUSCHWITZ HE
TRIED TO ESCAPE
AND THEY SHOT HIM.



HARDLY ANY SURVIVED.
BUT THESE THINGS WE
LEARNED ONLY MUCH
LATER. IN OUR BUNKERS
WE HEARD ONLY RUMORS.



YOUR
'BUNKERS'?

YES, WE HAD
IN GRODULA TO
MAKE FOR OUR
SELVES 'BUNKERS',
PLACES TO HIDE.



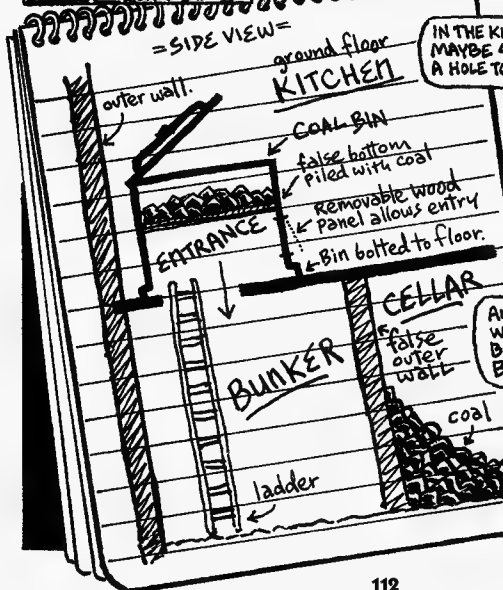
THE GERMANS STARTED
TO GRAB OUT ANYBODY,
IF HE HAD PAPERS OR NO.



THEREFORE I ARRANGED
FOR US A VERY GOOD HID-
ING SPOT- IN OUR CELLAR,
WHERE IT WAS COAL STORAGE.



SHOW TO ME YOUR PENCIL
AND I CAN EXPLAIN YOU...
SUCH THINGS IT'S GOOD TO
KNOW EXACTLY HOW WAS
IT- JUST IN CASE ...



IN THE KITCHEN WAS A COAL CABINET
MAYBE 4 FOOT WIDE. INSIDE I MADE
A HOLE TO GO DOWN TO THE CELLAR.



AND THERE WE MADE A BRICK
WALL FILLED HIGH WITH COAL.
BEHIND THIS WALL WE COULD
BE A LITTLE SAFE.



EVEN WHEN THEY CAME WITH DOGS TO SMELL US OUT-AND THEY KNEW THAT JEWS ARE LAYING HERE- BUT STILL THEY COULDN'T FIND.



THE DOGS RAN UP AND DOWN LIKE MAD. BUT IN THE COAL BIN WAS ONLY COAL. IT LOOKED FULL AND THEY COULDN'T LIFT IT. AND THE CELLAR, IT WAS ONLY A CELLAR.

IS IT SAFE TO GO OUT YET? I CAN'T STAND ALL THESE WORMS CRAWLING OVER ME.

THE GER-
MANS ARE
LEAVING!



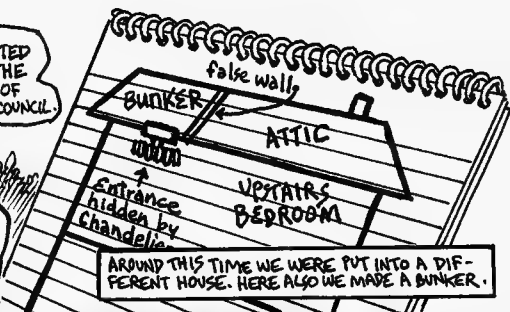
WE HAD WORMS THERE IN THAT BUNKER.

WE'VE GOT ENOUGH FOOD TO STAY HERE A COUPLE OF DAYS. WE'D BETTER WAIT 'TIL THINGS QUIET DOWN.



WE SURVIVED THERE A FEW ACTIONS. BUT OTHERS, WHAT DIDN'T HAVE SUCH A GOOD PLACE LIKE WHAT I MADE, THEY KEPT BEING TAKEN AWAY.

THEN, IN JUNE, THEY ARRESTED MONIEK MERIN AND ALL THE OTHER HIGHEST BIG SHOTS OF THE JUDENRAT, THE JEWISH COUNCIL.



AROUND THIS TIME WE WERE PUT INTO A DIFFERENT HOUSE. HERE ALSO WE MADE A BUNKER.

BY THE END OF JULY THE NAZIS MADE TO LIQUIDATE COMPLETELY OUR GHETTO - IT WAS 10,000 JEWS TAKEN AWAY IN ONE WEEK.



EXCEPT TO SNEAK FOR FOOD, WE STAYED MOSTLY IN THE BUNKER.

LOLEK! THANK GOD YOU'RE SAFE!

IT'S LIKE A BATTLEFIELD OUTSIDE!



THERE'S HARDLY ANYONE LEFT IN SRODULA. EVERYONE HAS BEEN DEPORTED OR SHOT.



FROM ALL THE JEWS OF ALL SOSNOWIEC IT WAS LEFT MAYBE 1,000 IN THE GHETTO.

AT LEAST YOUR BAG IS FULL... YOU FOUND A LOT OF FOOD, YES?

JUST A FEW OLD TURNIPS... AND SOME BOOKS.

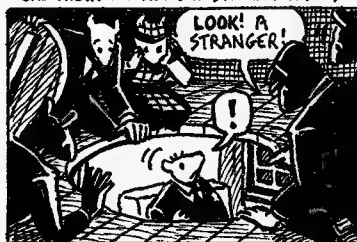


BOOKS!? WHAT'S THE MATTER WITH YOU? WE CAN'T EAT BOOKS!



ALL THE TIME WE WERE HUNGRY. WE JUST DIDN'T HAVE WHAT TO EAT.

ONE NIGHT WE WENT TO SNEAK FOR FOOD...



WE DRAGGED HIM UP TO OUR BUNKER



MY WIFE AND I HAVE A STARVING BABY. I WAS OUT HUNTING FOR SCRAPS!



HE MAY BE AN INFORMER. THE SAFEST THING WOULD BE TO KILL HIM!



IN THE MORNING WE GAVE A LITTLE FOOD TO HIM AND LEFT HIM GO TO HIS FAMILY...





THE NEXT DAY CAME IN TWO GIRLS CARRYING FOOD. WITH THEM CAME HASKEL, A CHIEF OF THE JEWISH POLICE.

(LOOK, VLADEK. I CAN GET YOU AND YOUR WIFE OUT—EVEN YOUR NEPHEW. BUT YOUR IN-LAWS ARE TOO OLD. THEY'LL NEVER GET PAST THE GUARDS.)

PLEASE! WE'LL MAKE IT WORTH YOUR WHILE.

THE TWO GIRLS HE SENT BACK TO THE KITCHEN.

QUICK, BOY, GRAB THIS EMPTY PAIL AND CARRY IT OUT WITH ME.

FROM THE WINDOW WE SAW LOLEK GO.

MY GOD, VLADEK...

YOU MUST GET MATKA AND ME OUT TOO. GIVE YOUR COUSIN THIS GOLD WATCH, THIS DIAMOND—ANYTHING!

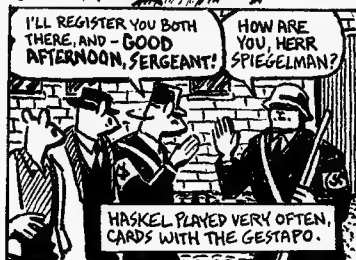
OF COURSE I—I'LL DO EVERYTHING I CAN.

THE DAY AFTER, ANJA AND I CARRIED PAST THE GUARDS THE EMPTY PAILS.

HASKEL TOOK FROM ME FATHER-IN-LAW'S JEWELS. BUT FINALLY, HE DIDN'T HELP THEM.

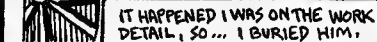
ON WEDNESDAY THE VANS CAME. ANJA AND I SAW HER FATHER AT THE WINDOW. HE WAS TEARING HIS HAIR AND CRYING.

HE WAS A MILLIONAIRE, BUT EVEN THIS DIDN'T SAVE HIM HIS LIFE.





HASKEL HAD 2 BROTHERS, PESACH AND MILOCH. PESACH WAS ALSO A KOMBINATOR. BUT MILOCH, HE WAS A FINE FELLOW.



HASKEL IS ALIVE STILL IN POLAND, WITH A POLISH WOMAN, A JUDGE, WHAT KEPT HIM HIDDEN WHEN **HYAAK!**



MY HEART - ARTIE! QUICK! TAKE FROM MY POCKET A NITROSTAT PILL.



H-HERE... YOU OKAY?

HOOSH



I-I'LL BE FINE NOW. I HAVE ONLY TO CATCH MY BREATH STILL FOR A MINUTE.



LET'S SIT ON THAT STOOP.

JUST RELAX. DON'T TALK FOR A WHILE.



HOOH! I MADE TOO FAST, OUR WALKING!

THANK GOD, WITH THE NITROSTAT IT'S COMPLETELY OVER RIGHT AWAY! WHAT WAS I TELLING YOU?



YOU SURE YOU'RE OKAY?

WELL... YOU WERE SAYING THAT HASKEL SURVIVED THE WAR.



YES, EVEN A FEW YEARS AGO I SENT HIM PACKAGES.

GIFTS? WHY? HE SOUNDS LIKE A ROTTEN GUY!



YES, I DON'T KNOW WHY. I KNOW ONLY THAT I SENT.

YOU KNOW, ONE TIME I WAS IN THE GHETTO WALKING AROUND...



HALT, JEW!

GIVE ME YOUR I.D. PAPERS... I'M GOING TO BLOW YOUR BRAINS OUT.



AH, I SEE YOU'RE A MEMBER OF THE ILLUSTRIOUS SPIEGELMAN FAMILY... GO ON YOUR WAY THEN, AND GIVE HASKEL MY REGARDS.



... SUCH FRIENDS HASKEL HAD,

I TOLD HASKEL AND MILOCH LATER ABOUT THIS.



BUT COUSIN PESACH WAS REALLY SELLING CAKE! EVERYONE WHAT COULD AFFORD IT STOOD ON LINE TO BUY A PIECE...



BEFORE THE WAR PESACH HAD A RESORT HOTEL IN ZAKOPANE...

IN THOSE DAYS ALSO HE FOUND ALWAYS SCHEMES.



ALL GUESTS HAD TO PAY BIG POLISH TAXES... SO PESACH TOOK BRIBES TO NOT REGISTER THEM. BUT IF AN INSPECTOR CAME, THE GUESTS HAD TO HIDE THEMSELVES AWAY.



ONE TIME HIS WIFE MADE NOT ENOUGH DESSERTS TO GIVE TO EVERYBODY... SO PESACH RAN INTO THE DINING ROOM AND YELLED, "INSPECTORS ARE COMING!"



IT WAS NO INSPECTOR, OF COURSE. BUT 40% OF THE GUESTS RAN FAST FROM THE ROOM. ... PESACH HAD ENOUGH DESSERTS LEFT OVER EVEN FOR THE NEXT DAY!



COME.

ARE YOU READY TO WALK AGAIN?

YES, IT'S TOO DIRTY TO SIT! ...BUT, REALLY, IF I DIDN'T HAVE MY NITROSTAT, IT COULD HAVE BEEN JUST NOW SOMETHING TERRIBLE.



MILCH SPIEGELMAN - HE SURVIVED THE WAR WITH HIS WIFE AND CHILD AND THEY MOVED TO AUSTRALIA. ABOUT FIVE YEARS AGO HE GOT A BIG HEART ATTACK...



AND LAST YEAR, HE GOT ON THE STREET A SEIZURE - LIKE WHAT I HAD JUST NOW... BUT HE DIDN'T HAVE WITH HIM HIS PILLS. HIS WIFE RAN TO FIND A DRUG STORE.

WHEN SHE CAME BACK MILCH WAS DEAD!



NU? SO LIFE GOES.

BUT I MUST FINISH QUICK TO TELL YOU THE REST ABOUT SRODULA, BECAUSE WE WILL COME SOON OVER TO THE BANK.



BY THE END OF 1943 THE VANS WENT EVERY WEDNESDAY WITH MORE AND MORE AND MORE PEOPLE FROM SRODULA TO AUSCHWITZ UNTIL IT WAS VERY FEW LEFT.



HASKEL HEARD THAT ANY DAY NOW THEY INTEND TO DEPORT EVERYONE THAT'S STILL LEFT HERE.



IT WAS EARLY AND NOBODY WAS THERE...

HASKEL MADE PLANS TO SMUGGLE HIMSELF OUT OF THE GHETTO. PESACH AND I HAVE A PLAN ALSO...



...AND TOOK ME INSIDE A TUNNEL...

DON'T TELL ANYONE ABOUT THIS EXCEPT ANJA AND YOUR NEPHEW.



WE CAME OUT TO A BUNKER...

BE PREPARED TO BRING THEM ON A MOMENT'S NOTICE!

INCREDIBLE!

EVERYTHING WAS READY HERE SO 15 OR 16 PEOPLE COULD HIDE.



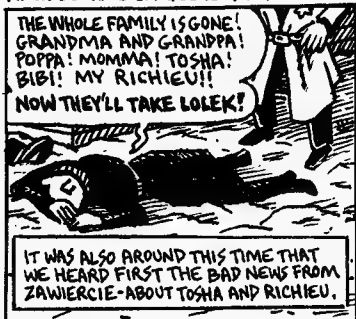
...BUT WHEN ANJA AND I APPROACHED
TO DISCUSS THIS BUNKER WITH LOLEK...



ALWAYS LOLEK WAS A LITTLE MESHUGA...



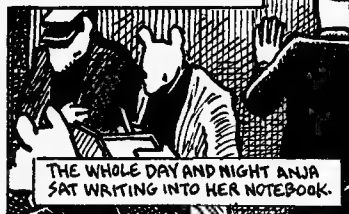
ANJA BECAME COMPLETELY HYSTERICAL.



THE GHETTO FINISHED OUT SO LIKE MILOCH SAID. ABOUT TWELVE FROM US RAN INTO HIS BUNKER WITH HIM, HIS WIFE AND HIS THREE-YEARS-OLD BABY BOY.



IT WAS NOTHING TO DO ALL DAY BUT TO LIE AND TO STARVE.



WHAT LITTLE FOOD WE HAD, SOON IT WAS GONE.



AT NIGHT WE SNEAKED OUT TO LOOK FOR WHAT TO EAT... BUT IT WAS NOTHING TO FIND.



NEVER ANY OF US HAD BEEN SO HUNGRY LIKE THEN.



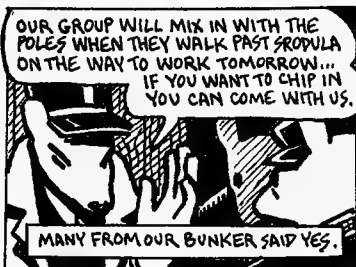


AFTER A TIME PESACH CAME OVER TO US FROM HIS BUNKER...

MAYBE YOU FOOLS ARE WILLING TO LIE HERE UNTIL YOU STARVE TO DEATH - BUT NOT ME!...



I'VE CONTACTED ONE OF THE GUARDS. IT'LL COST A FORTUNE, BUT HE'S AGREED TO LOOK THE OTHER WAY.



OUR GROUP WILL MIX IN WITH THE POLES WHEN THEY WALK PAST SRODULA ON THE WAY TO WORK TOMORROW... IF YOU WANT TO CHIP IN YOU CAN COME WITH US.

MANY FROM OUR BUNKER SAID YES.

MILOCH AND I, WE SAID NO TO THIS IDEA. WE DIDN'T TRUST TO THE GERMANS. ONE GUY FROM OUR BUNKER, AVRAM, CAME TO ME.

HE SAID, "TELL ME WHEN YOU WILL GO OUT, VLADEK. THEN I'LL KNOW IT'S SAFE." HE AND HIS GIRLFRIEND WANTED TO PAY ME TO ADVISE.

THEY HAD STILL 2 WATCHES AND SOME DIAMOND RINGS. I DIDN'T WANT TO TAKE. THEY NEEDED THESE TO LIVE.

SO I TOOK ONLY THE SMALL WATCH.



THE NEXT MORNING, VERY EARLY, THE GROUP WALKED OUT.

I STOOD, SECRET, BEHIND A CORNER. I HEARD LOUD SHOOTING, AND I DIDN'T GO TO SEE WHAT HAPPENED...



THEY GAVE OVER THE MONEY AND WENT PAST THE GUARD.



I ONLY RAN VERY FAST BACK TO OUR BUNKER.

ONLY A FEW OF US REMAINED. A LITTLE BEFORE DAWN WE WENT OUT FROM SRODUL...

THERE HAVEN'T BEEN ANY LIGHTS ON IN THE GUARD-HOUSE FOR TWO NIGHTS... I THINK IT'S SAFE.



THEY'RE ALL GONE!

THE GHETTO IS EMPTY!

WHEW

AHEAD OF TIME WE ORGANIZED OURSELVES GOOD CLOTHES AND I.D. PAPERS.



WE MIXED WITH THE POLES GOING TO WORK.

THAT GUY, AVRAM, HIS WOMAN HAD FRIENDS TO KEEP THEM.

WE'LL BE HIDING AT THIS ADDRESS. WHEN YOU FIND A SAFE PLACE, TRY TO CONTACT US, VLADEK.

GOOD LUCK, MILOCH.



ANJA AND I DIDN'T HAVE WHERE TO GO.



IT WAS NOWHERE. WE HAD TO HIDE.

CAN I HELP YOU, MR. SPIEGELMAN?



YES, I HAVE HERE MY SON, ARTIE. I WANT TO SIGN HIM A KEY. SO HE CAN GO ALSO TO MY SAFETY BOX.





YOU SEE THIS DIAMOND?
THIS I GAVE TO ANJA WHEN
FIRST WE CAME TO THE U.S.



EVEN WHEN YOU WERE A
LITTLE BOY, ANJA WANTED
THAT THIS RING SHOULD
BE FOR YOUR WIFE.



BUT IF I GIVE IT TO YOU,
MALA WILL DRIVE ME
CRAZY. SHE WANTS EV-
ERYTHING ONLY FOR HER.



SHE WANTS THAT I GIVE NOTHING FOR
MY BROTHER IN ISRAEL, AND NOTHING
FOR YOU—THREE TIMES ALREADY SHE
MADE ME CHANGE OVER MY WILL.



YOU ONLY CAN'T KNOW! EVEN RIGHT
AFTER MY LAST HEART ATTACK, WHEN
STILL I WAS IN BED, SHE STARTED
AGAIN ABOUT CHANGING THE WILL!



I SAID, "MALA, YOU SEE HOW SICK I AM.
LET ME A LITTLE BIT HAVE SOME PEACE.
WHAT YOU WANT FROM ME?"



AND SHE SCREAMED, "I WANT THE MONEY!
THE MONEY.
THE MONEY!"



WHY, ARTIE?
WHY I EVER
REMARRIED?

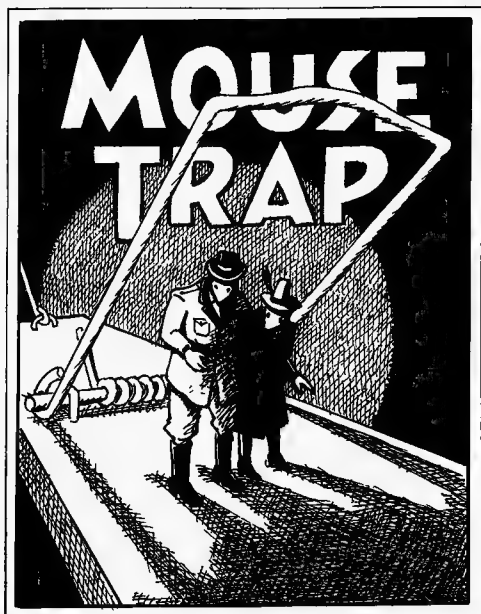


OY, ANJA!
ANJA!
ANJA!

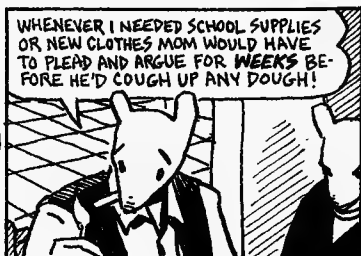
EASY, POP...
LET'S GO HOME.



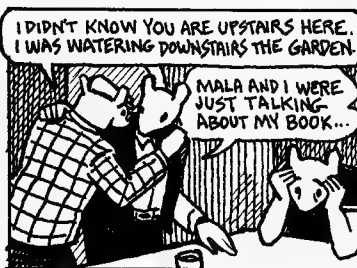
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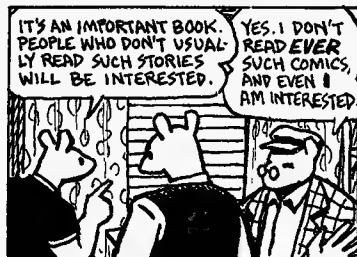


Another visit...

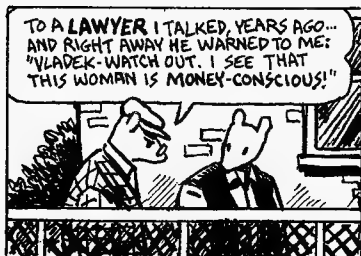














GO THROUGH THE COURTYARD TO THE SHED IN THE BACK. I'LL BRING YOU SOME FOOD.



THANK GOD THERE ARE STILL SOME KIND PEOPLE LEFT. I THOUGHT—

A JEWESS!



THERE'S A JEWESS IN THE COURTYARD! POLICE!

HURRY!



AN OLD WITCH RECOGNIZED ANJA FROM HER WINDOW.

WE RAN FAST TO THE SHED AND HID IN THE STRAW.

IT'S OKAY FOR NOW...



I DON'T THINK ANYONE HEARD HER... SHE'S A LITTLE SENILE ANYWAY.



BUT YOU MUST LOOK FOR A BETTER PLACE TO STAY. SOMEONE HERE IS BOUND TO RECOGNIZE YOU!



IT'S ALMOST MORNING. WAIT HERE. I'M GOING OUT TO SCOUT AROUND.

B-BE CAREFUL.



I WALKED, BUT I DIDN'T KNOW WHERE TO GO.



AND I HEARD SOON IT WAS SOMEBODY FOLLOWING BEHIND ME.





THIS TIME IT WAS MORE PEOPLE...THERE EVEN, I SAW SOME JEWISH BOYS I KNEW FROM BEFORE THE WAR.





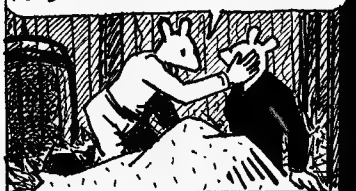
AND SO WE CAME THERE
TO LIVE WITH KAWKAS COW

IT'S ALMOST DAWN—WHEN MRS KAWKA
COMES TO MILK HER COW, SHE'LL
BRING YOU SOME COFFEE.

WHERE ARE
YOU GOING?
TO DEKERTA.

DON'T LEAVE ME
ALONE AGAIN.
I'M TERRIFIED
WHILE YOU'RE GONE.

DON'T WORRY, ANJA. I'LL BE SAFE.
IF I DIDN'T GO OUT WE WOULDN'T HAVE
FOOD...WE WOULDN'T HAVE THIS PLACE!...



AND WE'VE GOT TO
FIND A WARMER
PLACE FOR THE
WINTER...AWAY
FROM SOSNOWIEC
IF POSSIBLE...

I-I'LL BE OKAY.
COME BACK QUICK.



I TRAVELED OFTEN WITH
THE STREETCAR TO TOWN.



IT WAS TWO CARS. ONE WAS ONLY GERMANS AND
OFFICIALS. THE SECOND, IT WAS ONLY THE POLES.

ALWAYS I WENT STRAIGHT
IN THE OFFICIAL CAR...

HEIL HITLER.



THE GERMANS PAID NO ATTENTION OF ME... IN THE PO-
LISH CAR THEY COULD SMELL IF A POLISH JEW CAME IN.

AT THE BLACK MARKET I SAW SEVERAL TIMES A NICE WOMAN, WHAT I MADE A LITTLE FRIENDS WITH HER...

GOOD MORNING, MR. SPIEGELMAN.



HOW DO YOU DO, MRS. MOTONOWA! WHAT DO YOU HAVE IN YOUR BASKET TODAY?

HOW ABOUT A LOAF OF FRESH BREAD? FINE, FINE.



OH, I'M SORRY. I DON'T HAVE ANY CHANGE.

IT'S OKAY... KEEP IT FOR YOUR LITTLE BOY.



ARE YOU AND YOUR WIFE STILL LIVING IN A BARN?

WE HAVEN'T FOUND ANYTHING BETTER.

I'VE BEEN THINKING ABOUT IT... WHY DON'T YOU BOTH MOVE IN WITH MY SON AND ME?



WHAT ABOUT YOUR HUSBAND?

HE WORKS IN GERMANY, AND ONLY COMES HOME FOR 10 DAYS EVERY 3 MONTHS... I'LL KEEP YOU HIDDEN IN THE CELLAR WHEN HE'S AROUND.



IT SOUNDS GOOD TO ME, BUT IT'S OVER 20 KILOMETERS TO YOUR HOUSE IN SZOPIENICE. MY WIFE WILL BE AFRAID TO GO!

DON'T WORRY. I'LL ESCORT YOU!



THE NEXT EVENING SHE CAME WITH HER 7-YEARS-OLD BOY TO KAWKA'S FARMHOUSE...



I WALKED WITH MOTONOWA AS IF SHE WAS MY WIFE.

AND ANJA, LIKE A GOVERNESS, WENT WITH THE LITTLE BOY BEHIND. AND NOBODY EVEN LOOKED ON US.

WE HAD HERE A LITTLE COMFORTABLE...WE HAD WHERE TO SIT.



YOU HAD TO PAY MRS. MOTO-NOWA TO KEEP YOU, RIGHT?



...I PAID ALSO FOR THE FOOD WHAT SHE GAVE TO US FROM HER SMUGGLING BUSINESS.



BUT, ONE TIME I MISSED A FEW COINS TO THE BREAD...



I'LL PAY YOU THE REST TOMORROW, AFTER I GO OUT AND CASH SOME VALUABLES.



SORRY...I WASN'T ABLE TO FIND ANY BREAD TODAY.



IN HIS SCHOOL THE BOY WAS VERY BAD IN GERMAN. SO ANJA TUTORED TO HIM.



AND SOON HE CAME OUT WITH VERY GOOD GRADES.



SO I TOLD HIM MY MOTHER WAS HELPING ME.

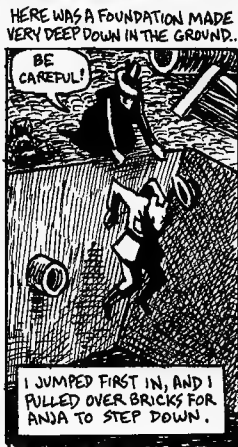
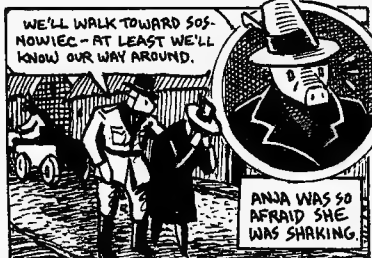


BUT IT WAS A FEW THINGS HERE NOT SO GOOD... HER HOME WAS VERY SMALL AND IT WAS ON THE GROUND FLOOR...



STILL, EVERYTHING HERE WAS FINE, UNTIL ONE SATURDAY MOTONOWA RAN VERY EARLY BACK FROM HER BLACK MARKET WORK...





IT STARTED TO BE LIGHT...



LATER, KAWKA CAME IN...



SHE TOOK ANJA INSIDE AND BROUGHT TO ME SOME FOOD... IN THOSE DAYS I WAS SO STRONG I COULD SIT EVEN IN THE SNOW ALL NIGHT.

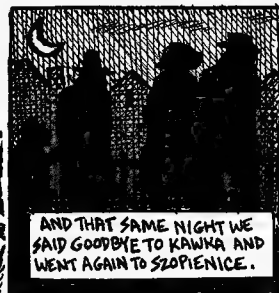
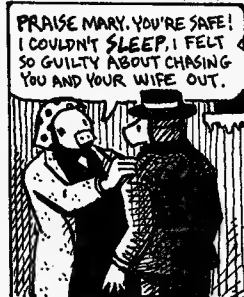


TWO PEOPLE I KNOW SMUGGLED THEM INTO HUNGARY. I HEARD HE AND HIS BOY WERE DOING WELL THERE.





SO... I WENT NEXT DAY TO DEKERTA STREET TO BUY FOOD...



AFTER WE WERE BACK ONLY A SHORT TIME...



SO EACH DAY AND NIGHT WE SAT IN SUCH A STORAGE LOCKER...



AT NIGHT WE COULD MOVE AROUND A LITTLE, BUT IT WAS SOMETHING ELSE DOWN THERE...



TH-THERE ARE RATS DOWN HERE!



THOSE AREN'T RATS. THEY'RE VERY SMALL. ONE RAN OVER MY HAND BEFORE. THEY'RE JUST MICE!



BUT, THEN, MOTONOWA STOPPED TO COME DOWN.

IT'S BEEN 3 DAYS SINCE SHE BROUGHT ANY FOOD.

HERE...HAVE ANOTHER CANDY...

I HAD STILL CANDIES I ORGANIZED ON DEKERTA. ONLY THIS WE HAD TO EAT.

ALSO, HERE WE HAD NO PLACE WHERE TO WASH, SO ANJA GOT ON ALL HER SKIN A TERRIBLE RASH.

I DON'T KNOW WHAT'S WORSE- THE HUNGER OR THE ITCHING.

DON'T SCRATCH! IT ONLY- SHH!

THE DOOR.

I'M SORRY I COULDN'T GET DOWN BEFORE...MY HUSBAND IS GETTING SUSPICIOUS.

HE ASKED WHY I GO TO THE CELLAR SO OFTEN. HE EVEN ASKED IF I WAS HIDING JEWS HERE! ...HE WAS JOKING, BUT STILL...

ARE YOU ALL RIGHT HERE?

THERE ARE RATS, GIANT RATS! THEY'RE HORRIBLE!

WELL- YOU'RE BETTER OFF WITH THE RATS THAN WITH THE GESTAPO... AT LEAST THE RATS WON'T KILL YOU!

MMM...

AND SHE WAS RIGHT. WE WERE HAPPY EVEN TO HAVE THESE CONDITIONS.

AFTER THE TEN DAYS HER HUSBAND LEFT, AND SHE TOOK US BACK.

IT'S GOOD TO BE "HOME," EH, VLADEK?

IT'S A LOT NICER THAN THAT CELLAR.

BUT I DIDN'T FEEL SAFE HERE. IT WAS TOO MANY WAYS SOMEBODY COULD FIND US OUT. I WANTED TO GO BETTER TO HUNGARY.

SO, WHEN IT CAME THURSDAY, I WENT IN THE DIRECTION TO TAKE A STREETCAR TO SEE KAWKA IN SOSNOWIEC.



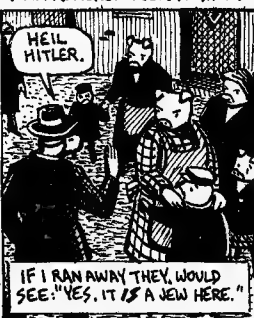
THEY RAN SCREAMING HOME.



THE MOTHERS ALWAYS TOLD SO: "BE CAREFUL! A JEW WILL CATCH YOU TO A BAG AND EAT YOU!" ... SO THEY TAUGHT TO THEIR CHILDREN.



I APPROACHED OVER TO THEM...



DON'T BE AFRAID, LITTLE ONES. I'M NOT A JEW. I WON'T HURT YOU.



SORRY, MISTER. YOU KNOW HOW KIDS ARE ... HEIL HITLER.



SO I CAME OUT WELL FROM THIS...



WHEN I ARRIVED TO KAWKA, THE TWO SMUGGLERS WERE THERE TOGETHER SITTING IN THE KITCHEN..



PLEASE WAIT IN THE OTHER ROOM. THEY'LL SEE YOU SOON..



MR. MANDELBAUM!

VLADEK SPIEGELMAN!

MANDELBAUM, BEFORE THE WAR OWNED A SWEETS SHOP.

ANJA AND I BOUGHT ALWAYS PASTRIES THERE. HE USED TO BE A VERY RICH MAN IN SOSNOWIEC.



THIS IS MY WIFE...AND YOU KNOW MY NEPHEW..

HELLO, ABRAHAM. WHAT ARE YOU ALL DOING HERE?

BACK WHEN IT WAS THE GHETTO, ABRAHAM WAS A BIG MEMBER OF THE JEWISH COUNCIL.



WE'RE TRYING TO GET OUT OF POLAND..

-TO HUNGARY?! YES. ANJA AND I ARE TRYING TO ARRANGE THAT TOO!

THE SMUGGLERS PROPOSED US HOW THEY WOULD DO.



...AND AT THE BORDER OUR PARTNERS WILL TAKE YOU THROUGH THE MOUNTAINS.

WHEW- IT'S RISKY AND VERY EXPENSIVE!

WE SPOKE YIDDISH SO THE POLES DON'T UNDERSTAND.



NIE, VAS PENKST DIE?

YECH KENN DIE FRAU KAWKA, UBER YECH BIN NISH ZICHER VEGEN DIE ZWEI.

So, what do you think?

I know Mrs. Kawka, but I'm not sure about these two.

HERR MECH TSE! YECH GEI KODEM MIT ZEI. AZ ALLES VET ZEIN BESEDER, YECH VIL SCHREIBEN TSE DEYER.



Listen! I'll go first. If everything is okay, I'll write back to you.



THE OTHERS WANT TO THINK ABOUT IT A LITTLE LONGER, BUT I'M READY TO GO NOW.

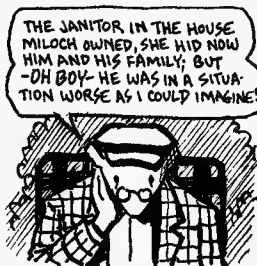
FINE. FINE.

I AGREED WITH MANDELBAUM TO MEET AGAIN HERE. IF IT CAME A GOOD LETTER, WE'LL GO.

BUT IF EVER I TALKED OF THIS PLAN TO ANJA...



MILOCH HELPED ME IN SRDULA. MAYBE
NOW, IF HE NEEDED, I COULD HELP HIM.

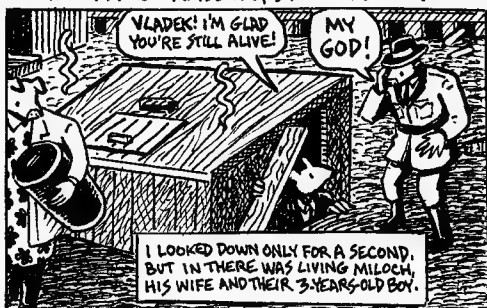




THE CONDITIONS HOW MILOCH WAS LIVING - YOU COULDN'T BELIEVE.



INSIDE THIS GARBAGE HOLE WAS HERE SEPARATED
A TINY SPACE - MAYBE ONLY 5 FEET BY 6 FEET.



A FEW DAYS AFTER,
I CAME AGAIN TO
THE SMUGGLERS.
AND MANDELBAUM
WAS ALSO THERE.



LOOK, VLADEK - MY NEPHEW IS SAFE!
THEY BROUGHT ME
A LETTER FROM HIM.

IT WAS IN YIDDISH
AND IT WAS SIGNED
REALLY BY ABRAHAM.
SO WE AGREED RIGHT
AWAY TO GO AHEAD.

BUT ANJA JUST DIDN'T WANT WE WOULD GO...

PLEASE, VLADEK,
CALL IT OFF!

BUT IT'S ALL AR-
RANGED. I'VE EVEN
GIVEN THEM HALF
THEIR MONEY!



NO! NO! NO!
IT'S SOME KIND
OF TRICK!

BE REASONABLE.
I SAW ABRAHAM'S
LETTER WITH MY
OWN EYES!



WH-WHAT
DID IT
SAY?

"DEAR AUNT AND UNCLE,
EVERYTHING IS WON-
DERFUL HERE. I AR-
RIVED SAFELY. I'M FREE
AND HAPPY. DON'T LOSE
A MINUTE. JOIN ME AS
SOON AS YOU CAN.
YOUR LOVING NEPHEW,
ABRAHAM."



I-I DON'T
KNOW...

WE LEAVE THE DAY AFTER
TOMORROW FROM THE KA-
TOWICE TRAIN STATION.



AND FINALLY I
CONVINCED HER.

SO, I WENT ONE MORE TIME
OVER TO MILOCH IN HIS GAR-
BAGE BUNKER AND DIRECTED
HIM HOW HE MUST GO TO
SZOPIENICE AND HIDE...



AND, YOU KNOW, MILOCH AND
HIS WIFE AND BOY, THEY ALL
SURVIVED THEMSELVES THE
WHOLE WAR... SITTING THERE
... WITH MOTONOWA...



BUT, FOR ANJA AND I, IT WAS FOR US WAITING ANOTHER DESTINY...



WE CAME WITH NO PROBLEM
BY TROLLEY CAR TO OUR MEET-
ING POINT WITH THE MANDEL-
BAUMS AND THE SMUGGLERS.

EVERYTHING IS
ARRANGED. HERE
ARE YOUR TICKETS.



I HAD A SMALL BAG TO TRAVEL.
WHEN THEY REGISTERED ME IN,
THEY LOOKED OVER EVERYTHING.



WITH A SPOON HE TOOK OUT, LIT-
TLE BY LITTLE, ALL THE POLISH.

WELL, WELL... A GOLD WATCH.
YOU JEWS ALWAYS HAVE GOLD!



IT WAS THIS WATCH I GOT
FROM FATHER-IN-LAW WHEN
FIRST I MARRIED TO ANJA.



WELL, NEVER MIND... THEY
TOOK IT AND THREW ME WITH
MANDELBAUM INTO A CELL...



AH, MANDELBAUM'S NEPHEW!
YES. HE FINISHED THE SAME
AS US TO CONCENTRATION CAMP.

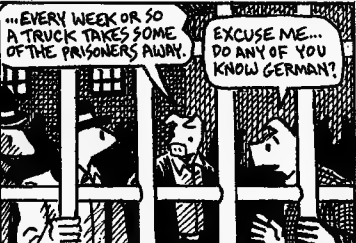


YES. I'LL TELL YOU HOW IT
WAS WITH HIM - BUT NOW I'M
TELLING HERE IN THE PRISON...



WHY DON'T THEY PUT US TO
WORK LIKE THE REST OF YOU?

IT MEANS YOU
WON'T BE HERE
VERY LONG...



MY FAMILY JUST SENT ME A FOOD PARCEL.
IF I WRITE BACK THEY'LL SEND ANOTHER,
BUT WE'RE ONLY ALLOWED TO WRITE GERMAN.



IN A SHORT TIME HE GOT AGAIN A PACKAGE...

YOU DID A GREAT JOB! TAKE ANYTHING
YOU WANT FOR YOU AND YOUR FRIEND!



A FEW DAYS LATER THE TRUCKS CAME.
THEY PUSHED IN MAYBE 100 OF US.



ONE MORE TIME I WAS TOGETHER WITH ANJA.

HERE, DARLING. I HAVE
A PRESENT FOR YOU...

EGGS?! CAKE???

WHAT? HOW?...



I HAD STILL THINGS I GOT
BY WRITING THIS LETTER.

NO... YOU KEEP IT... I'M NOT HUNGRY.

HERE...
AT LEAST
TAKE HALF
FOR LATER.

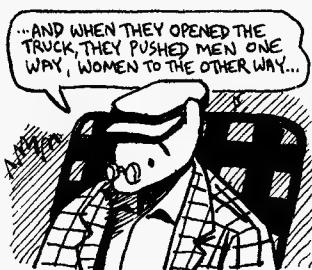


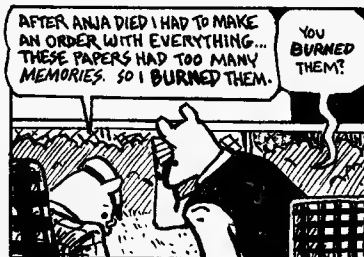
WE CAME TO THE TOWN OF OSWIECIM...
BEFORE THE WAR I SOLD TEXTILES HERE.

AND WE CAME HERE TO THE CONCENTRATION
CAMP AUSCHWITZ. AND WE KNEW THAT FROM
HERE WE WILL NOT COME OUT ANYMORE...



WE KNEW THE STORIES--THAT THEY WILL GAS US
AND THROW US IN THE OVENS. THIS WAS 1944...
WE KNEW EVERYTHING. AND HERE WE WERE.





MAUS



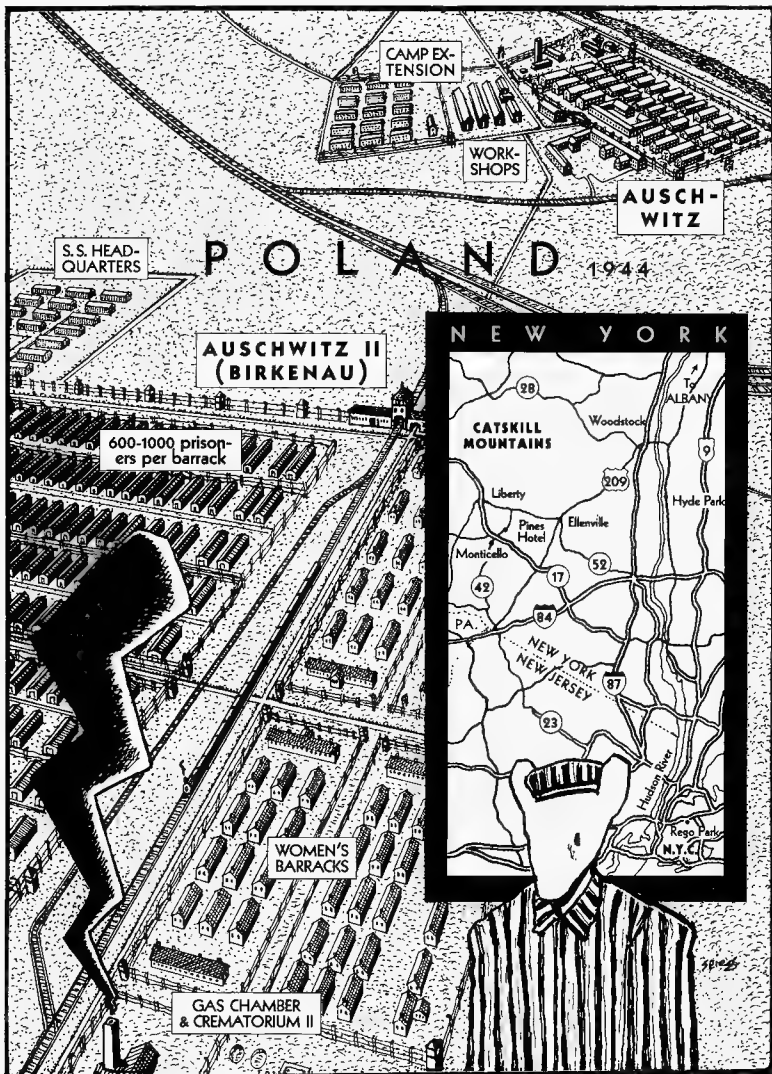
"Mickey Mouse is the most miserable ideal ever revealed. . . . Healthy emotions tell every independent young man and every honorable youth that the dirty and filth-covered vermin, the greatest bacteria carrier in the animal kingdom, cannot be the ideal type of animal. . . . Away with Jewish brutalization of the people! Down with Mickey Mouse! Wear the Swastika Cross!"

—newspaper article, Pomerania, Germany, mid-1930s

FOR RICHIEU



**AND FOR NADJA
AND DASHIELL**



AND HERE MY TROUBLES BEGAN

(FROM MAUSCHWITZ TO THE LATERILLS AND BEYOND)

C O N T E N T S

169 one/Mauschwitz

199 two/Auschwitz (time flies)

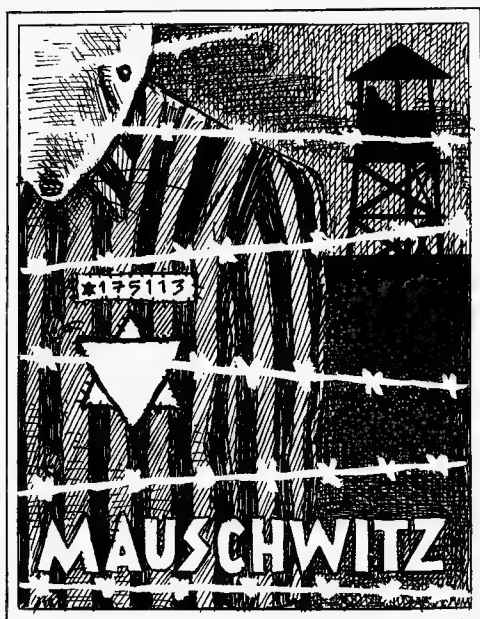
235 three/...and here my troubles began ...

261 four/saved

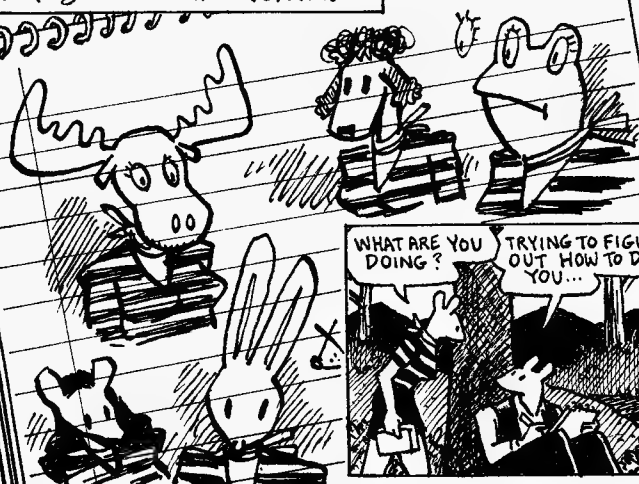
279 five/the second honeymoon



C H A P T E R O N E



Summer vacation. Françoise and I were staying with friends in Vermont...



WHAT ARE YOU DOING?

TRYING TO FIGURE OUT HOW TO DRAW YOU...



WANT ME TO POSE?

I MEAN IN MY BOOK. WHAT KIND OF ANIMAL SHOULD I MAKE YOU?

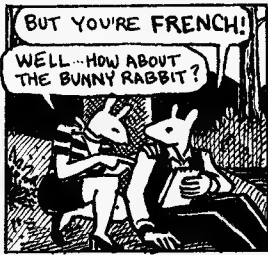


HUH? A MOUSE, OF COURSE!



BUT YOU'RE FRENCH!

WELL...HOW ABOUT THE BUNNY RABBIT?



NAH. TOO SWEET AND GENTLE.

I MEAN THE FRENCH IN GENERAL. LET'S NOT FORGET THE CENTURIES OF ANTI-SEMITISM..

HMMMPH.

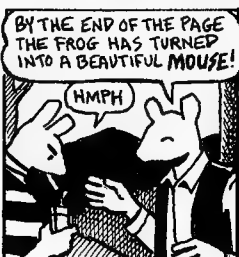


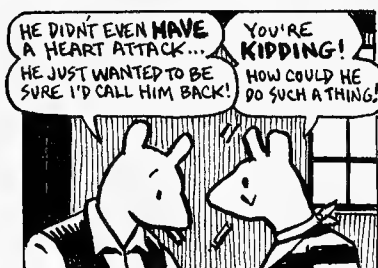
I MEAN, HOW ABOUT THE DREYFUS AFFAIR? THE NAZI COLLABORATORS! THE —

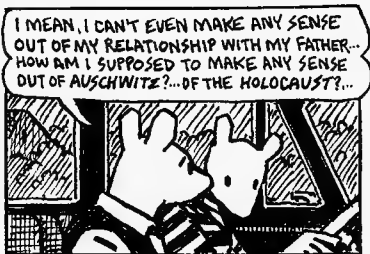
OKAY! BUT IF YOU'RE A MOUSE, I OUGHT TO BE A MOUSE TOO.

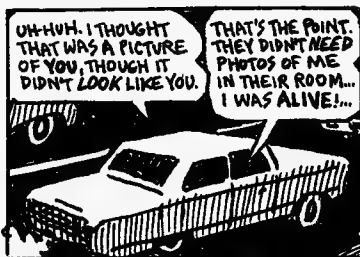
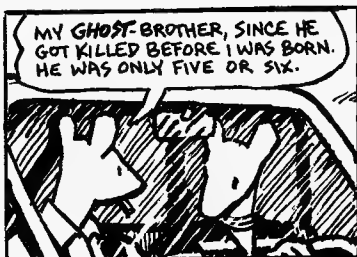
I CONVERTED DIDN'T I?











I NEVER FELT GUILTY ABOUT RICHIEU.
BUT I DID HAVE NIGHTMARES ABOUT
SS MEN COMING INTO MY CLASS AND
DRAGGING ALL US JEWISH KIDS AWAY.



DON'T GET ME WRONG. I WASN'T
OBSESSED WITH THIS STUFF ...
IT'S JUST THAT SOMETIMES I'D FAN-
TASIZE ZYKLON B COMING OUT OF
OUR SHOWER INSTEAD OF WATER.



I KNOW THIS IS INSANE, BUT I SOMEHOW WISH I HAD
BEEN IN AUSCHWITZ WITH MY PARENTS SO I COULD
REALLY KNOW WHAT THEY LIVED THROUGH!

...I GUESS IT'S SOME KIND OF GUILT ABOUT HAVING
HAD AN EASIER LIFE THAN THEY DID.



SIGH.

I FEEL SO INADEQUATE TRYING TO
RECONSTRUCT A REALITY THAT WAS
WORSE THAN MY DARKEST DREAMS.



AND TRYING TO DO IT AS A COMIC STRIP!
I GUESS I BIT OFF MORE THAN I CAN CHEW.
MAYBE I OUGHT TO FOR-
GET THE WHOLE THING.



THERE'S SO MUCH I'LL NEVER BE ABLE
TO UNDERSTAND OR VISUALIZE. I MEAN,
REALITY IS TOO COMPLEX FOR COMICS...
SO MUCH HAS TO BE LEFT OUT OR DISTORTED.



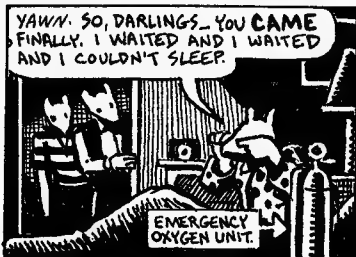
JUST KEEP IT
HONEST, HONEY.

SEE WHAT I MEAN...
IN REAL LIFE YOU'D NEVER
HAVE LET ME TALK THIS
LONG WITHOUT INTERRUPTING.

HMMPH.
LIGHT
ME A
CIGARETTE.



And so, the Catskills...







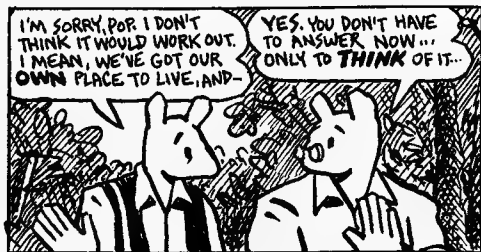
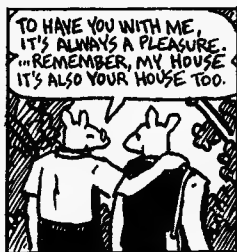






A few tense hours later...







NO! THE WAR PUT US
APART, BUT ALWAYS
BEFORE AND AFTER,
WE WERE TOGETHER.



NOT SO LIKE
MALA, WHAT
GRABS OUT
MY MONEY!-

AUSCHWITZ,
POR TELL
ME ABOUT
AUSCHWITZ.



AUSCHWITZ WAS IN A TOWN
CALLED OSWIECIM. BEFORE
THE WAR I CAME OFTEN
HERE TO SELL MY TEXTILES.



...AND NOW,
I CAME AGAIN.



THEY TOOK FROM US OUR PAPERS, OUR CLOTHES AND OUR HAIR-



EVERYWHERE WE HAD TO RUN—SO LIKE JOGGERS—AND THEY RAN US TO THE SAUNA...



IN THE SNOW THEY THREW TO US PRISONERS CLOTHINGS.



ONE GUY TRIED TO EXCHANGE.



I WAS A LUCKY ONE. EVERYTHING FITTED ME A LITTLE. ONLY THE SHIRT WAS TORN AND TOO BIG FOR ME...



ALL AROUND WAS A SMELL SO TERRIBLE, I CAN'T EXPLAIN... SWEETISH... SO LIKE RUBBER BURNING. AND FAT.

HERE WAS ABRAHAM - MANDELBAUM'S NEPHEW!



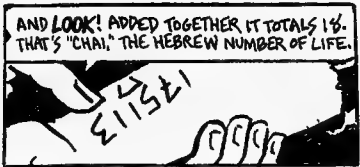
WE NEWCOMERS WERE PUT INSIDE A ROOM. OLD-TIMERS PASSED AND SAID ALL THE SAME.



I WAS WORN AND SHIVERING AND CRYING A LITTLE.



BUT FROM ANOTHER ROOM SOMEONE APPROACHED OVER



FOR ME IT WAS HARD HERE,
BUT FOR MY FRIEND MANDEL-
BAUM IT WAS MORE HARD.



IN SOSNOWIEC, EVERYONE
KNEW MANDELBAUM.
HE WAS OLDER AS ME...
NICE...A VERY RICH MAN...



...BUT NOW, IN AUSCHWITZ, MANDELBAUM WAS A MESS.



HIS PANTS WERE
BIG LIKE FOR 2
PEOPLE, AND HE
HAD NOT EVEN A
PIECE OF STRING
TO MAKE A
BELT. HE HAD
ALL DAY TO
HOLD THEM
WITH ONE
HAND...

ONE SHOE, HIS FOOT
WAS TOO BIG TO
GO IN. THIS ALSO
HE HAD TO HOLD
SO HE COULD
FIND MAYBE
WITH WHOM TO
EXCHANGE IT.

ONE SHOE WAS
BIG LIKE A BOAT.
BUT THIS AT LEAST
HE COULD WEAR.

IT WAS WIN-
TER, AND EVERYWHERE
HE HAD TO
GO AROUND
WITH ONE
FOOT ONTO
THE SNOW.

CAN I USE YOUR SPOON,
VLADEK?

OF COURSE,
BUT WHERE'S
YOURS?



I DROPPED IT, AND BY THE
TIME I BENT DOWN, SOME-
ONE STOLE IT.



FOR A SPOON YOU COULD
GET A HALF DAY'S BREAD.

I SPILLED MOST OF MY
SOUP, TOO. WHEN I ASKED
FOR MORE, THEY BEAT ME!



I HOLD ONTO MY BOWL
AND MY SHOE FALLS DOWN.
I PICK UP THE SHOE AND
MY PANTS FALL DOWN!!!



BUT WHAT CAN I DO?
I ONLY HAVE TWO HANDS!



MY GOD. PLEASE GOD...
HELP ME FIND A PIECE OF
STRING AND A SHOE THAT FITS!



BUT HERE GOD DIDN'T COME.
WE WERE ALL ON OUR OWN.

SO, MANDELBAUM AND I WERE TWO IN A BED.
WE DIDN'T KNOW WHY, SINCE IT WAS SPACES LEFT.



BUT A DAY AFTER, THEY PUSHED IN A SHIP-
MENT OF MAYBE 400 MORE JEWS THERE.



IT WAS ROOM HARDLY
TO MOVE. ONLY TO GO
DOWN TO THE TOILET WAS
15 MINUTES WALKING ON
THE UNLUCKY ONES
SLEEPING ON THE FLOOR.



AND COMING BACK I COULDN'T
FIND AGAIN WHERE IS MY BED.



IN THE BARRACK WAS A KAPO-A SUPERVISOR-HE
WAS SCREAMING AND KICKING, WHATEVER HE COULD.



LINE UP IN ROWS OF FIVE, YOU SHITS!
STAND STRAIGHT!

HE WAS ALSO A PRISONER,
A PEASANT FROM THE
GERMAN PART OF POLAND.



NOW LIE ON YOUR
BELLIES. QUICK!



STAND UP!
LIE DOWN!

STAND UP!
FASTER!



LIE DOWN!

WE DID SUCH "SPORT" ALL DAY-KICKING, HITTING,
YELLING-TIL SOME DROPPED DEAD. THEN MORE.

ONE TIME THIS BLOCK SUPERVISOR STARTED SCREAMING ON US:



HE TOOK THEM APART... BUT SENT THEM SOON BACK.

IT WAS 8 OR 9 OF US. EACH HAD TO SPEAK A FEW WORDS.



I SPOKE ONLY ENGLISH TO HIM: FOR POLISH, I HAD A GOOD ENGLISH



IN THE MORNING, THE S.S. CHOSE WHO TO TAKE FOR THE DAY TO WORK. WEAK ONES THEY PUT ON THE SIDE TO TAKE AWAY FOREVER. BEFORE THEY CAME TO ME, THEY TOOK ENOUGH.



THE KAPO PUSHED THOSE REMAINING TO CLEAN UP IN THE BLOCK.



IT MUST BE IT'S HIS BREAKFAST. SEE HOW HAPPY HE HAS IT HERE!

I WAS AFRAID TO LOOK. I WAS SO HUNGRY, I COULD GRAB ALL OF IT!



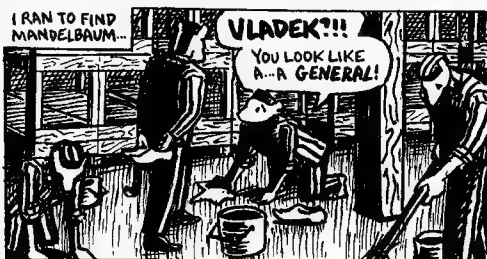
I ATE, ATE, ATE AS HE WATCHED. THEN I TAUGHT HIM A COUPLE HOURS AND WE SPOKE A LITTLE.





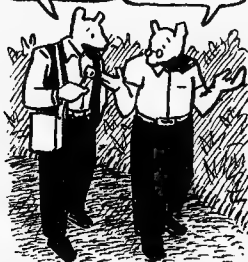
I EXPLAINED HIM EVERYTHING ABOUT MANDELBAUM.

I'M TELLING YOU - I WAS AMAZING WELL-OFF!



SO YOU DON'T KNOW WHAT HAPPENED TO MANDELBAUM?

HE GOT KILLED. OR HE DIED. I KNOW THEY FINISHED HIM.



MAYBE ON THE WALK TO WORK, A GUARD GRABBED HIS CAP AWAY.



THE GUARD GOT A CONGRATULATIONS AND A FEW DAYS VACATION FOR STOPPING THE ESCAPE.



THEY WANTED ONLY TO FINISH EVERYONE OUT. IT WAS VERY HARD WORK AND VERY LITTLE FOOD.



...MAYBE THEY KICKED AND HIT HIM IN HIS HEAD BECAUSE HE COULDN'T WORK FAST ENOUGH.



...OR MAYBE HE GOT SICK. SO THEY PUT HIM FIRST IN THE "HOSPITAL" AND THEN IN THE OVEN...



YOU SEE HOW THEY DID? AND I HAD IT STILL HAPPY THERE. FOR ME IT WAS NOT YET THE END.

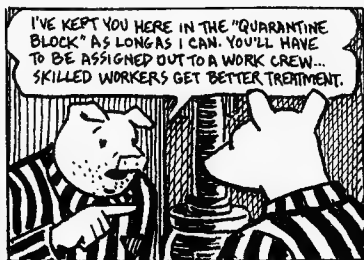
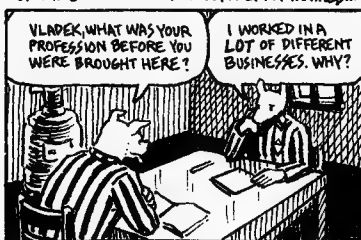


NEWCOMERS WERE AFRAID FROM ME. I LOOKED LIKE A BIG SHOT AND THE KAPO KEPT ME CLOSE.

THEY'LL WANT 200 WORKERS TOMORROW. I'VE ONLY GOT 180 STILL REGISTERED HERE. ...YOU'D BETTER HIDE IN MY ROOM...



OF THE GROUP WHEN I ARRIVED, ONLY I REMAINED...

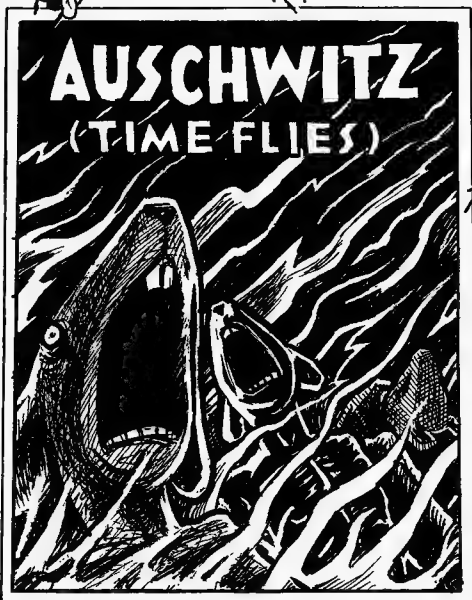


ALWAYS AROUND AUSCHWITZ THEY WERE BUILDING. TO THE ROOFS THEY NEEDED GOOD TIMMEN.

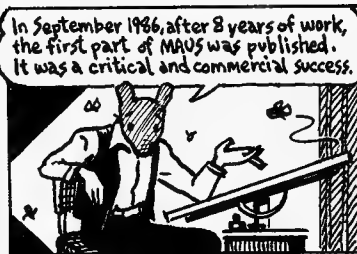
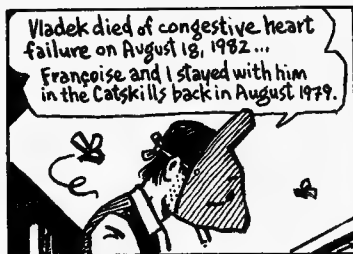




C H A P T E R T W O



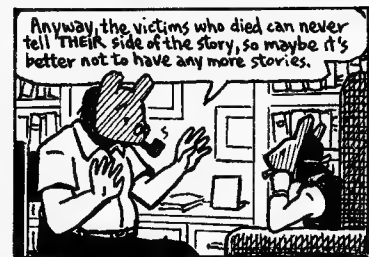
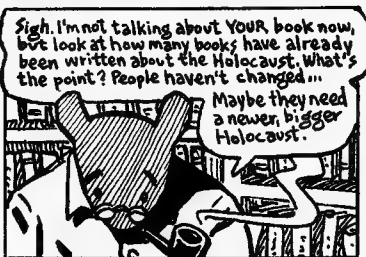
Time flies...











My book? Hah! What book?? Some part of me doesn't want to draw or think about Auschwitz. I can't visualize it clearly, and I can't BEGIN to imagine what it felt like.



What Auschwitz felt like? Hmm... How can I explain?...
BOO!

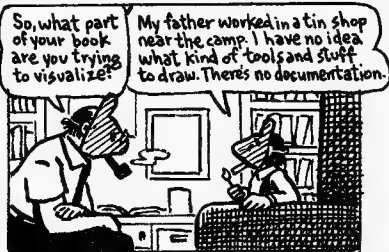


It felt a little like *that*. But ALWAYS! From the moment you got to the gate until the very end.

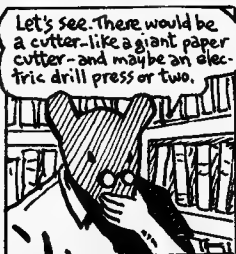


So, what part of your book are you trying to visualize?

My father worked in a tin shop near the camp. I have no idea what kind of tools and stuff to draw. There's no documentation.



Let's see. There would be a cutter-like a giant paper cutter - and maybe an electric drill press or two.



How do you KNOW that?

Oh, I worked in a tool and die shop in Czechoslovakia when I was a kid.



But it's getting late now, and I still have to walk my dogs.

Okay, I'll see you in a week...



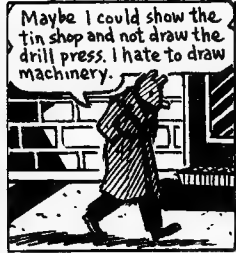
Gee, I don't understand exactly why...



but these sessions with Pavel somehow make me feel better...



Maybe I could show the tin shop and not draw the drill press. I hate to draw machinery.



And so...

... THEN, WHEN I CAME OUT FROM THE HOSPITAL, RIGHT AWAY SHE STARTED AGAIN THAT I CHANGE MY WILL!



I WAS STILL SO SICK AND TIRED. AND TO HAVE PEACE ONLY, I AGREED. TO MAKE IT LEGAL SHE BROUGHT RIGHT TO MY BED A NOTARY.



FIFTEEN DOLLARS HE CHARGED TO COME! IF SHE WAITED ONLY A WEEK UNTIL I WAS STRONGER, I'D GO TO THE BANK AND TAKE A NOTARY FOR ONLY A QUARTER!



sigh
YOU WERE TELLING ME HOW YOUR KAPO TRIED TO GET YOU WORK AS A TINSMITH...



THE CHIEF OF THE TINMEN IT WAS A RUSSIAN JEW NAMED YIDL.



I'VE ONLY BEEN A TINSMITH FOR A FEW YEARS. IF YOU SHOW ME HOW YOU WANT IT CUT I CAN LEARN QUICKLY.



HAH! YOU NEVER DID AN HONEST DAY'S WORK IN YOUR WHOLE LIFE, SPIEGELMAN! I KNOW ALL ABOUT YOU...



YOU OWNED BIG FACTORIES AND EXPLOITED YOUR WORKERS, YOU DIRTY CAPITALIST!



PFUI! THEY SEND DREK LIKE YOU HERE WHILE THEY SEND REAL TINMEN UP THE CHIMNEY. WATCH OUT, I'VE GOT MY EYE ON YOU!



WITH THE OTHER BOYS THERE, I GOT ALONG FINE.



BRING HIM A FEW EGGS,
SOME BUTTER OR CHEESE...

YOU'LL SEE. HE'LL SING
A DIFFERENT TUNE.



HA! AND
WHERE DO
I GET ALL
THIS FOOD?

JUST KEEP YOUR
EYES OPEN. YOU
CAN ORGANIZE
THINGS WITH
THE POLES HERE.



POLES FROM NEARBY THEY HIRED TO WORK ALSO HERE--
NOT PRISONERS, BUT SPECIALIST BUILDING WORKERS...

(PSST-I CAN GET YOU
A FINE GOLD WATCH
FOR A POUND OF SAV-
SAGE AND SIX EGGS.)

(AGREED.)



THEY HAD NOTHING, ONLY FOOD FROM THEIR
FARMS. THEY WERE HAPPY TO MAKE EXCHANGES.

THE HEAD GUY FROM THE AUSCHWITZ LAUN-
DRY WAS A FINE FELLOW WHAT KNEW WELL
MY FAMILY BEFORE THE WAR...

FROM HIM I GOT CIVILIAN CLOTHINGS TO
SMUGGLE OUT BELOW MY UNIFORM. I WAS SO
THIN THE GUARDS DIDN'T SEE IF I WORE EXTRA.



HERE YIDL. I'VE
GOT A BIG PIECE
OF CHEESE FOR YOU.

A GIFT?
VERY NICE,
SPIEGELMAN.

AND WHAT ELSE DO YOU
HAVE THERE? A LOAF OF
BREAD? YOU'RE A RICH MAN!

WAIT! I NEED THAT TO PAY
OFF THE GUY WHO HELPED
ME ORGANIZE THE CHEESE!



HMPH.

HE WAS SO GREEDY, YIDL, HE
WANTED I RISK ONLY FOR HIM
EVERYTHING. I TOO HAD TO EAT.

EVERYBODY WAS SO HUNGRY ALWAYS, WE DIDN'T KNOW EVEN WHAT WE ARE DOING...

IN THE MORNING FOR BREAKFAST WE GOT ONLY A BITTER DRINK MADE FROM ROOTS.

I WOKE BEFORE EVERYBODY TO HAVE TIME TO THE TOILET AND FIND STILL SOME TEA LEFT.

ONE TIME A DAY THEY GAVE A SOUP FROM TURNIPS TO STAND NEAR THE FIRST OF THE LINE WAS NO GOOD. YOU GOT ONLY WATER.

MIX IT! MIX IT!

NEAR THE END WAS BETTER - SOLID THINGS TO THE BOTTOM FLOATED.

BUT TOO FAR TO THE END IT WAS ALSO NO GOOD

..BECAUSE MANY TIMES IT COULD BE NO SOUP ANYMORE.

AND ONE TIME EACH DAY THEY GAVE TO US A SMALL BREAD, CRUNCHY LIKE GLASS.

THE FLOUR THEY MIXED WITH SAWDUST TOGETHER - WE GOT ONE LITTLE BRICK OF THIS WHAT HAD TO LAST THE FULL DAY.

MOST GOBBLED IT RIGHT AWAY, BUT ALWAYS I SAVED A HALF FOR LATER.

AND IN THE EVENING WE GOT A SPOILED CHEESE OR JAM. IF WE WERE LUCKY A COUPLE TIMES A WEEK WE GOT A SAUSAGE BIG LIKE TWO OF MY FINGERS. ONLY THIS MUCH WE GOT

IF YOU ATE HOW THEY GAVE YOU, IT WAS JUST ENOUGH TO DIE MORE SLOWLY.

EACH MORNING AND EVENING THEY MADE AN APPEL. THEY COUNTED THE LIVE ONES AND DEAD ONES TO SEE IT WASN'T ANY MISSING ...



WE STOOD SOMETIMES THE WHOLE NIGHT WHILE THEY COUNTED AGAIN AND AGAIN.



ON OUR APPELS IT WAS ONE OLD GUY THERE, ALWAYS HE WAS COMPLAINING ...

I DON'T BELONG HERE WITH ALL THESE YIDS AND POLACKS!

I'M A GERMAN LIKE YOU!



I HAVE MEDALS FROM THE KAISER. MY SON IS A GERMAN SOLDIER!

ONLY THEY HIT HIM AND THEY LAUGHED.



WAS HE REALLY A GERMAN?

WHO KNOWS. IT WAS GERMAN PRISONERS ALSO... BUT FOR THE GERMAN THIS GUY WAS JEWISH!



ON ONE APPEL HE DIDN'T STAND SO STRAIGHT AND A GUARD DRAGGED HIM AWAY. I HEARD HE PUSHED HIM DOWN AND JUMPED HARD ON HIS NECK...

OR THEY SENT HIM TO THE GAS, I DON'T REMEMBER, BUT THEY FINISHED HIM AND HE NEVER ANYMORE COMPLAINED.

TELL ME ABOUT MOM.
WERE YOU IN TOUCH
WITH HER IN AUSCHWITZ.

YA-

IN THE BEGINNING I KNEW
ONLY HER NUMBER, AND THAT
SHE WAS THERE. IN BIRKENAU.

THIS I FOUND OUT BY WORKERS
FROM BIRKENAU WHAT PASSED
WHERE I WAS TEACHING ENGLISH.

WHERE WAS
BIRKENAU?

THE CAMP WAS
A PART FROM
AUSCHWITZ...

Workshops and
camp extension.

Ausch-
witz I

Auschwitz II
Birkenau

IT WAS MAYBE 2 MILES TO GO
FROM AUSCHWITZ TO BIRKENAU
THERE IT WAS MUCH MORE BIG.

IN AUSCHWITZ WE HAD, SAY,
20,000 PRISONERS, IN BIRKENAU
WAS AT LEAST 5 TIMES SO MANY.

AUSCHWITZ, IT WAS A CAMP
WHERE THEY GAVE YOU TO WORK
SO THEY DIDN'T FINISH YOU SO FAST.

BIRKENAU WAS EVEN MORE
BAD. IT WAS 800 PEOPLE IN A
BUILDING MADE FOR 50 HORSES.

THERE IT WAS JUST A DEATH
PLACE WITH JEWS WAITING FOR
GAS...AND THERE IT WAS ANJA.

COME...IT'S TIME NOW
WE'LL HURRY FOR LUNCH
HOME TO THE BUNGALOW.

SO YOU WERE ACTUALLY
IN TOUCH WITH ANJA IN BIRKENAU?

YAH. FROM MANCIE I HAD A REAL
CONTACT WITH MOTHER, UNTIL
LATER I COULD BRING ANJA TO-

WAIT!
WHO'S MANCIE?

SHE WAS A HUNGARIAN, MANCIE, WHO
WORKED SOMETIMES THERE. BEAUTIFUL.
A TALL BLONDE GIRL. AND CLEVER.

REST BEHIND THAT STACK
OF WOOD. I'LL WARN YOU
IF A GUARD COMES CLOSE.

SHE HAD A LOVER, I HEARD LATER. AN S.S.
MAN. HE GOT FOR HER A GOOD POSITION
OVER 10 OR 12 OTHER GIRLS FROM BIRKENAU.

(PSST, MISS-UP HERE!
I SEE HOW KIND YOU
ARE. HELP ME, PLEASE!)

HUH? (WHAT
DO YOU WANT?)

(NOTHING FOR ME, BUT I'M
AFRAID FOR MY WIFE IN
BIRKENAU. CAN YOU FIND
OUT IF SHE'S STILL ALIVE?)

I TOLD TO HER ANJA'S NAME AND NUMBER.

(I'VE SAVED SOME FOOD.
I CAN PAY FOR YOUR HELP.)

(KEEP YOUR FOOD. WE'LL
BE WORKING HERE AGAIN
IN A FEW DAYS. I'LL SEE
WHAT I CAN FIND OUT.)

EACH DAY I LOOKED. FOUR DAYS AFTER, I SAW HER.

I MET A WOMAN
NAMED ANJA FROM
SOSNOWIEC. SHE'S
VERY FRAIL...

SHE SPOKE OVER TO ONE OF HER WORKERS; I
SPOKE ONLY TO MY TIN SO NOBODY WILL NOTICE.

SOMEONE TOLD HER
THAT HER HUSBAND
IS STILL ALIVE AND
SHE STARTED SOB-
BING WITH JOY.

I HEARD THIS, AND I STARTED ALSO CRYING A
LITTLE. AND MANCIE, SHE TOO STARTED CRYING.

A FEW DAYS AFTER, MANCIE AGAIN CAME THERE.



SHE TOLD ME HER KAPO WAS VERY MEAN ON HER AND GAVE WORK ANJA REALLY COULDN'T DO.

EVEN FOR ME SUCH CANS WERE HEAVY, AND FOR ANJA- SHE WAS SO SMALL- IT WAS IMPOSSIBLE.



I WROTE TO HER, "I THINK OF YOU ALWAYS," AND SENT WITH MANCIE TWO PIECES OF BREAD.



IF THE S.S. WOULD SEE SHE IS TAKING FOOD INTO THE CAMP, RIGHT AWAY THEY WILL KILL HER. BUT ALWAYS SHE TOOK.



SO SHE SAID, "IF A COUPLE IS LOVING EACH OTHER SO MUCH, I MUST HELP HOWEVER I CAN."



EACH DAY I MARCHED TO WORK AND HOPED AGAIN I'LL SEE MANCIE...



I JUST READ ABOUT THE CAMP ORCHESTRA THAT PLAYED AS YOU MARCHED OUT THE GATE...

AN ORCHESTRA?...



NO. I REMEMBER ONLY MARCHING, NOT ANY ORCHESTRAS...



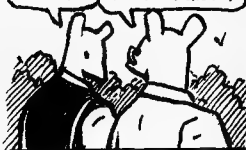
I DUNNO, BUT IT'S VERY WELL DOCUMENTED...

NO. AT THE GATE I HEARD ONLY GUARDS SHOUTING.



DID YOU EVER TALK WITH ANY OF THE GUARDS?

ACH! WE WERE BELOW THEIR DIGNITY. WE WERE NOT EVEN MEN. BUT IT WAS ONE GUY...



IF HE SPOKE OF COURSE I ANSWERED. HE HAD EVEN A LITTLE HEART.

AAH. GUTEN MORGEN. THIS SPRING AIR REMINDS ME OF HOME... OF NUREMBERG...

YES. I WAS THERE ONCE. IT'S A BEAUTIFUL CITY.



AND IF HE LIKED ME, MAYBE SOMEDAY HE WON'T SHOOT ME.

ONE TIME HE WAS MISSING A FEW DAYS...



YOU LOOK PALE. WERE YOU SICK HERR SOLDAT?

NO... I WAS... WORKING... IN BIAKENAU.

YES... I'VE HEARD ABOUT WHAT GOES ON THERE...

SHUT UP!



AND HE WAS AFRAID ANYMORE TO SPEAK.

WHEN I VISITED TO ANJA THERE, I SAW WITH MY OWN EYES HOW IT WAS...

YOU SAW ANJA?

YA. EVERY FEW DAYS IT CAME AN S.S. COMMISSION TO THE TIN SHOP...

YOU HAVE MORE WORKERS THAN YOU NEED HERE...

GIVE US 10 PRISONERS TO TAKE BACK TO THE MAIN CAMP FOR OTHER WORK.

WELL... TAKE THAT ONE... AND THAT ONE...

AND - WAIT! DON'T TAKE HIM! HE'S ONE OF MY BEST ROOFERS... TAKE THAT ONE... AND THAT ONE...

THE UNLUCKY ONES WENT OVER FOR BAD JOBS, BUT ME YIDL KEPT PROTECTED.

..SEND A CREW TO SECTOR B1B IN BIRKENAU. SOME OF THE ROOFS IN THE WOMEN'S CAMP HAVE COLLAPSED.

LET ME GO TO BIRKENAU. I'VE NEVER SEEN IT.

GO, SPIEGELMAN, AND DON'T COME BACK FOR ALL I CARE. BAH! I GIVE UP MY BEST TINMEN, AND YOU I SAVE.

WHY?!

SO I MARCHED WITH A FEW TINMEN OVER TO BIRKENAU. I CAME THE FIRST TIME IN SUMMER 1944.

THOUSANDS - HUNDREDS OF THOUSANDS OF HUNGARIANS WERE ARRIVING THERE AT THIS TIME.

INSIDE THE CAMP WE CALLED OUT. MAYBE SOME-
BODY KNEW IF OUR LOVED ONES ARE HERE ALIVE.



MY GOD. THAT'S
VLADEK! I'LL
GO FIND ANJA!

I WAS SO HAPPY. SOMEONE
BROUGHT SOMEHOW ANJA OVER.



I WAS A FEW TIMES IN BIRKENAU, AND ONCE I HAD REALLY TROUBLES. I WAS GOING FROM WORK AND PASSED BY ANJA...



A GUARD SCREAMED TO ME:



THE NEXT DAYS IT WAS HARD TO GO WORK, BUT TO GO TO THE HOSPITAL, I COULD EASY NOT COME AGAIN OUT.



IT WASN'T A PLACE WITH MEDICINES, ONLY A PLACE FULL WITH PRISONERS TOO SICK TO GO WORK.



EACH DAY IT WAS SELECTIONS. THE DOCTORS CHOSE OUT THE WEAKER ONES TO GO AND DIE.



IN THE WHOLE CAMP WAS SELECTIONS. I WENT TWO TIMES IN FRONT OF DR. MENGELE.



WE STOOD WITHOUT ANYTHING, STRAIGHT LIKE A SOLDIER. HE GLANCED AND SAID: "FACE LEFT!"



THEY LOOKED TO SEE IF IT WAS SORES OR PIMPLES ON THE BODY. THEN AGAIN: "FACE LEFT!"



THEY LOOKED TO SEE IF EATING NO FOOD MADE YOU TOO SKINNY...

FACE LEFT!



IF YOU HAD STILL A HEALTHY BODY TO WORK, THEY PASSED YOU THROUGH AND GAVE YOU ANOTHER UNIFORM UNTIL IT CAME THE NEXT SELECTION...



WHEN FIRST I CAME I WAS VERY STRONG THEN, AND CAME WELL TO THE GOOD SIDE.

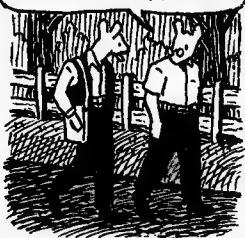


THE ONES THAT HAD NOT SO LUCKY THE SS. WROTE DOWN THEIR NUMBER AND SENT TO THE OTHER SIDE.

THE SECOND SELECTION I WAS IN THE BARRACK IN THE BED UP FROM ME WAS A FINE BOY, A BELGIAN.



THEY TOOK THEN THE JEWS TO A SELECTION. I CAME AGAIN TO THE GOOD SIDE, BUT THIS BELGIAN, HE HAD MAYBE A RASH, AND THEY WROTE HIS NUMBER...



ANY TIME THEY COULD TAKE HIM. ALL NIGHT HE CRIED AND SCREAMED.



SOB

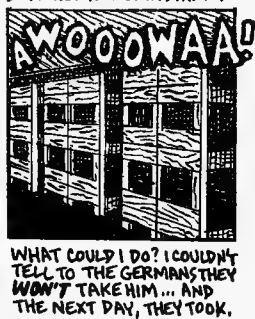
LOOK, THEY'RE GOING TO KILL ALL OF US HERE EVENTUALLY... YOU THIS WEEK, ME THE NEXT...



...NONE OF US CAN ESCAPE IT. YOU MUST BE BRAVE... AND, WHO KNOWS, MAYBE IT'S NOT EVEN YOUR TURN YET...



BUT LATER HE AGAIN STARTED...



SO... IN THE TINSHOP I HAD STILL THE SAME STORY WITH YIDL.

A LOT OF THE POLISH PRISONERS WERE SENT TO CAMPS INSIDE THE REICH. THEY TOOK SOME OF MY BOYS TOO.

ONLY ONE APPLE FOR ME TODAY? IS BUSINESS BAD, MR. CAPITALIST?

WHAT HAPPENED TO THE SHOEMAKER WHO WORKED IN THERE?



I RAN TO THE KAPO IN CHARGE FROM ALL THE SHOP.

DO YOU NEED A NEW SHOEMAKER?

SURE, THE S.S. TOOK THE OLD ONE AWAY, BUT THEY'RE STILL BRINGING SHOES IN!



YOU KNOW, I'VE BEEN A SHOEMAKER SINCE CHILDHOOD.

YOU DON'T LOOK LIKE A SHOEMAKER TO ME... YOU'RE A TINMAN!



DO I HAVE TO HAVE IT WRITTEN ON MY FOREHEAD?

ALRIGHT, THEN... FIX THIS!



I LEARNED A LITTLE SHOE FIXING WATCHING HOW THEY WORKED WHEN I WAS WITH MY COUS- IN MILOCH, THERE IN THE GHETTO SHOE SHOP.

TO FIX SUCH AN OPENED SOLE I KNEW TO TAKE A DOUBLE THREAD SMEARED WITH WAX.



...MAKE THEN A HOLE AND PUSH THE THREAD HALF WAY ONLY.

AND ON THE UPPER PART PUT TWO HOLES EVEN TO THE SOLE...



BRING THE THREAD THEN THROUGH THESE HOLES.



CROSS THE THREAD FROM THE TOP AND BOTTOM, BOTH ENDS THROUGH A NEW HOLE IN THE SOLE AND REPEAT SO UNTIL THE SHOE IS CLOSED.



...AND SO IT'S MADE, YOU CAN'T EVEN SEE IT HAS STITCHES!

YOU'RE BETTER THAN OUR LAST SHOEMAKER!



YOU SEE? IT'S GOOD TO KNOW HOW TO DO EVERYTHING!

SO, NOW I WAS A SHOEMAKER. I HAD HERE A WARM AND PRIVATE ROOM WHERE TO SIT...



OFFICIALS LIKED BETTER IF I FIX THEIR SHOES THAN TO SEND TO THE BIG SHOP INSIDE CAMP



I KNEW TO FIX SOLES AND HEELS, BUT WHAT THIS GESTAPO WANTED, IT NEEDED A SPECIALIST.

SO, GOING FROM WORK, I HID THIS BOOT TO SNEAK IT TO A REAL SHOEMAKER IN AUSCHWITZ.



NEXT DAY I HAD THE BOOT READY FOR THIS GESTAPO.

HE LEFT THE BOOT AND WENT WITHOUT ONE WORD.



AND HE CAME BACK WITH A WHOLE SAUSAGE.



YOU KNOW WHAT THIS WAS, A WHOLE SAUSAGE? YOU CAN'T IMAGINE! I CUT WITH A SHOE KNIFE AND ATE SO FAST I WAS A LITTLE SICK AFTER.

I COULDN'T ANYMORE MAKE A BUSINESS SMUG-GLING WITH POLISH WORKERS FROM HERE AS A SHOEMAKER, BUT STILL I WAS WELL-OFF...



THE GESTAPO WHAT I FIXED HIS BOOT RECOM-MENDED ME, SO HIS FRIENDS WANTED I'LL FIX ALSO THEIR SHOES AND PAID ME FOOD.



I SHARED SOMETIMES TO THE KAPO IN CHARGE.

I JUST ORGANIZED SOME EGGS-WANT ONE?

WHAT A FRIENDLY JEW! SURE-WE CAN COOK THEM ON MY HEATER.



IF YOU WANT TO LIVE, IT'S GOOD TO BE FRIENDLY.

AND HERE'S A LITTLE BREAD FOR OUR MEAL.

GREAT! SAY, WHAT ARE ALL THOSE NEW BUILDINGS THEY'RE PUTTING UP THERE?



JUST SOME NEW WORKSHOPS. THEY'RE EXPANDING THE UNION WERKE MUNI-TIONS FACTORY...



AND THEY'RE PUTTING UP SOME BARRACKS TO MOVE SOME WOMEN WORKERS FROM BIRKENAU OVER HERE.



M-MY WIFE IS IN BIR-KENAU. MAYBE I COULD GET HER INTO ONE OF THOSE BARRACKS!

HAH! IMPOSSIBLE! IT WOULD COST A FORTUNE IN BRIBES!



HE UNWRAPPED SOME CHEESE AND ATE HIMSELF A PIECE.

PLEASE. COULD I HAVE THAT PIECE OF PAPER?

WELL, SURE. I CAN LET YOU HAVE THE PAPER - BUT NOT THE CHEESE!



I NEEDED TO WRITE OVER TO ANJA!



ANJA'S BARRACK WAS MAYBE 1000 GIRLS WITH A BAD KAPO WHAT HIT ANYBODY WHAT CAME NEAR.



I THOUGHT ONLY HOW HAPPY IT WOULD BE TO HAVE ANJA SO NEAR TO ME IN THESE NEW BARRACKS.



IT COULD BE "ARRANGED" FOR 100 CIGARETTES AND A BOTTLE VODKA, BUT THIS WAS A FORTUNE.



HOW COULD YOU GET CIGARETTES?

EACH WEEK TO THE WORKERS, THEY GAVE US THREE.



THEY ISSUED A LUXURY LIKE THAT?

YA. AND IF YOU DON'T SMOKE YOU CAN EXCHANGE FOR BREAD.



I STARVED A LITTLE TO PAY TO BRING ANJA OVER.

BUT, WHEN I CAME BACK ONE TIME FROM WORK...



YOU LEFT THE BOX IN THE BARRACK? HOW COULD IT NOT BE TAKEN?

I DIDN'T THINK ON IT...

BUT EVERYONE WAS STARVING TO DEATH! SIGH-I GUESS I JUST DON'T UNDERSTAND.

YES... ABOUT AUSCHWITZ, NOBODY CAN UNDERSTAND.



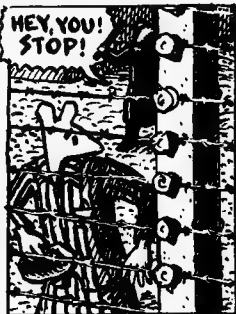
SO... I SAVED A SECOND TIME A FORTUNE, AND GAVE OVER BRIBES TO BRING ANJA CLOSE TO ME. AND IN THE START OF OCTOBER, 1944, I SAW A FEW THOUSAND WOMEN IN THESE NEW BARRACKS...



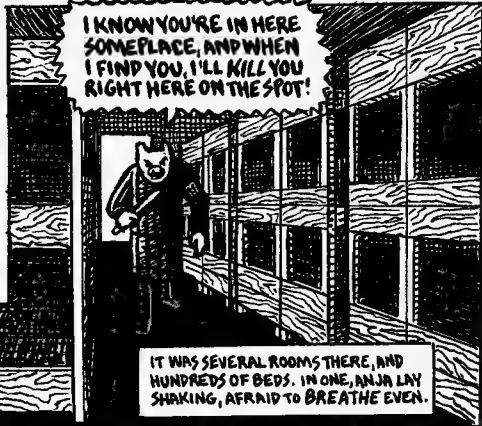
WHEN NOBODY SAW I WENT BACK AND FORTH UNTIL I SAW HER FROM FAR GOING TO MAKE MUNITIONS...

SHE WENT ALSO BACK AND FORTH UNTIL IT WAS SAFE TO APPROACH OVER TO MY FOOD PACKAGES...

BUT ONE TIME, IT WAS VERY BAD.



ONLY A FRIEND FROM ANJA WAS THERE AS A ROOM CLEANER...



I KNOW YOU'RE IN HERE SOMEPLACE, AND WHEN I FIND YOU, I'LL KILL YOU RIGHT HERE ON THE SPOT!

IT WAS SEVERAL ROOMS THERE, AND HUNDREDS OF BEDS. IN ONE, ANJA LAY SHAKING, AFRAID TO BREATHE EVEN.



ON THE EVENING APPEL SHE CAME AGAIN THIS KAPO.



SHE MADE THEM TO RUN, TO JUMP, TO BEND UNTIL THEY COULDN'T ANYMORE. THEN MORE, THE SAME.





I HAD TO STOP SENDING OVER SUCH PACKAGES MORE TO ANJA.

I LOST ANYWAY MY JOB NEAR TO HER SOON AFTER. MY WHOLE WORKSHOP THEY CLOSED OUT...

THEY PUT US BACK TO THE MAIN CAMP AND TOOK ME FOR BLACK WORK.

BLACK WORK?

CARRYING BACK AND FORTH BIG STONES, DIGGING OUT HOLES, EACH DAY DIFFERENT, BUT ALWAYS THE SAME. VERY HARD...



AND GOD FORBID, IF YOU STOPPED ONLY A MINUTE TO BREATHE.

YOU GOT A HIT TO THE HEAD, OR WORSE.



TO ME THEY NEVER HIT, BECAUSE I WORKED ALL MY MUSCLES AWAY.

I LIKED BETTER INDOORS WORK. I SOMETIMES WAS A "BETNACH-ZIEHER"... A BED-AFTER-PULLER...

AFTER EVERYBODY FIXED THEIR BED, WE CAME TO FIX BETTER, SO THE STRAW LOOKED SQUARE.

WHAT A CRAZY JOB!

NO. THEY WANTED EVERYTHING NEAT AND IN GOOD ORDER.



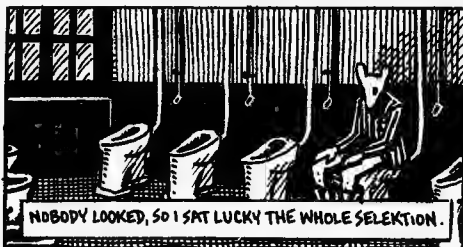
BUT THESE DAYS I GOT TOO SKINNY AND IT CAME AGAIN A SELECTION.

RIGHT AWAY I RAN INSIDE THE TOILETS. AND IF SOMEBODY LOOKED, I'LL TELL I HAD A BAD STOMACH. WHAT HAD I TO LOSE?

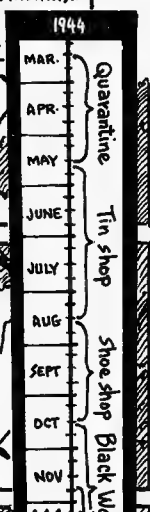
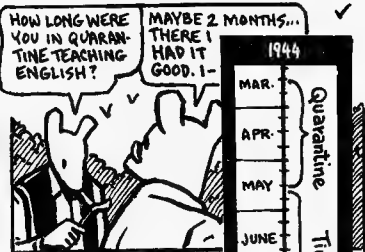
BLOCKSPERRE!

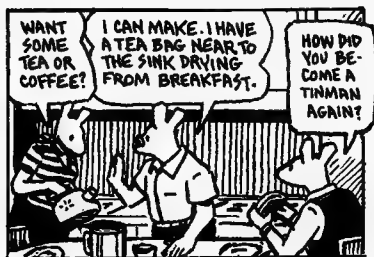


NOW IT COULD BE MY TURN.

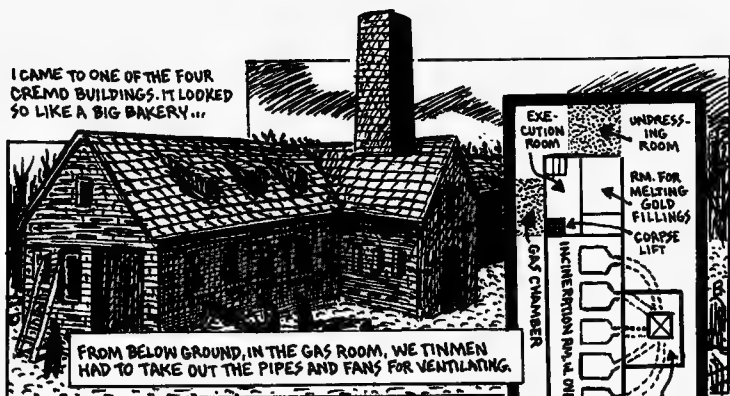


NBODY LOOKED, SO I SAT LUCKY THE WHOLE SELECTION.

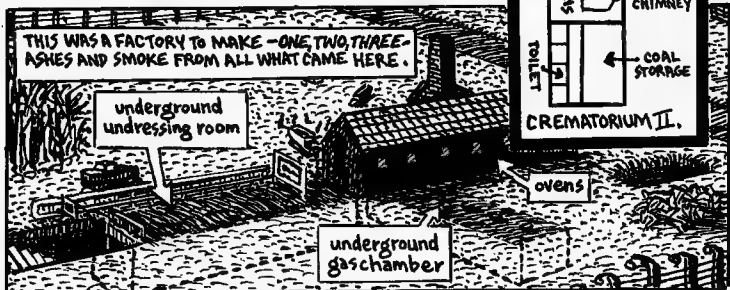




I CAME TO ONE OF THE FOUR CREMO BUILDINGS. IT LOOKED SO LIKE A BIG BAKERY...



THIS WAS A FACTORY TO MAKE - ONE, TWO, THREE - ASHES AND SMOKE FROM ALL WHAT CAME HERE.



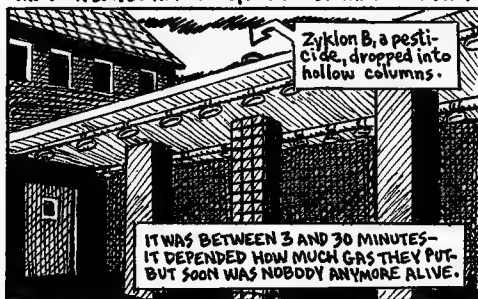
SPECIAL PRISONERS WORKED HERE SEPARATE. THEY GOT BETTER BREAD, BUT EACH FEW MONTHS THEY ALSO WERE SENT UP THE CHIMNEY. ONE FROM THEM SHOWED ME EVERYTHING HOW IT WAS.



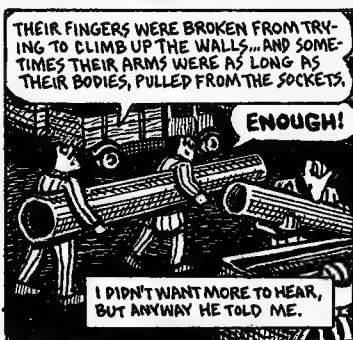
THEY CAME TO A BIG ROOM TO UNDRESS THEIR CLOTHES WHAT LOOKS SO, YES - HERE IS A PLACE SO LIKE THEY SAY.



AND EVERYBODY CROWDED INSIDE INTO THE SHOWER ROOM, THE DOOR CLOSED HERMETIC, AND THE LIGHTS TURNED DARK.



THIS GUY WHO WORKED THERE, HE TOLD ME...



THEY PULLED THE BODIES WITH AN ELEVATOR UP TO THE OVENS—MANY OVENS—AND TO EACH ONE THEY BURNED 2 OR 3 AT A TIME.



WHAT ARE THEY DOING
OVER THERE- DIGGING
TRENCHES IN CASE
THE RUSSIANS ATTACK?

TRENCHES... HAH!
THOSE ARE GIANT
GRAVES THEY'RE
FILLING IN! ...



IT STARTED IN MAY AND WENT ON ALL
SUMMER. THEY BROUGHT JEWS FROM
HUNGARY- TOO MANY FOR THEIR OVENS,
SO THEY DUG THOSE BIG CREMATION PITS.



THE HOLES WERE BIG, SO
LIKE THE SWIMMING POOL
OF THE PINES HOTEL HERE.

AND TRAIN AFTER TRAIN
OF HUNGARIANS CAME.

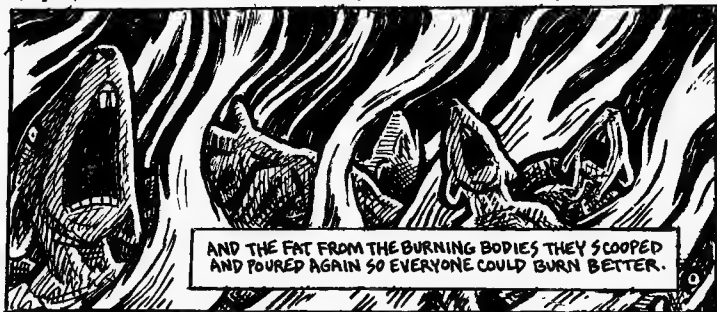


AND THOSE WHAT FINISHED IN THE GAS CHAMBERS BEFORE
THEY GOT PUSHED IN THESE GRAVES, IT WAS THE LUCKY ONES.

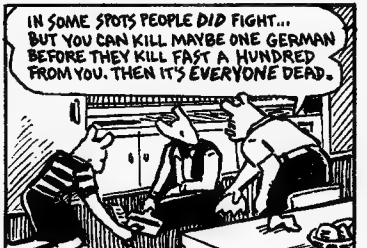


THE OTHERS HAD TO JUMP IN THE GRAVES
WHILE STILL THEY WERE ALIVE ...

PRISONERS WHAT WORKED THERE POURED GASOLINE OVER THE LIVE ONES AND THE DEAD ONES.



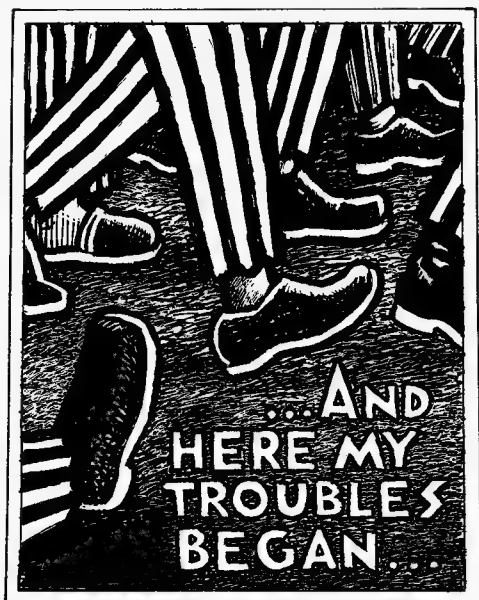
AND THE FAT FROM THE BURNING BODIES THEY SCOOPED
AND POURED AGAIN SO EVERYONE COULD BURN BETTER.



That night...



C H A P T E R T H R E E







And so ...

LOOK, I'M SORRY
I SNAPPED AT
YOU BEFORE ...

YES, THE WALLS ARE
SO THIN, THE NEIGHBORS
CAN HEAR EVERYTHING.



I MEAN, FRANCOISE AND I ARE BOTH
WORRIED ABOUT YOU NOW THAT MALA
IS GONE, BUT YOU CAN'T EXPECT US
TO MOVE IN WITH YOU PERMANENTLY ...



WHAT PERMANENTLY? I WANT ONLY YOU'LL
ENJOY HERE THE SUMMER WITH ME...IT'S
PAID ALREADY IN FULL, WITH NO REFUND.



HOW WILL YOU
MANAGE, LIVING
IN REGO PARK
ALL ALONE?

ALONE I CAN
MANAGE MORE
EASY THAN WITH
MALA, BELIEVE ME.



COME, WE'LL SIT
ALL THREE TOGETHER
IN THE FRONT.

Y'KNOW...LAST
NIGHT I WAS
READING ABOUT
AUSCHWITZ ...



SOME PRISONERS WORKING IN THE GAS
CHAMBERS REVOLTED. THEY KILLED
3 SS MEN AND BLEW UP A CREMATORIUM.

YAH. FOR THIS
THEY ALL
GOT KILLED.



AND THE FOUR YOUNG GIRLS WHAT SNEAKED OVER THE AMMUNI-
TIONS FOR THIS, THEY HANGED THEM NEAR TO MY WORKSHOP.

THEY WERE GOOD FRIENDS OF
ANJA, FROM SOSNOWIEC. THEY
HANGED A LONG, LONG TIME. SIGH.



A COUPLE WEEKS MORE AND THEY WOULDN'T HANG...
IT WAS VERY NEAR TO THE END, THERE IN AUSCHWITZ.



IF WE CAN JUST STAY
ALIVE A LITTLE BIT
LONGER, THE RUSSIANS
WILL BE HERE.



THIS BOY WORKED IN THE
OFFICE AND KNEW RUMORS.

THE GERMANS ARE
GETTING WORRIED.
THE BIG SHOTS HERE
ARE ALREADY RUNNING
BACK INTO THE REICH.



THEY'RE PLANNING TO
TAKE EVERYBODY HERE
BACK TO CAMPS INSIDE
GERMANY. EVERYBODY!



BUT A FEW OF US
HAVE A PLAN!!!
WE'RE NOT GOING!



YOU HAVE A FRIEND
IN THE CAMP LAUNDRY.
HELP US GET CIVILIAN
CLOTHES AND JOIN US.



HE TOOK ME QUICK TO AN ATTIC IN ONE OF THE BLOCKS.



WE ARRANGED THERE CLOTHING AND EVEN IDENTITY
PAPERS, AND HALF EACH DAYS BREAD WE PUT OVER HERE.



THEN THIS GUY FROM THE OFFICE RAN IN...



FINALLY THEY *DIDN'T* BOMB, BUT THIS WE COULDN'T KNOW. WE LEFT BEHIND EVERY-
THING, WE WERE SO AFRAID, EVEN THE CIVILIAN CLOTHES WE ORGANIZED. AND RAN OUT!



ALL NIGHT I HEARD SHOOTING. HE WHO GOT TIRED, WHO CAN'T WALK SO FAST, THEY SHOT.



AND IN THE DAYLIGHT, FAR AHEAD, I SAW IT.



SOMEBODY IS JUMPING, TURNING, ROLLING 25 OR 35 TIMES AROUND. AND STOPS.



WHEN I WAS A BOY OUR NEIGHBOR HAD A DOG WHAT GOT MAD AND WAS BITING.



THE DOG WAS ROLLING SO AROUND AND AROUND, KICKING, BEFORE HE LAY QUIET.



ONE OF THE BOYS WHAT WE WERE IN THE ATTIC TOGETHER, TALKED OVER TO THE GUARD...



ALL DAY LONG THEY WERE ARRANGING...



AT NIGHT WAS A COMMOTION. 8 OR 9 RAN OFF...



AND SO WE CAME OVER TO GROSS-ROSEN. HERE WAS A SMALL CAMP, WITH NO GAS.



EVERYWHERE WAS CONFUSION AND HITTING. TERRIBLE!

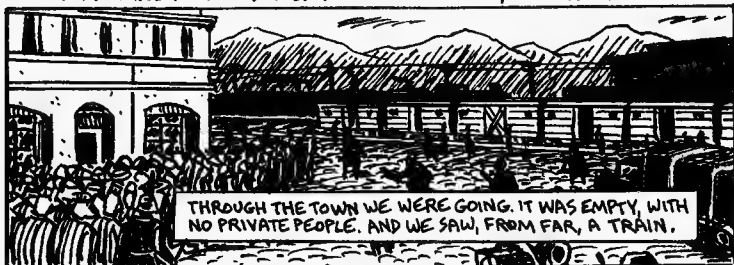


MOST COULDN'T EVEN LIFT THEY WERE WEAK FROM MARCHING AND NO FOOD.

BEHIND I HEARD YELLING AND SHOUTING. I DIDN'T LOOK.



IN THE MORNING THEY CHASED US TO MARCH AGAIN OUT, WHO KNOWS WHERE...



THROUGH THE TOWN WE WERE GOING. IT WAS EMPTY, WITH NO PRIVATE PEOPLE. AND WE SAW, FROM FAR, A TRAIN.

IT WAS SUCH A TRAIN FOR HORSES, FOR COWS.

THEY PUSHED UNTIL IT WAS NO ROOM LEFT.



INSIDE!
MOVE!
MOVE!



WE LAY ONE ON TOP THE OTHER,
LIKE MATCHES, LIKE HERRINGS.



I PUSHED TO A CORNER.
NOT TO GET CRUSHED...

HIGH UP I SAW A FEW
HOOKS TO CHAIN UP
MAYBE THE ANIMALS.



I HAD STILL THE THIN
BLANKET THEY GAVE ME.

I CLIMBED TO SOME-
BODY'S SHOULDER AND
HOOKED IT STRONG.



IN THIS WAY I CAN REST
AND BREATHE A LITTLE.

THIS SAVED ME. MAY-
BE 25 PEOPLE CAME OUT
FROM THIS CAR OF 200.

SO, THE TRAIN WAS GOING, WE DIDN'T KNOW WHERE.

FOR DAYS AND NIGHTS, NOTHING



YOU SEE, PEOPLE BEGAN TO DIE, TO FAINT...

IF SOMEONE HAD TO MAKE A URINE OR A BOWEL MOVEMENT, HE DID WHERE HE STOOD.



IT WASN'T ROOM TO FALL...AND IF HE FELL, THEY STOOD ON HIM.



I ATE MOSTLY SNOW FROM UP ON THE ROOF.



SO HE JABBED TO THEIR LEGS WITH A KNIFE, BUT USUALLY HE ANYWAY DIED.



SOME HAD SUGAR SOMEHOW, BUT IT BURNED.

MY THROAT! I NEED WATER! WATER! GIVE ME SOME SNOW!

I CAN ONLY REACH A LITTLE FOR MYSELF!

PLEASE! PLEASE!! I BEG YOU!

OKAY. GIVE ME SOME SUGAR, I'LL GET YOU SOME SNOW...



SO I ATE ALSO SUGAR AND SAVED THEIR LIFE.



THE TRAIN STAYED SO, WITHOUT MOVING, I DON'T KNOW HOW LONG, UP TO A WEEK...



THEN, ONE DAY THEY OPENED...

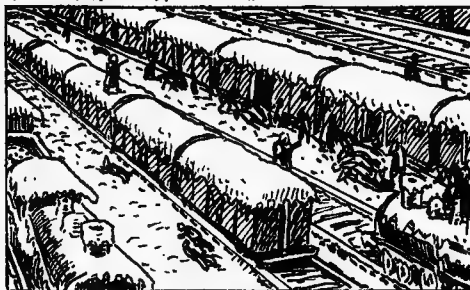
THROW OUT
THE DEAD,
AND CLEAN UP
YOUR FILTH!

IF THE DEAD HAD BREAD LEFT,
OR BETTER SHOES, WE KEPT...

OUTSIDE WERE MANY TRAINS STANDING FOR WEEKS, WHAT
THEY NEVER OPENED, AND IT WAS EVERYONE DEAD INSIDE...



...THEY DIDN'T
NEED ANYMORE.



THEY CLOSED
US AGAIN.
WE WERE
VERY HAPPY
WE HAD NOW
ROOM WHERE
TO STAND.

NEAR TO THE DOOR WE PILED NEW DEAD
ONES. EACH DAY THE GERMANS OPENED:
"HOW MANY DEAD?" AND WE THREW OUT,
AND SOON WE HAD ROOM EVEN TO SIT.

THEN THE TRAIN STARTED AGAIN GOING AND GOING...
INSIDE WE WERE MORE DYING AND SOME GOT CRAZY.

THEY OPENED THAT WE WILL
THROW OUT THE DEAD...



WE'VE GOTTA GET OUT!
LET US OUT! OUT! OUT!

THEN AGAIN IT STOPPED.



ALL OF
YOU-GET
DOWN!

WE COULD NOT
BELIEVE WHAT
WE ARE SEEING!

THERE IS THE
RED CROSS!...

YES! AND THE GIRLS ARE GIVING TO EVERYBODY A
SNACK-A LITTLE COFFEE AND A PIECE OF BREAD...



WE DIDN'T REMEMBER EVEN HOW
BREAD LOOKS. WE WERE VERY HAPPY.

THEN THEY CHASED US BACK IN THE TRAIN AGAIN
TO DIE, AND SO THE TRAVEL CONTINUED MORE...

FROM ALL THE CAMPS
OF EUROPE THEY NOW
BROUGHT BACK ALL OF
US INSIDE GERMANY.



IN THE MIDDLE WE FOUND OUT
THAT WE ARE COMING TO DACHAU.



THIS WAS EARLY FEBRUARY, IN 1945.
IT WAS NO FOOD AND SO CROWDED—

LOOK WHERE YOU GO!

ACH! THE SHOP-RITE
IS THERE, AND YOU
DIDN'T TURN TO IT!

WHOOOSH

SO, COME. WE'LL GO NOW IN TO
GIVE BACK OUR GROCERIES.

NO WAY! I'M NOT GOING IN TO
RETURN A LOAD OF OPEN BOXES
AND PARTIALLY EATEN FOOD.

WHAT'S TO BE SO ASHAMED?
IT'S FOODS I CAN'T EAT.
YOU WAIT THEN IN THE CAR
WHILE I ARRANGE IT.

Y'KNOW... I'LL BET YOU
THAT ANJA'S NOTEBOOKS
WERE WRITTEN ON BOTH
SIDES OF THE PAGE...

HUH? I CAN'T
REMEMBER.
WHY D'YOU
SAY THAT?

WELL... IF THERE WERE
ANY BLANK PAGES
VLADEK WOULD NEVER
HAVE BURNED THEM.

UH HUH...
HEY! YOU CAN
SEE HIM IN
THE WINDOW!

JEEZ, VLADEK AND
THE MANAGER
ARE SHOUTING
AT EACH OTHER...

NOW THE MAN-
AGER IS JUST
WALKING AWAY
FROM HIM...

AND NOW VLADEK
IS TRAILING
AFTER HIM...

HOW
EMBAR-
RASSING.





WE WERE CLOSED IN BARRACKS, SITTING ON STRAW, WAITING ONLY TO DIE.



TO EAT WE GOT ONLY BREAD AND SOUP, BUT YOU HAD TO SHOW FIRST YOUR SHIRT...



IF IT WAS ANY LICE, YOU GOT NO SOUP. THIS WAS IMPOSSIBLE. EVERYWHERE WAS LICE!



THERE, IN DACHAU,
I GOT AN INFECTION
IN MY HAND...



I TRIED TO MAKE WORSE
AND WORSE MY INFECTION...



I WANTED THEY TAKE
ME TO THE INFIRMARY.

EACH FEW DAYS SOMEONE
CAME TO SEE WHO IS SICK...



GO WITH THEM...

YOU SEE, THE INFIRMARY, I HEARD IT WAS A PARADISE.

PUT THIS OINTMENT ON HIS HAND AND KEEP
IT BANDAGED. IT WILL CLEAR UP QUICKLY.



HERE I HAD THREE TIMES A DAY
SOMETHING TO EAT, AND IT WAS
ONLY TWO PATIENTS FOR EACH BED.



I WORKED HOW I
COULD WITH ONE
HAND, SO THEY
WILL LIKE ME.

THAT'S STRANGE,
IT SHOULD HAVE
HEALED BY NOW!



I IRRITATED EACH DAY
MY HAND TO STAY LONGER.

AH!

THERE! I
OPENED IT
UP AGAIN!



THIS HURT ME REALLY
VERY VERY MUCH...

I GOT AFRAID FOR MY
HAND AND LET IT HEAL.
...I HAVE STILL TODAY
A SCAR ON THIS PLACE.



FROM THE INFIRMARY I HAD TO GO BACK TO A BAD BARRACK, WHERE WE WERE ALL DAY STANDING OUTSIDE.



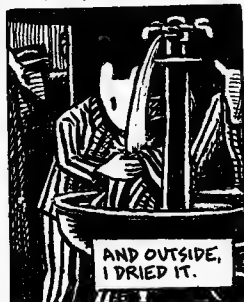
EACH DAY HE FOUND ME, THE FRENCH MAN...



WITH MY NEW FOOD I CAME TO AN IDEA...



I CLEANED THE SHIRT VERY, VERY CAREFUL.



I WAS LUCKY TO FIND A PIECE OF PAPER...



I UNWRAPPED ONLY WHEN THEY CALLED TO SOUP...



MY OLD SHIRT I HID TO MY PANTS. I SHOWED THE NEW ONE.



BUT AFTER A FEW WEEKS
I GOT TOO SICK EVEN TO EAT...

TYPHUS!



I GOT VERY HOT FEVER AND
I COULDN'T SLEEP. TYPHUS!



EVERY NIGHT PEOPLE DIED OF THIS.

AT NIGHT I HAD TO GO TO THE TOILET DOWN. IT WAS
ALWAYS FULL, THE WHOLE CORRIDOR, WITH THE DEAD
PEOPLE. PILED THERE. YOU COULDN'T GO THROUGH!!!



YOU HAD TO GO ON THEIR HEADS, AND THIS WAS TERRIBLE, BECAUSE IT WAS SO
SLIPPERY, THE SKIN, YOU THOUGHT YOU ARE FALLING. AND THIS WAS EVERY NIGHT.



SO NOW I HAD TYPHUS, AND I HAD TO GO TO THE TOILET DOWN,
AND I SAID, "NOW IT'S MY TIME. NOW I WILL BE LAYING
LIKE THIS ONES AND SOMEBODY WILL STEP ON ME!"

I WAS ALIVE STILL THE NEXT TIME IT
CAME A GUY FROM THE INFIRMARY..



MANY DIDN'T LIVE LONG ENOUGH
TO GO TO DIE IN THE INFIRMARY.

THERE I LAY TOO WEAK EVEN TO MOVE
OR TO GO TO THE TOILET OUT FROM BED.



I ASKED HELP FROM THE FELLOWS
NEXT TO ME, BUT IN A FEW HOURS
THEY WERE DEAD AND OTHERS CAME.

THEY GAVE BREAD AND SOUP, BUT I WAS TOO WEAK TO EAT...



SO I PUT MY PORTION
BELOW MY PILLOW.

HEY! THERE'S STALE
BREAD ALL OVER
THIS ONE'S BED!

WELL, TAKE IT
AWAY... HE'LL
NEVER NEED IT.



I SCREAMED, BUT I COULDN'T SCREAM.



MMUH
MMNH.

I WAS TOO WEAK
TO SCREAM...

SO I TOOK MY SHOE AND KNOCKED LOUD.



STOP THAT
RACKET!

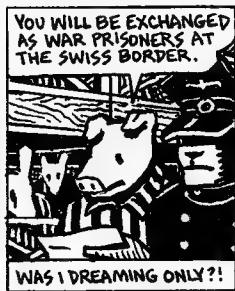
KLAKK
KLAKK
KLAKK

BAH! KEEP YOUR DAMN BREAD!



I COULDN'T EAT,
BUT I CUT PIECES
TO PAY FOR HELP
TO GO DOWN TO
THE TOILET.

SO... MY FEVER FELL DOWN,
AND SOMETHING NEW CAME.



THEY LIKED TO SEND OUT THE SICK ONES,
BUT NOT SO SICK THAT WE ARRIVE DEAD.



BUT I CAME SOMEHOW
OUTSIDE THE GATE!!!



I THOUGHT THIS TRAIN, IT MUST BE FOR THE GESTAPO, BUT NO!



WHATEVER HAPPENED TO THAT FRENCH GUY WHO HELPED YOU?

YAH. HE WAS A FINE FELLOW...



WELL...DID YOU SAVE ANY OF HIS LETTERS?

OF COURSE I SAVED. BUT ALL THIS I THREW AWAY TOGETHER WITH ANJA'S NOTEBOOKS.



I CAN'T REMEMBER EVEN HIS NAME, BUT IN PARIS HE IS LIVING... FOR YEARS WE EXCHANGED LETTERS IN THE ENGLISH I TAUGHT TO HIM.



ALL SUCH THINGS OF THE WAR, I TRIED TO PUT OUT FROM MY MIND ONCE FOR ALL... UNTIL YOU REBUILD ME ALL THIS FROM YOUR QUESTIONS.



HAH?! WHAT FOR DO YOU STOP, FRANÇOISE? WE'RE NOT YET TO THE BUNGALOW?

THERE'S A HITCH-HIKER...



A HITCH-HIKER? AND -OY- IT'S A COLORED GUY, A SHVARTSER!

HIYA.

PUSH QUICK ON THE GAS!



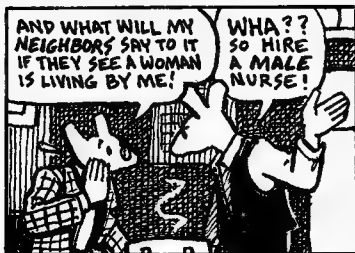




C H A P T E R F O U R



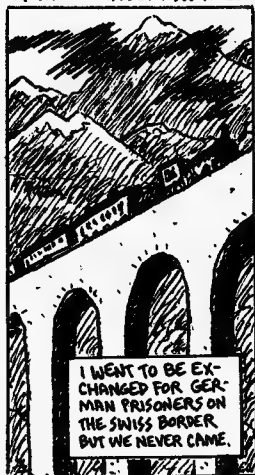
Back in Rego Park. Late Autumn...







IT WAS THE LAST MINUTES OF THE WAR, I LEFT DACHAU...



I REMEMBER WE GOT EACH A TREASURE BOX FROM THE SWISS RED CROSS: SARDINES! BISCUITS! CHOCOLATE!



SO, AT NIGHT, SOME TRIED TO STEAL FROM ME...



WITH MY TYPHUS I NEEDED STILL MUCH TO REST, BUT THIS TREASURE WAS MORE TO ME THAN SLEEPING.



WE HAD FROM HERE TO GO BY FOOT TO THE FRONTIER...



IT WAS COMMOTIONS AND RUMORS THEN SHOUTS:



IT WAS COMMOTIONS AND RUMORS THEN SHOUTS:



THEY DIDN'T LEAVE US GO, BUT PUT US TO A FREIGHT TRAIN.



IN A HALF HOUR THIS TRAIN STOPPED

HEY! THE AMERICANS AREN'T HERE!

WHY WAIT? LET'S GO!



SOME WENT ONE WAY, SOME ANOTHER...



HALT
OR WE'LL
SHOOT!

ALL OF A SUDDEN, IT WAS
A WEHRMACHT PATROL!



LITTLE BY LITTLE THEY GOT ALL OF US WHAT WERE GOING TO BE FREE,
MAYBE 150 OR 200 PEOPLE, OVER IN THE WOODS, BY A BIG LAKE !!!



THEY GUARDED SO WE COULDN'T GO AWAY.

THERE ARE MACHINE GUNS
SET UP ALL AROUND US!



WE OVERHEARD. THEY INTEND
TO MURDER EVERY ONE OF US
TONIGHT, RIGHT ON THIS SPOT!



IN THE LATER AFTERNOON I WENT OVER
CLOSE TO THE EDGE OF THE WATER ...

VLADK SPIEGEL:
MAN! IS THAT YOU?

SHIVEK?!
YOU'RE ALIVE?



SHIVEK WAS FROM BEFORE THE WAR. A
FRIEND FROM BEDZIN, NEAR SOSNOWIEC.

WE SURVIVED EV-
ERYTHING JUST TO
GET SHOT WHILE
THE WAR ENDS!

I STILL HAVE A
LITTLE COFFEE I
ORGANIZED. LET'S
MAKE A LAST CUP.



LOOK!
GET HIM!

SPLASH



ONE OLDER GUY, HE WAS
MAYBE 50, JUMPED TO THE
LAKE. IT WAS A FAR SWIM.

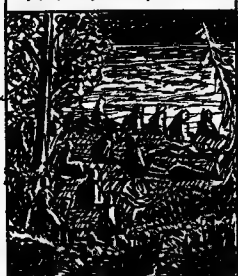
KBANG!
KBANG!

HE MADE IT!
DO YOU HAVE THE
STRENGTH TO TRY?



JUST STAY NEAR THE WATER.
WE CAN ALWAYS TRY IT WHEN
THE REAL SHOOTING STARTS.

SO IT CAME NIGHT. WE
WERE TERRIBLE FRIGHT-
ENED, WE SAT AND WAITED.



IT WAS CRYING AND PRAYING. SO LONG WE
SURVIVED, AND NOW WE WAITED ONLY THAT
THEY SHOOT, BECAUSE WE HAD NOT ELSE TO DO.



IN THE EARLY MORNING
WE WERE STILL ALL ALIVE.

THEY'RE GONE!



IT'S A MIRACLE!
THERE'S NOT ONE
GERMAN LEFT—
JUST THEIR GUNS!

WHAT
HAP-
PENED?

I WAS LYING NEAR THE
HEAD OFFICER'S TENT—
HIS GIRLFRIEND WAS
ARGUING WITH HIM...



SHE BEGGED HIM TO LET US GO. SHE
WARNED HIM HE'D BE PUNISHED.



"THE WAR IS OVER," SHE CRIED.
"LET'S RUN AWAY!" SHE SAVED US!



SOME, WE WENT ONE WAY, SOME ANOTHER.

MAYBE WE CAN GET FOOD
AT ONE OF THESE FARMS.



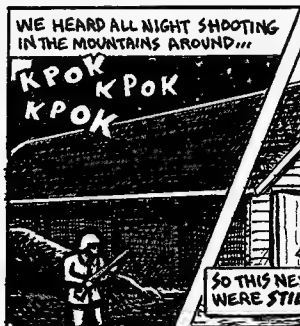
HALT!

ON THE ROAD WAS
ANOTHER PATROL,
ALSO CATCHING JEWS.

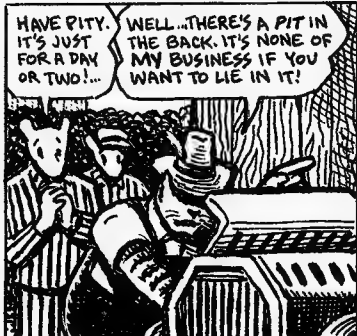


SO WE HAD AGAIN THE SAME STORY. THEY FOUND
40 OR 50 OF US, AND CLOSED US TO A BIG BARN.





WE CAME BY A GARAGE. SO I WENT OVER...



OVER A DAY WE LAY THERE.
THEN TWO WEHRMACHT CAME.



LET'S GO, SHIVEK. WE'LL FIND A SAFER SPOT.



WE PASSED TO A FEW HOUSES AND PEEKED INSIDE...



LOOK. NOBODY SEEMS TO BE HOME HERE.

A PART OF THIS HOUSE, IT WAS A BARN.



WE CAN HIDE UP HERE UNDER THE HAY.

FROM THE WALLS WE HEARD SHOUTING:

SCHELL, ELSA! PACK WHAT YOU CAN.

HURRY! THIS MAY BECOME A BATTLEFIELD ANY MINUTE!



THE VILLAGERS ARE RUNNING AWAY!

FINE. THE FARTHER THE BETTER!



THE FAR SIDE FROM OUR BARN FELL DOWN A LITTLE...

MY GOD! WH-WHAT HAPPENED?!

THE WEHRMACHT IS RETREATING AND BLEW UP THE BRIDGE TO SEAL THEIR TRAIL. IT MEANS WE'RE FREE!

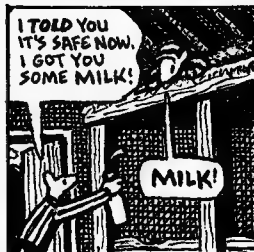
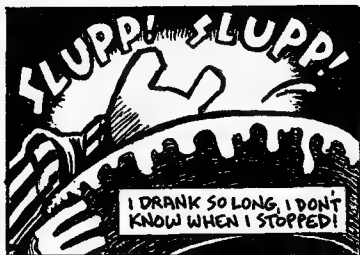


LET'S LOOK AROUND. IT'S SAFE NOW!

UH-UH. I'M NOT GOING ANYWHERE!



I WENT MYSELF TO THE EMPTY HOUSE.



SO, WE BOTH DRANK TOO MUCH MILK AND LOOKED AROUND.



I TOLD EVERYTHING HOW WE SURVIVED TO HERE...

...AND FROM DACHAU WE
CAME OVER BY TRAIN TO-

THAT'S JUST MY MEN
SIGNALING THAT
THEY FOUND A CACHE
OF GERMAN AMMO...



THOSE KRAUTS CAN'T
HURT YOU ANYMORE.
THE ONLY ONES LEFT
ARE DEAD OR DYING.



THIS HOUSE WILL
BE PART OF OUR
BASE CAMP...



BUT I GUESS YOU BOYS
CAN STAY IF YOU KEEP
THE JOINT CLEAN AND
MAKE OUR BEDS.



WANT
SOME
CHOCO-
LATE?

M-MAYBE
FOR LATER.
THANK YOU.



SO WE WORKED FOR
THE AMERICANS AND
THEY LIKED ME THAT
I CAN SPEAK ENGLISH.



THANKS FOR THE
SHINE, WILLIE.

IT'S O.KAY, SERGEANT.
DON'T EVEN MENTION.



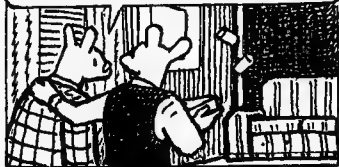
ONE TIME IT CAME A WOMAN
WITH OFFICIALS TO THE HOUSE.





YAH. HE WAS ANJA'S OLDEST BROTHER. HE RAN, IN LODZ, THE FAMILY MOSIERY FACTORY.

IN 1939 HE AND HELA CAME TO SEE THE WORLD FAIR, AND STAYED HERE THE WAR. IN 1950 - YOU WERE A BABY - WE CAME ALSO HERE, FROM STOCKHOLM TO HIS HOUSE.



I LIKED BETTER TO STAY IN SWEDEN - I HAD AGAIN A GOOD BUSINESS - BUT ANJA INSISTED TO BE WITH THE ONLY SURVIVING ONE OF ALL HER FAMILY.



AND - OY - WHEN HERMAN DIED FROM A HIT-AND-RUN DRIVER IN 1964, ANJA STARTED THE - ALSO TO DIE A LITTLE.



SO HERE IT'S THEIR TWO KIDS, LOLEK AND LONIA, WHAT STAYED BY US, IN SOŚNOWIEC, IN THE WAR.



LOLEK, YOU KNOW HE THEN CAME OUT ALIVE FROM AUSCHWITZ, SO NOW HE'S AN ENGINEER AND A BIG-SHOT COLLEGE PROFESSOR.



THE LITTLE GIRL, SHE FINISHED WITH RICHIEU IN THE GHETTO.



THIS BROTHER OF ANJA, JOSEF, HE WAS A SIGN PAINTER, A COMMERCIAL ARTIST, ALWAYS SHE SAID YOU RESEMBLE.



Josef. Lodz. 1934

HE HAD, IN LODZ, A GIRLFRIEND-A BEAUTY- BUT SHE LIKED MONEY AND NIGHTCLUBS, THEN THE GERMANS TOOK AWAY THE FACTORY FROM ANJA'S FAMILY.



SO HE HAD LESS MONEY AND SHE LEFT HIM AND HE KILLED HIMSELF.



THE MIDDLE BROTHER, LEVEK, HE RAN WITH HIS WIFE TO RUSSIA WHEN THE WAR CAME, BUT WHEN HE SAW HOW IT WAS THERE, HE WANTED TO RUN BACK.



THOSE WHO RAN TO RUSSIA, THEY PUT TO SIBERIA AS TRAITORS, BUT TO SMUGGLE BACK OVER THE BORDERS COST A FORTUNE. I SENT SOME MONEY...



IN '38, WHEN I NEEDED CASH TO MY FACTORY, HE GAVE. SO NOW I HELPED HIM COME BACK TO HIS WIFE'S FAMILY... TO WARSAW.



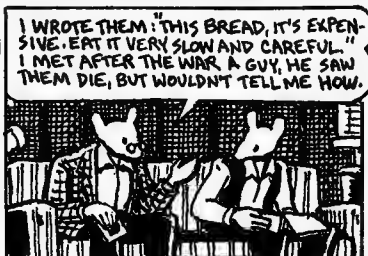
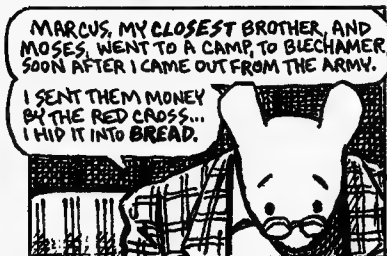
LEVEK, SO SNOWIEC'ZI

IN WARSAW, YOU KNOW HOW IT WAS. IF THEY STAYED ONLY IN RUSSIA, THEY STILL NOW COULD MAYBE BE ALIVE.



ANJA'S PARENTS, THE GRANDPARENTS, HER BIG SISTER TOSHA, LITTLE BIBI AND OUR RICHIEU... ALL WHAT IS LEFT, IT'S THE PHOTOS.





THESE PHOTOS WE GOT FROM RICHIEU'S POLISH GOVERNESS.

WE GAVE HER OUR VALUABLE THINGS TO HOLD UNTIL THE WAR IS OVER.



BUT AFTERWARD SHE SAID, "ALL THESE VALUABLES, THE NAZIS GRABBED AWAY."

WE DIDN'T BELIEVE, BUT THE PICTURES AT LEAST, SHE GAVE BACK.



CAN I TAKE THESE HOME?

YAH. IT'S FOR YOU. BUT, WAIT- I'LL PUT THEM TO AN ENVELOPE...



THE CIGAR BOX I CAN NEED FOR- **AKKH!**



WHOO- YOU SEE? MY NITRO-STAT HELPS ME RIGHT AWAY. BUT I TALKED TOO MUCH. I'LL LIE A LITTLE DOWN.



UM- WHAT ABOUT THE STORM WINDOWS?

ALONE YOU CAN'T KNOW HOW TO DO, AND I'M NOW TOO TIRED FOR THIS. MAY- BE TOMORROW WE'LL DO.



IMPOSSIBLE. I'M TOO BUSY! I'LL COME OUT AGAIN NEXT WEEK.

ACH. THEN NOW WE MUST DO IT. I'LL- UNNE



GREAT- HAVE ANOTHER HEART ATTACK! LOOK, YOU'LL JUST HAVE TO PAY A BIT MORE FOR HEAT A FEW DAYS LONGER.

GROAN.



I'M -UH- SORRY I MADE YOU TALK SO MUCH, POP.

SO, NEVER MIND, DARLING. ALWAYS IT'S A PLEASURE WHEN YOU VISIT.



C H A P T E R F I V E



Winter...







HEY! EVERYTHING'S AL-
MOST PACKED, MALA.
THE MAIN REASON I
FLEW DOWN WAS TO HELP!

PSSH. YOU KNOW VLADEK.
WILD HORSES CAN'T HOLD
HIM STILL... SO NOW HE'S
EXHAUSTED, AND ME TOO.



HI, POP.
HOW
ARE
YOU?

TERRIBLE.
SO WEAK...
SO WEAK...

DID YOU ARRANGE
EMERGENCY OXY-
GEN FOR HIM ON
TOMORROW'S PLANE?



UH-HUH. AND I'VE GOT AN AMBULANCE
TO TAKE HIM AND ME FROM J.F.K. TO
LAGUARDIA HOSPITAL. I'LL CHECK HIM
IN WHILE FRANÇOISE DRIVES YOU HOME.



HOW DID YOU
TWO GET BACK
TOGETHER?

I DON'T KNOW. I GOT A
CALL FROM THE HOSPI-
TAL AND FELT SORRY
FOR HIM. I WENT OVER.



I SWORE I'D NEVER SEE HIM
AGAIN, BUT I'M JUST A SUCKER.
HE TALKED UNTIL I WAS BLUE
IN THE FACE... AND HERE I AM.

MALA, MALA!
COME
QUICK!



ANJA MUST HAVE
BEEN A SAINT!
NO WONDER SHE
KILLED HERSELF.

HE'S
CALL-
ING
YOU.



IT'S JUST HIS STOOL. HE
WANTS ME TO CHECK IT
BEFORE HE'LL FLUSH.
HE'S AS DIFFICULT AS EVER.



BUT NOW HE'S MORE CON-
FUSED AND DEPENDENT.
...WHAT CAN I DO?
HE TRAPPED ME.



Next morning...







Late that night...



LaGuardia Hospital...



A month or so later...





SO, IT CAME AN ORDER...

WE ALL CAME OVER TO GARMISCH-PARTENKIRCHEN.



I WAS FOR A GOOD FEW DAYS VERY SICK.



IN THIS DP CAMP, I HAD IT EASY...

HURRY, VLADEN! WE CAN EARN SOME CHOCOLATES!



WE CARRIED MANY GOODIES WHEN FINALLY WE GOT OUR I.D. PAPERS TO GO.

WE WANT TICKETS TO HANNOVER.

TICKETS??...



OKAY! WE SPEAK ENGLISH! OKAY!!

SHIVEK, HE COULDN'T SPEAK EVEN POLISH—JUST YIDDISH.



I DON'T KNOW IF THERE ARE EVEN ANY TRACKS! THAT FREIGHT MAY BE HEADING NORTH.



TRAINS STOPPED AND STARTED AND HAD TO CHANGE OFTEN DIRECTIONS...

LOOK, SHIVEK—NUREMBERG.



I SCRUBBED STREETS HERE AS A P.O.W...



NOW IT WAS ONLY STONES AND NOTHING.

WE CAME TO ONE PLACE, WÜRZBURG—WHAT A MESS!

WHERE CAN WE FIND WATER?

HAH! WE HAVEN'T HAD ANY WATER IN THREE DAYS!

THE AMERICANS DESTROYED—SOB—EVERYTHING!



NOT ONE BUILDING WAS STILL STANDING.

WE CAME AWAY HAPPY.

LET THE GERMANS HAVE A LITTLE WHAT THEY DID TO THE JEWS.



WE ARRIVED FINALLY TO HANNOVER...

THE KIDS CAN SHARE ONE BEDROOM.
YOU TWO CAN HAVE THE OTHER ...



DO YOU KNOW
WHERE ANY
OF **YOUR**
FAMILY IS?

I'LL GO TO POLAND TO
SEE IF ANYONE'S LEFT.
WE PLANNED TO MEET
IN SOSNOWIEC IF WE
GOT SEPARATED.



I SENT A LETTER TO THE JEWISH
COMMUNITY CENTER THERE, FOR MY
WIFE, BUT-SHE CAN'T STILL BE ALIVE...
I SAW HER IN AUSCHWITZ LAST YEAR...



SHE WAS
SO THIN...
SO WEAK...

YOU MIGHT GET NEWS ABOUT
YOUR FAMILY AT THE BIG DP
CAMP AT BELSEN. JEWS ARE
FLOODING IN FROM ALL OVER.



IT WASN'T FAR, SO I WENT FOR A FEW DAYS TO BELSEN.
ONE MORNING A CROWD ARRIVED IN, WITH TWO GIRLS
WHAT I KNEW A LITTLE FROM MY HOME TOWN ...



WE JUST
CAME FROM
POLAND...

WE WERE
LUCKY TO
GET OUT!...



WHATEVER YOU DO, DON'T
GO BACK TO SOSNOWIEC.
THE POLES ARE STILL
KILLING JEWS THERE!







ANJA WAS ALL ALONE THERE IN SOSNOWIEC...



SHE TOLD ME LATER, SHE WENT ONCE TO A GYPSY...



I SEE TRAGEDY...DEATH!... YOU'VE LOST YOUR FATHER-- YOUR MOTHER...EVERYONE!

Y-YES. ONLY LOLEK, MY NEPHEW, CAME BACK-



I SEE A CHILD... A DEAD CHILD...

RICHIEU! MY LITTLE BOY, RICHIEU. SOB.



WAIT! NOW I SEE A MAN... ILLNESS...IT'S YOUR HUSBAND! HE'S BEEN VERY, VERY ILL...



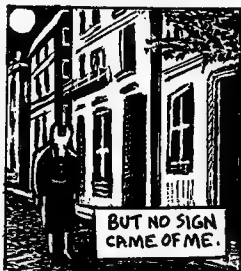
HE'S COMING - HE'S COMING HOME! YOU'LL GET A SIGN THAT HE'S ALIVE BY THE TIME THE MOON IS FULL!



I SEE A SHIP... A FARAWAY PLACE... YOU'LL HAVE A NEW LIFE... AND ANOTHER LITTLE BOY.

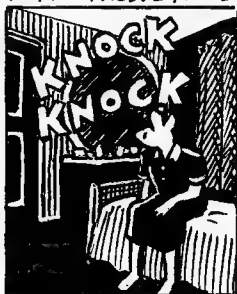


ANJA WENT A FEW TIMES
EACH DAY OVER TO THE
JEWISH ORGANIZATION...



BUT NO SIGN
CAME OF ME.

SO SHE SAT HOME EVEN
MORE DEPRESSED, UNTIL...



ANJA! GUESS WHAT!
A LETTER FROM YOUR
HUSBAND JUST CAME!



HE'S IN GERMANY...
HE'S HAD TYPHUS!

IT'S JUST LIKE
THE GYPSY SAID.



AND HERE'S A PICTURE OF HIM!
MY GOD-VLADEK
IS REALLY ALIVE!



I PASSED ONCE A PHOTO PLACE WHAT HAD
A CAMP UNIFORM - A NEW AND CLEAN ONE -
TO MAKE SOUVENIR PHOTOS..



ANJA KEPT THIS PICTURE ALWAYS.
I HAVE IT STILL NOW IN MY DESK!
HUH? WHERE DO YOU GO?

I NEED
THAT PHO-
TO IN MY
BOOK!





WE WENT, SOMETIMES BY FOOT, SOMETIMES BY TRAIN.



ONE PLACE WE STOPPED, HOURS, HOURS AND HOURS.



I MARKED OUR TRAIN CAR, BUT WHEN I CAME IN AN HOUR BACK, IT WAS GONE TO ANOTHER TRACK

SHIVEK WENT BACK TO HANNOVER TO FIND ME AGAIN...



WHEN I CAME FINALLY TO SOSNOWIEC,
I HAVE SEEN VERY LITTLE JEWS AROUND.



THERE IT WAS PEOPLE WHAT KNEW ME.



AND SOMEBODY FOUND HER...



- art spiegelman - 1978-1991

Art Spiegelman is a contributing editor and artist for the *New Yorker*, and co-founder/editor of *Raw*, the acclaimed magazine of avant-garde comics and graphics. His drawings and prints have been exhibited in museums and galleries here and abroad. Honours he has received for *Maus* include the Pulitzer Prize, a Guggenheim fellowship, and nominations for the National Book Critics Circle Award. He lives in New York City.



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